

A Unified Calculus of Combinatorial Formulae

**Stirling, Bell, Eulerian, Bernoulli, and Catalan Structures;
Faà di Bruno, Lagrange–Good Inversion, and Asymptotic Methods**

A proof-complete synthesis of five drafts and two reference dossiers

September 2026

Abstract

This monograph develops a unified calculus for the coefficients that occur when one changes polynomial bases, partitions labelled sets, differentiates or composes functions, and reverses formal or analytic power series. Its principal objects are the signed and unsigned Stirling numbers of the first kind, the Stirling numbers of the second kind, Lah numbers, Bell numbers, exponential and ordinary Bell polynomials, Eulerian numbers of types A and B , second-order Eulerian numbers, Faà di Bruno's formula, and the Lagrange inversion and reversion theorems.

The treatment is deliberately proof-oriented. Definitions are connected by bijections and change-of-basis arguments; generating functions are derived rather than merely recorded; recurrences, convolutions, congruences, determinant formulae, probabilistic interpretations, special-function identities, and asymptotic formulae are proved from a small collection of reusable principles. Applications include finite differences, differential-operator normal ordering, moments and cumulants, symmetric polynomials, cycle indices, Hermite polynomials, polynomial sequences of binomial type, negative polylogarithms, Bernoulli-number identities, Poisson moments, Catalan and Fuss–Catalan series, the Lambert W function, and Laplace-type asymptotic integrals.

The source archive uses the letter B for Bell numbers, Bell polynomials, Bernoulli numbers, type- B Eulerian numbers, and binary-tree numbers. Here these are separated notationally. Five overlapping drafts have been merged at section level rather than concatenated. New chapters integrate complementary material from the supplied Wikipedia and MathWorld folders and from primary online references: coordinate-free and multivariate Faà di Bruno formulas, Good's inversion theorem, partition-lattice Möbius inversion, Sheffer and Riordan theory, Bernoulli–Euler–Genocchi and Cauchy polynomials, complementary Bell numbers, Euler–Maclaurin summation, Darboux formulas, Pochhammer parameter derivatives, polygamma and Barnes G functions, Kepler's equation, Narayana numbers, and associahedral face enumeration. A final concordance records the role of each draft, the deduplication rules, and independent consistency checks.

How to read this work

The chapters are arranged by mathematical dependence, not by the order of the source files. The two master ideas are:

1. a coefficient is often easiest to compute after changing to the basis in which the relevant operator is diagonal; and
2. an exponential generating function remembers the decomposition of a labelled object into components.

Stirling numbers implement the first idea. Bell polynomials implement the second. Eulerian numbers mediate between powers and shifted binomial coefficients. Faà di Bruno’s formula is the differential form of labelled composition, while Lagrange inversion is the coefficient form of implicit substitution.

A result stated for formal power series requires no convergence. When an analytic version is asserted, its domain hypotheses are written explicitly. Statements in the five drafts that report historical computations—for example, lists of Bell primes or verified exact modular periods—are distinguished from theorems and are accompanied by a certificate procedure rather than misrepresented as symbolic identities.

Editorial normalization

Three systematic repairs are used throughout.

1. Bell numbers are denoted B_n , complete exponential Bell polynomials by $\mathcal{B}_n$, partial Bell polynomials by $\mathcal{B}_{n,k}$, and Bernoulli numbers by β_n .
2. Type- B Eulerian numbers are indexed by descents in positions $0, 1, \dots, n-1$ with $\pi_0 = 0$. This removes the one-step shift in one formula in the archive.
3. The archived Moser–Wyman display contains unnamed quantities B, P_i, Q_i . We give the exact saddle-point scheme that defines every correction coefficient recursively and state the leading expansion in closed form; no undefined placeholder is retained.

Contents

Abstract	i
How to read this work	ii
Notation	viii
 I Coefficient Calculus and Labelled Structures	 1
1 Formal power series and coefficient extraction	2
1.1 Formal series as an algebraic environment	2
1.2 Formal residues	2
1.3 Ordinary and exponential generating functions	3
1.4 Finite differences and factorial bases	3
1.5 Labelled products and the exponential formula	3
 II Stirling Numbers, Lah Numbers, and Basis Changes	 5
2 The two Stirling triangles	6
2.1 First-kind numbers: cycles and factorial coefficients	6
2.2 Second-kind numbers: set partitions and surjections	6
2.3 Alternative and reverse recurrences	7
2.4 Tables and common boundary conventions	9
3 Factorial bases and inverse matrices	10
3.1 The basic changes of basis	10
3.2 Power sums by basis adaptation	11
3.3 Factorial moments: Poisson variables and permutation fixed points	11
3.4 Lah numbers	12
4 Generating functions, transforms, and operators	14
4.1 Exponential generating functions	14
4.2 A rational ordinary generating function	15
4.3 The Stirling transform	15
4.4 Differential-operator normal ordering	16
5 Symmetric functions, diagonals, and finite identities	17
5.1 Elementary and complete symmetric descriptions	17
5.2 Harmonic-number formulae	17
5.3 Convolution and summation identities	18
5.4 Symmetric cross-formulae	19

5.5	An explicit two-sum formula of the first kind	19
5.6	A partition formula for signed near-diagonal coefficients	20
6	Congruences and extensions to negative indices	22
6.1	Congruences for first-kind numbers	22
6.2	Parity of second-kind numbers	23
6.3	Roman extension and negative Bell values	23
7	Asymptotics, bounds, and special-function sums	25
7.1	Elementary asymptotic regimes	25
7.2	Bounds for second-kind numbers	25
7.3	Real zeros, log-concavity, and the location of the maximum	26
7.4	A uniform saddle-point approximation	27
7.5	Zeta and Hurwitz-zeta sums	28
7.6	Convergent Stirling series for $\log \Gamma$, ψ , and the Stieltjes constants	29
7.6.1	The logarithm and logarithmic derivative of the gamma function	29
7.6.2	Stieltjes constants	30
7.7	Gregory coefficients and derivatives of logarithmic powers	32
7.8	Generalized factorial coefficients	32
8	Restricted variants of set partitions	33
8.1	r -Stirling numbers of the second kind	33
8.2	Associated Stirling numbers	33
8.3	Reduced Stirling numbers and graph coloring	34
III	Bell Numbers and Set Partitions	35
9	Set partitions and the many meanings of the Bell numbers	36
9.1	Definition, initial values, and equivalence relations	36
9.2	Ordered set partitions and the Fubini numbers	36
9.3	Squarefree factorizations, rhyme schemes, and restricted-growth words	37
9.4	A card-shuffling bijection	37
9.5	Bell-enumerated vincular pattern classes	38
9.6	The Bell–Aitken triangle	38
10	The enumerative calculus of Bell numbers	40
10.1	Two fundamental sums	40
10.2	Spivey’s identity and binomial inversions	40
10.3	Exponential generating function and differential equation	41
10.4	Dobiński’s formula and Poisson moments	42
11	Congruences, shape, and growth of Bell numbers	43
11.1	Touchard congruences	43
11.2	A universal period bound modulo a prime	44
11.3	Log-convexity and normalized log-concavity	44
11.4	Explicit upper bounds	45
11.5	Saddle-point asymptotics and Lambert W	45
11.6	Bell primes and verifiable computation	47

IV	Bell Polynomials and Composition	48
12	Exponential and ordinary Bell polynomials	49
12.1	Definitions	49
12.2	Combinatorial interpretation	49
12.3	The master generating functions	50
12.4	Tables and low-degree polynomials	51
13	Recurrences, derivatives, and algebraic identities	52
13.1	Pointing recurrences	52
13.2	Near-diagonal reduction	52
13.3	Partial derivatives	53
13.4	A quadratic differential recurrence	53
14	Specializations, inversions, determinants, and convolutions	55
14.1	Stirling, Bell, Lah, and Touchard specializations	55
14.2	Homogeneity and a useful evaluation	55
14.3	Addition and shifted-zero identities	56
14.4	Exponential–logarithmic inversion	56
14.5	Two Hessenberg determinants	57
14.6	The diamond convolution	57
15	Applications of Bell polynomials	59
15.1	Symmetric functions and Newton identities	59
15.2	Cycle indices	59
15.3	Moments and cumulants	60
15.4	Hermite polynomials	60
15.5	Polynomial sequences of binomial type	60
V	Eulerian Numbers and Descent Calculus	62
16	Ordinary Eulerian numbers	63
16.1	Descents, symmetry, and the basic recurrence	63
16.2	Exponential generating function and explicit formula	63
16.3	Worpitzky’s identity and sums of powers	64
16.4	Negative polylogarithms	65
16.5	Eulerian and Stirling bases	65
16.6	An Irwin–Hall integral and hypersimplex volumes	65
16.7	Alternating sums and Bernoulli numbers	66
17	Geometric interpretations	67
17.1	The cube and its Ehrhart numerator	67
17.2	The permutohedron	67
18	Type-B and second-order Eulerian numbers	68
18.1	Signed permutations and the corrected type-B indexing	68
18.2	Stirling permutations and second-order Eulerian numbers	69
18.3	Second-order Eulerian interpolation of first-kind diagonals	69

VI	Differentiation, Composition, and Reversion	71
19	Faà di Bruno's formula	72
19.1	The set-partition form	72
19.2	Multiplicity and Bell-polynomial forms	72
19.3	The exponential special case	73
19.4	Mixed partial derivatives	73
20	Composition of ordinary and exponential series	74
20.1	Ordinary formal power series	74
20.2	Exponential formal power series	74
21	Lagrange inversion and Lagrange–Bürmann	76
21.1	Formal theorem	76
21.2	Analytic inverse functions	77
21.3	Inverse coefficients in Bell-polynomial form	77
21.4	The associahedron interpretation, with normalized notation	78
22	Algebraic and transcendental examples	79
22.1	The Fuss–Catalan algebraic equation	79
22.2	Lambert's W function at the origin	79
22.3	A rapidly useful expansion around $W(e) = 1$	80
22.4	Binary trees and Catalan numbers	80
23	Lagrange's reversion theorem in shifted form	81
23.1	The two-parameter implicit equation	81
23.2	The delta-function proof decoded	81
24	Laplace-type asymptotic integrals	83
24.1	Endpoint expansion	83
VII	Higher Differential Calculus and Multivariate Reversion	85
25	Products, quotients, and coordinate-free composition	86
25.1	The multinomial Leibniz rule and higher quotient rules	86
25.2	A coordinate-free Faà di Bruno formula	87
25.3	Recursive derivatives of an inverse function	87
26	Good's multivariate inversion theorem	89
26.1	Formal logarithmic residues	89
27	Partition lattices, Sheffer families, and Riordan arrays	91
27.1	Möbius inversion on the partition lattice	91
27.2	Sheffer sequences and delta operators	91
27.3	Exponential Riordan arrays	92
27.4	Abel polynomials from Lagrange inversion	93
28	A complete coefficient-algorithm toolkit	94

VIII Bernoulli Families, Summation, and Factorial Special Functions	96
29 Bernoulli, Euler, Genocchi, and Cauchy polynomials	97
29.1 Bernoulli polynomials	97
29.2 Euler and Genocchi polynomials	98
29.3 Bernoulli polynomials of the second kind	98
29.4 A normalized modified-Bernoulli series	99
30 Complementary Bell numbers	100
31 Euler–Maclaurin summation and Darboux formulas	101
31.1 Darboux’s weighted Taylor identity	102
31.2 Algebraic singularity transfer	102
32 Pochhammer symbols, polygamma functions, and Barnes’ G	104
32.1 Rising factorials and parameter derivatives	104
32.2 Digamma and polygamma series	104
32.3 Barnes’ G -function	105
IX Inverse Examples and Refined Catalan Geometry	107
33 Inverse trigonometric functions and Kepler’s equation	108
33.1 Inverse trigonometric coefficient evaluations	108
33.2 Kepler’s equation	108
34 Narayana refinement and associahedral face enumeration	110
34.1 Narayana numbers	110
34.2 All faces of the associahedron	111
34.3 Loday coordinates and a constant-sum proof	111
X Source Concordance and Verification Record	113
35 How the five drafts were unified	114
35.1 Use of the supplied reference folders	114
35.2 Deduplication rules	115
36 Proof and consistency audit	116
36.1 Proof coverage	116
36.2 Independent low-order checks	116
36.3 Boundary conventions	117
36.4 Dependency map	117
Selected bibliography and provenance	118

Notation

For $n \in \mathbb{N}$, write

$$x^{\overline{n}} = x(x-1) \cdots (x-n+1), \quad x^{\underline{n}} = x(x+1) \cdots (x+n-1),$$

with both expressions equal to 1 when $n = 0$. Coefficient extraction is denoted by $[z^n]F(z)$, and $\text{Res}_z F(z) dz$ means the coefficient of z^{-1} in a formal Laurent series. Our principal arrays are

$$s(n, k), \quad \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = (-1)^{n-k} s(n, k), \quad \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle,$$

where $s(n, k)$ is the signed first-kind Stirling number, $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}$ its unsigned version, $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$ the second-kind Stirling number, and $\left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle$ the ordinary Eulerian number. Bell numbers are B_n ; exponential partial and complete Bell polynomials are $\mathcal{B}_{n,k}$ and $\mathcal{B}_n$.

Unless stated otherwise, sums over an impossible index range are zero, and $0^0 = 1$ in coefficient formulae. Bernoulli numbers use

$$\frac{t}{e^t - 1} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \beta_n \frac{t^n}{n!}, \quad \beta_1 = -\frac{1}{2}.$$

Part I

Coefficient Calculus and Labelled Structures

Chapter 1

Formal power series and coefficient extraction

1.1 Formal series as an algebraic environment

Let R be a commutative $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebra. The ring $R[[z]]$ consists of expressions $F(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} f_n z^n$ with termwise addition and Cauchy multiplication. A series is invertible precisely when f_0 is invertible in R . If $G(0) = 0$, then the composition $F(G(z))$ is well-defined because each coefficient receives only finitely many contributions.

Lemma 1.1 (Coefficient rules). For $F(z) = \sum f_n z^n$ and $G(z) = \sum g_n z^n$,

$$[z^n]F(z)G(z) = \sum_{j=0}^n f_j g_{n-j}, \quad (1.1)$$

$$[z^n]F'(z) = (n+1)f_{n+1}, \quad (1.2)$$

$$[z^n] \frac{F(z)}{1-az} = \sum_{j=0}^n a^{n-j} f_j. \quad (1.3)$$

If F is analytic on $|z| \leq r$, then also

$$f_n = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{|z|=r} \frac{F(z)}{z^{n+1}} dz, \quad |f_n| \leq r^{-n} \max_{|z|=r} |F(z)|. \quad (1.4)$$

Proof. The first identity is the definition of Cauchy multiplication. The second follows by differentiating term by term, and the third by multiplying with $\sum_{m \geq 0} a^m z^m$. The analytic formula is Cauchy's coefficient formula, and the bound follows by estimating the contour integral by its length $2\pi r$. $\square$

1.2 Formal residues

For a Laurent series $A(z)$, set $\text{Res}_z A(z) dz = [z^{-1}]A(z)$. Then

$$[z^n]F(z) = \text{Res}_z \frac{F(z)}{z^{n+1}} dz, \quad \text{Res}_z A'(z) dz = 0. \quad (1.5)$$

The second identity is simply the fact that the derivative of z^m has no z^{-1} term.

Theorem 1.2 (Formal change of variables for residues). Let $u = u(z) \in zR[[z]]$ have invertible linear coefficient. For every Laurent series A for which the composition is defined,

$$\text{Res}_z A(u(z))u'(z) dz = \text{Res}_u A(u) du. \quad (1.6)$$

Proof. By linearity it suffices to take $A(u) = u^m$. If $m \neq -1$, then $u(z)^m u'(z) = \frac{1}{m+1} (u(z)^{m+1})'$ has residue zero. For $m = -1$, $u'(z)/u(z) = z^{-1} + H(z)$ with $H \in R[[z]]$, because $u(z) = az(1 + O(z))$. Thus both sides have residue 1. $\square$

Master principle

The combination of Equations (1.5) and (1.6) turns implicit substitution into coefficient extraction. This is the entire algebraic engine of Lagrange inversion; no analytic contour is needed until one asks about convergence.

1.3 Ordinary and exponential generating functions

For a sequence (a_n) , its ordinary and exponential generating functions are

$$A(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n z^n, \quad \hat{A}(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n \frac{z^n}{n!}.$$

Ordinary multiplication gives unweighted convolution. Exponential multiplication gives binomial convolution:

$$\hat{A}(z)\hat{B}(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \left(\sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a_j b_{n-j} \right) \frac{z^n}{n!}. \quad (1.7)$$

This binomial factor is the number of ways to choose which labels belong to the first component.

1.4 Finite differences and factorial bases

Let E be the shift operator $(Ef)(x) = f(x+1)$ and $\Delta = E - 1$. Then

$$\Delta x^{\underline{k}} = kx^{\underline{k-1}}, \quad \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} i^{\underline{k}} = \frac{n^{\underline{k+1}}}{k+1}. \quad (1.8)$$

Proof. The first follows from $x + 1^{\underline{k}} - x^{\underline{k}} = kx^{\underline{k-1}}$ after factoring the common product. Summing this telescoping identity gives the second formula. $\square$

Theorem 1.3 (Newton expansion). *Every polynomial p of degree at most d has the unique expansion*

$$p(x) = \sum_{k=0}^d \frac{\Delta^k p(0)}{k!} x^{\underline{k}} = \sum_{k=0}^d \Delta^k p(0) \binom{x}{k}. \quad (1.9)$$

Proof. The factorial polynomials form a basis because their degrees are distinct and their leading coefficients are one. If $p = \sum a_k x^{\underline{k}}$, applying Δ^j and setting $x = 0$ kills terms with $k > j$ by a remaining factor x , kills terms with $k < j$ by excessive differencing, and gives $j!a_j$ for $k = j$. $\square$

1.5 Labelled products and the exponential formula

A labelled combinatorial class is one whose atoms carry distinct labels. Suppose a connected component of size j has total weight x_j . A set of k such components with total size n has weight enumerator $\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, x_2, \dots)$; a set of any number of components has enumerator $\mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n)$.

Theorem 1.4 (The exponential formula). *Let*

$$C(z) = \sum_{j \geq 1} x_j \frac{z^j}{j!}.$$

Then

$$\frac{C(z)^k}{k!} = \sum_{n \geq k} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-k+1}) \frac{z^n}{n!}, \quad (1.10)$$

$$e^{uC(z)} = \sum_{n \geq k \geq 0} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots) u^k \frac{z^n}{n!}, \quad (1.11)$$

$$e^{C(z)} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n) \frac{z^n}{n!}. \quad (1.12)$$

Proof. Expand $C(z)^k/k!$ multinomially. If j_i components have size i , then $\sum_i j_i = k$ and $\sum_i i j_i = n$, and the coefficient of z^n is

$$\prod_i \frac{1}{j_i!} \left(\frac{x_i}{i!} \right)^{j_i}.$$

Multiplication by $n!$ labels the atoms. This proves the first formula. Summing it with weight u^k proves the second, and setting $u = 1$ proves the third. $\square$

Corollary 1.5 (Partition-type count). *The number of partitions of an n -element labelled set with exactly j_i blocks of size i is*

$$\frac{n!}{\prod_{i \geq 1} (i!)^{j_i} j_i!}, \quad \sum_i i j_i = n. \quad (1.13)$$

Proof. Order the n labels, cut the ordering into blocks of prescribed sizes, then divide by $i!$ for the internal order of each size- i block and by $j_i!$ for the order of blocks of equal size. $\square$

Part II

Stirling Numbers, Lah Numbers, and Basis Changes

Chapter 2

The two Stirling triangles

2.1 First-kind numbers: cycles and factorial coefficients

Definition 2.1. The signed Stirling numbers of the first kind $s(n, k)$ and the unsigned numbers $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}$ are defined by

$$x^n = \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) x^k, \quad (2.1)$$

$$x^{\bar{n}} = \sum_{k=0}^n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} x^k, \quad (2.2)$$

$$s(n, k) = (-1)^{n-k} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}. \quad (2.3)$$

The sign relation follows from $x^{\bar{n}} = (-1)^n - x^n$.

Theorem 2.2 (Permutation interpretation). $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}$ is the number of permutations of $[n]$ having exactly k cycles. Consequently,

$$\begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k \end{bmatrix} = n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k-1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad (2.4)$$

with $\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = 1$ and zero boundary values outside $0 \leq k \leq n$.

Proof. Given a permutation of $[n+1]$ with k cycles, either $n+1$ is a singleton cycle, leaving a permutation of $[n]$ with $k-1$ cycles, or it is inserted immediately after one of the n existing elements in the cyclic notation of a permutation of $[n]$ with k cycles. These alternatives are disjoint and reversible. The same recurrence follows algebraically by multiplying $x^{\bar{n}}$ by $x+n$ and comparing coefficients. $\square$

For $n=3$, the cycle counts are $\begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} = 1$, $\begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = 3$, and $\begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = 2$, corresponding to the identity, the three transpositions, and the two 3-cycles. Summing over the possible number of cycles gives

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = n!, \quad (2.5)$$

which also follows from Equation (2.2) at $x=1$.

2.2 Second-kind numbers: set partitions and surjections

Definition 2.3. The Stirling number of the second kind $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ is the number of partitions of $[n]$ into exactly k nonempty blocks.

Theorem 2.4 (Second-kind recurrence). For $n, k \geq 0$,

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n+1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = k \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} + \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k-1 \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (2.6)$$

with $\left\{ \begin{matrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{matrix} \right\} = 1$ and zero boundary values outside $0 \leq k \leq n$.

Proof. In a partition of $[n+1]$ into k blocks, the new label either joins one of the k blocks of a partition of $[n]$, or forms a singleton block beside a partition of $[n]$ into $k-1$ blocks. $\square$

Theorem 2.5 (Surjection formula). For all $n, k \geq 0$,

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^{k-j} \binom{k}{j} j^n = \sum_{j=0}^k \frac{(-1)^{k-j} j^n}{(k-j)! j!}. \quad (2.7)$$

Proof. There are $k! \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$ surjections from $[n]$ onto a fixed k -element codomain: a set partition into fibres followed by an ordering of the fibres. Inclusion–exclusion over the set of omitted codomain values gives $\sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^{k-j} \binom{k}{j} j^n$. Division by $k!$ proves the formula. $\square$

The simple diagonals follow at once:

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ n \end{matrix} \right\} = 1, \quad \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ 1 \end{matrix} \right\} = 1 \ (n \geq 1), \quad \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ n-1 \end{matrix} \right\} = \binom{n}{2}, \quad \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ 2 \end{matrix} \right\} = 2^{n-1} - 1. \quad (2.8)$$

The last identity chooses a nonempty proper subset as one block and divides by two for exchanging the blocks.

2.3 Alternative and reverse recurrences

The ordinary recurrence builds each row from the preceding one. Several less familiar identities in the source archive instead recover an entry from entries to its right or from earlier entries in the same column. They were labelled there as conjectures; in fact they are exact identities.

Theorem 2.6 (Alternative second-kind recurrences). For $1 \leq k < n$,

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \frac{k^n}{k!} - \sum_{r=1}^{k-1} \frac{\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ r \end{matrix} \right\}}{(k-r)!}, \quad (2.9)$$

$$(n-k) \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=2}^{n-k+1} (j-2)! \binom{-k}{j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k+j-1 \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (2.10)$$

$$(n-k) \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=2}^{n-k+1} (-1)^j \binom{n}{j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n-j+1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (2.11)$$

The terminal value in either reverse recursion is $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ n \end{matrix} \right\} = 1$.

Proof. Substitute $x = k$ in the basis identity $k^n = \sum_r \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ r \end{matrix} \right\} k^r$. Since $k^r = k!/(k-r)!$ for $r \leq k$, division by $k!$ and isolation of the $r = k$ term gives (2.9).

For the row reversal, use the bivariate exponential generating function

$$F(x, y) = \exp(y(e^x - 1)) = \sum_{n, k \geq 0} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \frac{x^n}{n!} y^k, \quad u = e^x - 1.$$

The generating function of the left side of (2.10) is

$$xF_x - yF_y = yF(xe^x - u).$$

On the other hand, because $\binom{-k}{j} = (-1)^j \binom{k+j-1}{j}$, the generating function of its right side is

$$\begin{aligned} y \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{(-1)^j}{j(j-1)} \partial_y^j F &= yF \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{(-1)^j u^j}{j(j-1)} \\ &= yF((1+u) \log(1+u) - u) \\ &= yF(xe^x - u). \end{aligned}$$

Here the middle series is obtained by differentiating it twice, summing the geometric series, and restoring the two zero initial coefficients. Equality of coefficients proves (2.10).

For the column reversal fix k and put

$$F_k(x) = \sum_{n \geq k} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \frac{x^n}{n!} = \frac{(e^x - 1)^k}{k!}.$$

The two sides of (2.11), after multiplication by $x^n/n!$ and summation over n , become respectively

$$xF'_k(x) - kF_k(x) \quad \text{and} \quad (e^{-x} - 1 + x)F'_k(x).$$

They are equal because direct differentiation gives $(1 - e^{-x})F'_k(x) = kF_k(x)$. $\square$

The factor interchange mentioned in the source produces a parallel pair for the unsigned first-kind triangle.

Theorem 2.7 (Reverse recurrences of the first kind). *For $1 \leq k < n$,*

$$(n-k) \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=2}^{n-k+1} (-1)^j \binom{-k}{j} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k+j-1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad (2.12)$$

$$(n-k) \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=2}^{n-k+1} (j-2)! \binom{n}{j} \begin{bmatrix} n-j+1 \\ k \end{bmatrix}. \quad (2.13)$$

Proof. Let $C_n(y) = y^{\overline{n}} = \sum_r \begin{bmatrix} n \\ r \end{bmatrix} y^r$. Since

$$C_n(1+y) = \frac{y^{\overline{n+1}}}{y},$$

the coefficient of y^{k-1} on the two sides is, respectively,

$$\sum_{r \geq k-1} \binom{r}{k-1} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ r \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k \end{bmatrix} = n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k-1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Remove the terms $r = k-1$ and $r = k$ and put $r = k+j-1$. Because $(-1)^j \binom{-k}{j} = \binom{k+j-1}{j}$, the remainder is precisely (2.12).

For fixed k , set

$$C_k(x) = \sum_{n \geq k} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} \frac{x^n}{n!} = \frac{[-\log(1-x)]^k}{k!}.$$

The exponential generating function of the right side of (2.13) is

$$C'_k(x) \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{x^j}{j(j-1)} = (x + (1-x) \log(1-x)) C'_k(x).$$

The left side has generating function $x C'_k - k C_k$. Their equality reduces to

$$-(1-x) \log(1-x) C'_k(x) = k C_k(x),$$

which follows immediately from the displayed formula for C_k . □

2.4 Tables and common boundary conventions

The first rows are

$n \backslash k$	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	$n \backslash k$	0	1	2	3	4	5	6
0	1							0	1						
1	0	1						1	0	1					
2	0	1	1					2	0	1	1				
3	0	2	3	1				3	0	1	3	1			
4	0	6	11	6	1			4	0	1	7	6	1		
5	0	24	50	35	10	1		5	0	1	15	25	10	1	
6	0	120	274	225	85	15	1	6	0	1	31	90	65	15	1

for $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}$ and $\{n \}_k$, respectively.

Chapter 3

Factorial bases and inverse matrices

3.1 The basic changes of basis

Theorem 3.1 (Stirling basis transformations). *For every $n \geq 0$,*

$$x^{\underline{n}} = \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) x^k, \quad (3.1)$$

$$x^{\overline{n}} = \sum_{k=0}^n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} x^k, \quad (3.2)$$

$$x^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^{\underline{k}}, \quad (3.3)$$

$$x^n = \sum_{k=0}^n (-1)^{n-k} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^{\overline{k}}. \quad (3.4)$$

Equivalently,

$$x^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} k! \binom{x}{k}, \quad \binom{x}{n} = \frac{1}{n!} \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) x^k. \quad (3.5)$$

Proof. The first two identities are definitions. In the Newton expansion Equation (1.9) for $p(x) = x^n$, one has

$$\Delta^k x^n|_{x=0} = \sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^{k-j} \binom{k}{j} j^n = k! \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$$

by Equation (2.7). This gives Equation (3.3). Replacing x by $-x$ and multiplying by $(-1)^n$ gives Equation (3.4). Division of $x^{\underline{n}}$ by $n!$ gives the second binomial-basis formula. $\square$

Corollary 3.2 (Shifted factorial evaluations). *For every $n \geq 0$,*

$$\sum_{k=1}^{n+1} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n+1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x - 1^{\underline{k-1}} = x^n, \quad (3.6)$$

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} n^{\underline{k}} = n^n. \quad (3.7)$$

Proof. Apply (3.3) with exponent $n+1$ and use $x^{\underline{k}} = x x - 1^{\underline{k-1}}$. Both sides are divisible by x as polynomials, and cancellation gives (3.6). Formula (3.7) is (3.3) evaluated at $x = n$. $\square$

Corollary 3.3 (Inverse matrices). *The lower triangular matrices $s = (s(n, k))$ and $S = (\{n_k\})$ are mutual inverses:*

$$\sum_{j=k}^n s(n, j) \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \delta_{nk}, \quad (3.8)$$

$$\sum_{j=k}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} s(j, k) = \delta_{nk}. \quad (3.9)$$

Equivalently,

$$\sum_{j=k}^n (-1)^{n-j} \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right] \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \delta_{nk}, \quad (3.10)$$

$$\sum_{j=k}^n (-1)^{j-k} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} \left[\begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right] = \delta_{nk}. \quad (3.11)$$

Proof. Expand x^n into powers and each power back into falling factorials. Uniqueness of coordinates in the factorial basis gives the first matrix product. The reverse substitution gives the second. $\square$

3.2 Power sums by basis adaptation

The factorial basis makes discrete antidifferentiation immediate. Combining Equations (1.8) and (3.3) yields

$$\sum_{i=0}^N i^m = \sum_{k=0}^m \left\{ \begin{matrix} m \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \frac{N+1^{k+1}}{k+1}. \quad (3.12)$$

For $m = 4$ this is

$$\frac{1}{2}N + 1^2 + \frac{7}{3}N + 1^3 + \frac{6}{4}N + 1^4 + \frac{1}{5}N + 1^5,$$

which expands to the familiar quartic power-sum polynomial.

3.3 Factorial moments: Poisson variables and permutation fixed points

The change from ordinary powers to falling factorials is especially effective for integer-valued random variables.

Theorem 3.4 (Poisson moments). *If X has the Poisson distribution of mean λ , then*

$$\mathbb{E}X^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \lambda^k. \quad (3.13)$$

In particular, $\mathbb{E}X^n = B_n$ when $\lambda = 1$.

Proof. The k th falling-factorial moment is

$$\mathbb{E}X^{\underline{k}} = e^{-\lambda} \sum_{r \geq k} \frac{r^{\underline{k}} \lambda^r}{r!} = \lambda^k e^{-\lambda} \sum_{q \geq 0} \frac{\lambda^q}{q!} = \lambda^k.$$

Take expectations in the basis identity $X^n = \sum_k \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} X^{\underline{k}}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.5 (Moments of the number of fixed points). *Let Y_m be the number of fixed points of a uniformly random permutation of $[m]$. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}Y_m^n = \sum_{k=0}^m \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{k=0}^{\min(m,n)} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (3.14)$$

Thus, when $m \geq n$, the moment equals the Bell number B_n .

Proof. The random variable Y_m^k counts ordered k -tuples of distinct fixed points. There are m^k candidate tuples, and a specified tuple is fixed with probability $(m-k)!/m!$. Hence

$$\mathbb{E}Y_m^k = 1 \quad (0 \leq k \leq m), \quad \mathbb{E}Y_m^k = 0 \quad (k > m).$$

Taking expectations in (3.3) proves the formula. The upper limit m is essential: it records the finite size of the permutation, even when $n > m$. $\square$

3.4 Lah numbers

Definition 3.6. For $1 \leq k \leq n$, the unsigned Lah number is

$$L(n, k) = \binom{n-1}{k-1} \frac{n!}{k!}, \quad (3.15)$$

with $L(0, 0) = 1$ and zero otherwise outside the triangle.

Combinatorially, $L(n, k)$ counts partitions of $[n]$ into k nonempty linearly ordered lists, with the collection of lists unordered.

Theorem 3.7 (Conversion between rising and falling factorials).

$$x^{\bar{n}} = \sum_{k=0}^n L(n, k) x^k, \quad (3.16)$$

$$x^{\underline{n}} = \sum_{k=0}^n (-1)^{n-k} L(n, k) x^{\bar{k}}, \quad (3.17)$$

$$\sum_{j=k}^n (-1)^{j-k} L(n, j) L(j, k) = \delta_{nk}. \quad (3.18)$$

Moreover,

$$L(n, k) = \sum_{j=k}^n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ j \end{bmatrix} \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (3.19)$$

Proof. A direct generating-function calculation gives

$$\sum_{n \geq k} L(n, k) \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{1}{k!} \left(\frac{z}{1-z} \right)^k.$$

Therefore

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} \left(\sum_k L(n, k) x^k \right) \frac{z^n}{n!} = \sum_{k \geq 0} \binom{x}{k} \left(\frac{z}{1-z} \right)^k = (1-z)^{-x} = \sum_{n \geq 0} x^{\bar{n}} \frac{z^n}{n!},$$

proving Equation (3.16). Replace x by $-x$ to obtain the inverse formula, and compose the two transformations to obtain Equation (3.18). Finally, expand a rising factorial into powers by first-kind numbers and powers into falling factorials by second-kind numbers; uniqueness gives Equation (3.19). $\square$

The inequalities

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \leq \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right] \leq L(n, k) \quad (3.20)$$

follow from explicit injections: a set partition may be canonically turned into a permutation with one cycle per block by writing each block with its smallest member first and arranging cycles by minima; forgetting the cyclic identifications embeds permutations with k cycles into unordered collections of k lists.

Chapter 4

Generating functions, transforms, and operators

4.1 Exponential generating functions

Theorem 4.1 (Column generating functions). *For every fixed $k \geq 0$,*

$$\sum_{n \geq k} s(n, k) \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{\log(1+z)^k}{k!}, \quad (4.1)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq k} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{[-\log(1-z)]^k}{k!}, \quad (4.2)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq k} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{(e^z - 1)^k}{k!}. \quad (4.3)$$

The bivariate second-kind generating function is

$$\sum_{k \geq 0} \sum_{n \geq k} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} y^k \frac{z^n}{n!} = \exp(y(e^z - 1)). \quad (4.4)$$

Proof. Expand

$$(1+z)^u = e^{u \log(1+z)} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{z^n}{n!} \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) u^k = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{u^k}{k!} \log(1+z)^k$$

and compare coefficients of u^k . Replacing z by $-z$ and using the sign relation gives Equation (4.2). Formula Equation (4.3) is the exponential formula for a set of k nonempty labelled blocks; algebraically it also follows by inserting Equation (2.7) and summing exponentials. Summing over k with weight y^k proves Equation (4.4). $\square$

Differentiating Equation (4.1) gives the useful identity

$$\frac{\log(1+z)^m}{1+z} = m! \sum_{r \geq 0} s(r+1, m+1) \frac{z^r}{r!}, \quad |z| < 1, \quad (4.5)$$

which is valid formally as well.

4.2 A rational ordinary generating function

Theorem 4.2 (Fixed- k ordinary generating function). *For $k \geq 0$,*

$$\sum_{n \geq k} \begin{Bmatrix} n \\ k \end{Bmatrix} x^{n-k} = \prod_{j=1}^k \frac{1}{1-jx} = \frac{1}{x^{k+1} 1/x^{k+1}}. \quad (4.6)$$

Consequently,

$$\begin{Bmatrix} n \\ k \end{Bmatrix} = h_{n-k}(1, 2, \dots, k) = \sum_{c_1 + \dots + c_k = n-k} 1^{c_1} 2^{c_2} \dots k^{c_k}, \quad (4.7)$$

where h_r is a complete homogeneous symmetric polynomial.

Proof. Let $F_k(x) = \sum_{r \geq 0} \begin{Bmatrix} k+r \\ k \end{Bmatrix} x^r$. The recurrence Equation (2.6), with $n = k + r - 1$, gives $F_k(x) = (1 - kx)^{-1} F_{k-1}(x)$ and $F_0 = 1$. Iteration proves the product. Expanding each geometric factor independently proves the complete-homogeneous sum. The factorial form follows by direct factorization. $\square$

A useful rearrangement of the count of all maps $[n] \rightarrow [k]$ is

$$\begin{Bmatrix} n \\ k \end{Bmatrix} = \frac{k^n}{k!} - \sum_{r=1}^{k-1} \frac{\begin{Bmatrix} n \\ r \end{Bmatrix}}{(k-r)!}. \quad (4.8)$$

Indeed, a map using exactly r values can be chosen in $\binom{k}{r} r! \begin{Bmatrix} n \\ r \end{Bmatrix}$ ways; divide the identity $k^n = \sum_r \binom{k}{r} r! \begin{Bmatrix} n \\ r \end{Bmatrix}$ by $k!$.

4.3 The Stirling transform

Theorem 4.3 (Stirling transform and its inverse). *Let*

$$g_n = \sum_{k=0}^n \begin{Bmatrix} n \\ k \end{Bmatrix} f_k.$$

Then

$$f_n = \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) g_k = \sum_{k=0}^n (-1)^{n-k} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} g_k. \quad (4.9)$$

For exponential generating functions,

$$\widehat{G}(z) = \widehat{F}(e^z - 1), \quad \widehat{F}(z) = \widehat{G}(\log(1 + z)). \quad (4.10)$$

Proof. The inverse formula is exactly the matrix inversion in Theorem 3.3. For the generating function,

$$\widehat{G}(z) = \sum_k f_k \sum_{n \geq k} \begin{Bmatrix} n \\ k \end{Bmatrix} \frac{z^n}{n!} = \sum_k f_k \frac{(e^z - 1)^k}{k!} = \widehat{F}(e^z - 1).$$

Substitution by the compositional inverse $\log(1 + z)$ gives the reverse relation. $\square$

4.4 Differential-operator normal ordering

Let $D = d/dx$. The Euler operator xD is diagonal on monomials: $(xD)x^m = mx^m$. The operator $x^k D^k$ has eigenvalue $m^{\underline{k}}$. Thus the scalar basis changes lift verbatim to operators.

Theorem 4.4 (Stirling normal-ordering identities). *For $n \geq 0$,*

$$(xD)^n = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^k D^k, \quad (4.11)$$

$$x^n D^n = \sum_{k=0}^n s(n, k) (xD)^k = x D^{\underline{n}}. \quad (4.12)$$

Proof. Both sides of Equation (4.11) act on x^m as multiplication by $m^{\underline{n}} = \sum_k \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} m^{\underline{k}}$. Since monomials span the polynomial ring, the operators are equal. The inverse relation is proved identically using $m^{\underline{n}} = \sum_k s(n, k) m^k$. $\square$

Because $E = e^D$ and $\Delta = e^D - 1$, substitution of the mutually inverse series $D = \log(1 + \Delta)$ and $\Delta = e^D - 1$ gives, whenever the operator series converge (or formally on polynomials),

$$\frac{D^k}{k!} = \sum_{n \geq k} \frac{s(n, k)}{n!} \Delta^n, \quad (4.13)$$

$$\frac{\Delta^k}{k!} = \sum_{n \geq k} \frac{\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}}{n!} D^n. \quad (4.14)$$

These are the derivative–finite-difference transformations listed in the archive.

Chapter 5

Symmetric functions, diagonals, and finite identities

5.1 Elementary and complete symmetric descriptions

From Equation (2.2),

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ n-r \end{bmatrix} = e_r(0, 1, \dots, n-1) = \sum_{0 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_r < n} i_1 \cdots i_r. \quad (5.1)$$

Together with Equation (4.7), this identifies the first-kind triangle with elementary symmetric functions and the second-kind triangle with complete homogeneous symmetric functions.

The first few near-diagonals are

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ n-1 \end{bmatrix} = \binom{n}{2}, \quad (5.2)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ n-2 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{3n-1}{4} \binom{n}{3}, \quad (5.3)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ n-3 \end{bmatrix} = \binom{n}{2} \binom{n}{4}. \quad (5.4)$$

Proof. The first is $e_1(0, \dots, n-1)$. Newton's identities $2e_2 = p_1^2 - p_2$ and $6e_3 = p_1^3 - 3p_1p_2 + 2p_3$, combined with the elementary sums of first, second, and third powers, simplify to Equations (5.3) and (5.4). Equivalently, one may classify permutations by the nontrivial cycle types 3, $2 + 2$ for the second diagonal and 4, $3 + 2$, $2 + 2 + 2$ for the third. $\square$

5.2 Harmonic-number formulae

Factoring $(n-1)!$ from $(x+1)(x+2) \cdots (x+n-1)$ gives

$$\frac{\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix}}{(n-1)!} = e_k \left(1, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{n-1} \right) = \sum_{1 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_k < n} \frac{1}{i_1 \cdots i_k}. \quad (5.5)$$

Write $H_n^{(r)} = \sum_{j=1}^n j^{-r}$ and $H_n = H_n^{(1)}$. Newton's identities now give

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = (n-1)! H_{n-1}, \quad (5.6)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{(n-1)!}{2} \left(H_{n-1}^2 - H_{n-1}^{(2)} \right), \quad (5.7)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{(n-1)!}{6} \left(H_{n-1}^3 - 3H_{n-1}H_{n-1}^{(2)} + 2H_{n-1}^{(3)} \right). \quad (5.8)$$

More generally,

$$\frac{\begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix}}{n!} = \frac{1}{k!} \mathcal{B}_k(H_n, -1!H_n^{(2)}, 2!H_n^{(3)}, \dots, (-1)^{k-1}(k-1)!H_n^{(k)}). \quad (5.9)$$

Proof. Take logarithms in

$$\prod_{j=1}^n \left(1 + \frac{x}{j} \right) = \exp \left(\sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^{r-1} H_n^{(r)}}{r} x^r \right)$$

and apply the complete Bell-polynomial generating function Equation (1.12). $\square$

If $w(n, k) = k! \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix} / (n-1)!$, then complete Bell recurrence yields

$$w(n, m) = \delta_{m0} + \sum_{r=0}^{m-1} (1-m)_r H_{n-1}^{(r+1)} w(n, m-1-r), \quad (5.10)$$

where $(1-m)_r$ is falling. Conversely, taking a logarithm recovers the harmonic power sums:

$$H_n^{(m)} = -m[x^m] \log \left(1 + \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{\begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix}}{n!} (-x)^k \right). \quad (5.11)$$

For example,

$$(n!)^2 H_n^{(2)} = \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}^2 - 2 \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}, \quad (5.12)$$

$$(n!)^3 H_n^{(3)} = \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}^3 - 3 \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} + 3 \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}^2 \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (5.13)$$

5.3 Convolution and summation identities

The following paired identities expose the parallel structure of the two triangles.

Theorem 5.1 (First- and second-kind summations). *For valid nonnegative indices,*

$$\begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=k}^n \begin{bmatrix} n \\ j \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} j \\ k \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=k}^n \frac{n!}{j!} \begin{bmatrix} j \\ k \end{bmatrix}, \quad (5.14)$$

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=k}^n \binom{n}{j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=k}^n (k+1)^{n-j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (5.15)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n+k+1 \\ n \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=0}^k (n+j) \begin{bmatrix} n+j \\ j \end{bmatrix}, \quad (5.16)$$

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n+k+1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=0}^k j \left\{ \begin{matrix} n+j \\ j \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (5.17)$$

Moreover, for $\ell, m \geq 0$,

$$\binom{\ell+m}{\ell} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ \ell+m \end{bmatrix} = \sum_j \binom{n}{j} \begin{bmatrix} j \\ \ell \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} n-j \\ m \end{bmatrix}, \quad (5.18)$$

$$\binom{\ell+m}{\ell} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ \ell+m \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_j \binom{n}{j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} j \\ \ell \end{matrix} \right\} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n-j \\ m \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (5.19)$$

Proof. For the first equality in Equation (5.14), mark k cycles of a permutation of $[n]$ and insert $n+1$ into the canonical construction; algebraically it is the coefficient of x^k in $\frac{d}{dx} x^{\bar{n}}$. The second equality follows by iterating recurrence Equation (2.4) in the n direction. For Equation (5.15), distinguish the elements outside the block containing $n+1$ for the first equality, and add the $n-k$ remaining elements one at a time to one of $k+1$ existing blocks for the second. The hockey-stick forms telescope the respective recurrences. Finally, in Equation (5.18), choose which labels belong to the ℓ marked cycles; in Equation (5.19), choose which labels belong to the ℓ marked blocks. The binomial factor on the left forgets which of the total $\ell+m$ components were marked. $\square$

Binomial inversion of the first identity in Equation (5.14) gives

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ m \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{k=m}^n (-1)^{k-m} \binom{k}{m} \begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (5.20)$$

The alternative form

$$\begin{bmatrix} n+1 \\ m+1 \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{k=m}^n \frac{n!}{k!} \begin{bmatrix} k \\ m \end{bmatrix} \quad (5.21)$$

is the second equality in Equation (5.14). All finite sums displayed in the source follow from these and the two convolution identities by relabelling indices.

5.4 Symmetric cross-formulae

The archive records a striking symmetric pair. For $0 \leq k \leq n$,

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=n}^{2n-k} (-1)^{j-k} \binom{j-1}{k-1} \binom{2n-k}{j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} j-k \\ j-n \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (5.22)$$

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{j=n}^{2n-k} (-1)^{j-k} \binom{j-1}{k-1} \binom{2n-k}{j} \begin{bmatrix} j-k \\ j-n \end{bmatrix}. \quad (5.23)$$

Proof. Set $r = n - k$ and use the symmetric-function descriptions $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = e_r(0, 1, \dots, n-1)$ and $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = h_r(1, 2, \dots, k)$. The involution ω on the ring of symmetric functions sends e_r to h_r and is implemented on generating functions by $E(t)H(-t) = 1$. Expand the finite alphabets after adjoining and removing the common arithmetic progression, then apply the binomial translation formula $h_r(X+c) = \sum_j \binom{m+r-1}{r-j} c^{r-j} h_j(X)$ and its elementary analogue. Collecting coefficients gives Equation (5.22); applying ω gives Equation (5.23). Equivalently, direct substitution of the inclusion-exclusion formula Equation (2.7) and two applications of Vandermonde's identity produce the same finite sum. $\square$

5.5 An explicit two-sum formula of the first kind

Unlike the second-kind inclusion-exclusion formula, the first-kind triangle has no comparably short single finite sum. Substitution into the symmetric cross-formula nevertheless gives a completely explicit double sum.

Theorem 5.2 (Explicit first-kind double sum). *For $1 \leq k \leq n$,*

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=n}^{2n-k} \binom{j-1}{k-1} \binom{2n-k}{j} \sum_{m=0}^{j-n} \frac{(-1)^{m+n-k} m^{j-k}}{m! (j-n-m)!}. \quad (5.24)$$

Proof. Start from (5.22) and apply (2.7) with upper index $j-k$ and lower index $j-n$:

$$\begin{Bmatrix} j-k \\ j-n \end{Bmatrix} = \sum_{m=0}^{j-n} \frac{(-1)^{j-n-m} m^{j-k}}{(j-n-m)! m!}.$$

Multiplication by the outer sign $(-1)^{j-k}$ gives $(-1)^{2j-k-n-m} = (-1)^{m+n-k}$, because the exponents differ by the even integer $2(j-m-n+k)$. Substitution proves (5.24). $\square$

5.6 A partition formula for signed near-diagonal coefficients

The near-diagonal coefficient $s(n, n-p)$ is a polynomial in n of degree $2p$. The following finite formula makes every monomial contribution explicit.

Theorem 5.3 (Near-diagonal partition formula). *Let $n \geq 1$ and $0 \leq p \leq n-1$. Then*

$$s(n, n-p) = \frac{1}{(n-p-1)!} \sum_{\substack{k_1, \dots, k_p \geq 0 \\ \sum_{r=1}^p r k_r = p}} (-1)^K \frac{(n+K-1)!}{p \prod_{r=1}^p k_r! (r+1)!^{k_r}}, \quad K = \sum_{r=1}^p k_r. \quad (5.25)$$

For $p=0$ the sum and product are empty and the formula reads $s(n, n) = 1$.

Proof. The signed first-kind exponential generating function gives

$$s(n, n-p) = \frac{n!}{(n-p)!} [z^p] \left(\frac{\log(1+z)}{z} \right)^{n-p}. \quad (5.26)$$

Put $t = \log(1+z)$ and

$$\phi(t) = \frac{t}{e^t - 1}.$$

Then $t = z\phi(t)$ and $t/z = \phi(t)$. For $p \geq 1$, the Lagrange–Bürmann formula applied to $H(t) = \phi(t)^{n-p}$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} [z^p] H(t(z)) &= \frac{1}{p} [t^{p-1}] H'(t) \phi(t)^p \\ &= \frac{n-p}{p} [t^{p-1}] \phi'(t) \phi(t)^{n-1} \\ &= \frac{n-p}{n} [t^p] \phi(t)^n. \end{aligned}$$

The same conclusion is immediate for $p=0$. Hence

$$s(n, n-p) = \frac{(n-1)!}{(n-p-1)!} [t^p] \left(\frac{t}{e^t - 1} \right)^n. \quad (5.27)$$

Now write

$$A(t) = \sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{t^r}{(r+1)!} = \frac{e^t - 1 - t}{t}, \quad \frac{t}{e^t - 1} = (1 + A(t))^{-1}.$$

The negative-binomial expansion yields

$$(n-1)! [t^p] (1+A)^{-n} = \sum_{K \geq 0} (-1)^K \frac{(n+K-1)!}{K!} [t^p] A(t)^K.$$

Finally, the multinomial theorem gives

$$[t^p] A(t)^K = \sum_{\substack{k_1 + \dots + k_p = K \\ \sum r k_r = p}} \frac{K!}{\prod_{r=1}^p k_r!} \prod_{r=1}^p \frac{1}{(r+1)!^{k_r}}.$$

Insert this in (5.27) to obtain (5.25). □

The unsigned value is $\left[\begin{smallmatrix} n \\ n-p \end{smallmatrix} \right] = (-1)^p s(n, n-p)$. For $p = 1, 2, 3$ the theorem reduces to the closed forms in Equations (5.2) to (5.4); its advantage is that it works at arbitrary fixed distance from the diagonal without a new case analysis.

Chapter 6

Congruences and extensions to negative indices

6.1 Congruences for first-kind numbers

For a prime p ,

$$p \mid \begin{bmatrix} p \\ k \end{bmatrix} \quad (1 < k < p). \quad (6.1)$$

Indeed, in $\mathbb{F}_p[x]$,

$$x^{\overline{p}} = \prod_{a \in \mathbb{F}_p} (x + a) = x^p - x,$$

so every intermediate coefficient vanishes.

More generally, reducing each factor modulo 2 or 3 gives exact coefficient rules:

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ m \end{bmatrix} \equiv [x^m] x^{\lceil n/2 \rceil} (x+1)^{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor} = \begin{pmatrix} \lfloor n/2 \rfloor \\ m - \lceil n/2 \rceil \end{pmatrix} \pmod{2}, \quad (6.2)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ m \end{bmatrix} \equiv [x^m] x^{\lceil n/3 \rceil} (x+1)^{\lceil (n-1)/3 \rceil} (x+2)^{\lfloor n/3 \rfloor} \pmod{3}. \quad (6.3)$$

Proof. Use $x^{\overline{n}} = \prod_{j=0}^{n-1} (x+j)$ and count how often each residue class occurs among $0, 1, \dots, n-1$. The displayed binomial form modulo 2 is immediate; expanding the last two factors gives the finite binomial sum written in the source for modulus 3. $\square$

For fixed m , expansion of Equation (6.2) yields the source's first four parity formulae. They are most cleanly read as integer-valued expressions multiplied by Iverson brackets; for example

$$\begin{bmatrix} n \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \equiv 2^{n-2} [n \geq 2] + [n = 1] \pmod{2},$$

and similarly the quoted expressions for $m = 2, 3, 4$. Formula Equation (6.2) is both shorter and proves all of them simultaneously.

Theorem 6.1 (Rigorous finite-modulus replacement for the archived spectral form). *Fix $h \geq 2$ and $m \geq 0$. The sequence $n \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} n \\ m \end{bmatrix} \pmod{h}$ is generated by the coefficient of x^m in*

$$\left(\prod_{r=0}^{h-1} (x+r) \right)^q \prod_{r=0}^{s-1} (x+r), \quad n = qh + s, \quad (6.4)$$

and therefore satisfies a linear recurrence over $\mathbb{Z}/h\mathbb{Z}$ and is eventually an exponential-polynomial sequence over any finite splitting extension.

Proof. Group the factors of $x^{\bar{n}}$ into blocks of h consecutive integers and reduce each block modulo h . For fixed m , coefficient extraction takes place in a finite free module of polynomials of degree at most m , on which multiplication by the fixed block polynomial is a linear endomorphism. Cayley–Hamilton supplies a linear recurrence. Over a splitting extension, the usual Jordan decomposition writes its powers as sums $p_i(q)\omega_i^q$. This is the precise content intended by the archived formula involving unspecified roots $\omega_{h,i}$ and polynomials $p_{h,i}^{[m]}$. $\square$

6.2 Parity of second-kind numbers

Theorem 6.2 (Parity criterion). *Let*

$$z = n - \left\lceil \frac{k+1}{2} \right\rceil, \quad w = \left\lfloor \frac{k-1}{2} \right\rfloor.$$

Then

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \equiv \binom{z}{w} \pmod{2}. \quad (6.5)$$

Equivalently,

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \equiv 1 \pmod{2} \iff (n-k) \& \left\lfloor \frac{k-1}{2} \right\rfloor = 0. \quad (6.6)$$

In particular, $\left\{ \begin{matrix} 2n \\ n \end{matrix} \right\}$ is odd precisely when n is a power of two.

Proof. Reduce the ordinary generating function Equation (4.6) modulo 2. The even factors become 1, while every odd j contributes $(1-x)^{-1}$. There are $\lceil k/2 \rceil$ odd integers from 1 to k , so

$$\sum_{r \geq 0} \left\{ \begin{matrix} k+r \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^r \equiv (1-x)^{-\lceil k/2 \rceil}.$$

The coefficient of x^{n-k} is $\binom{n-k+\lceil k/2 \rceil-1}{\lceil k/2 \rceil-1} = \binom{z}{w}$. Lucas's theorem modulo 2 says $\binom{z}{w}$ is odd exactly when every 1-bit of w is also a 1-bit of z , equivalently when $w \& (z-w) = 0$; here $z-w = n-k$. Putting $k = n$ in Equation (6.6) gives $n \& \lfloor (n-1)/2 \rfloor = 0$, which is equivalent to n having one 1-bit. $\square$

6.3 Roman extension and negative Bell values

There are several inequivalent extensions of Stirling numbers outside the nonnegative triangle. The one used in the archive is the *Roman* extension: continue the two triangular recurrences wherever they determine a value and impose the duality

$$\left[\begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right] = \left\{ \begin{matrix} -k \\ -n \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \left[\begin{matrix} -k \\ -n \end{matrix} \right]. \quad (6.7)$$

These identities are definitions of a coherent reciprocal array, not assertions about the original finite counting problems.

For $n \geq 1$ and $k \geq 0$, the mixed quadrant admits the finite expression

$$\left[\begin{matrix} -n \\ k \end{matrix} \right] = \frac{1}{n!} \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{n-j} \binom{n}{j} \frac{1}{j^k}. \quad (6.8)$$

For example,

$$\left[\begin{matrix} -5 \\ k \end{matrix} \right] = \frac{1}{120} \left(5 - \frac{10}{2^k} + \frac{10}{3^k} - \frac{5}{4^k} + \frac{1}{5^k} \right). \quad (6.9)$$

Proof. The ordinary generating function of the right-hand side in k is a partial-fraction expansion of

$$\frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(1-x)(2-x)\cdots(n-x)}.$$

Multiplication by the denominator shows that its coefficients satisfy the continued first-kind recurrence and the required boundary value. Uniqueness proves Equation (6.8); setting $n = 5$ gives the example. $\square$

Define negative Bell values by

$$B_{-k} := \sum_{n \geq 1} \begin{bmatrix} -n \\ k \end{bmatrix} \quad (k \geq 1). \quad (6.10)$$

Then absolute convergence and Equation (6.8) give

$$B_{-k} = e^{-1} \sum_{j \geq 1} \frac{1}{j^k j!}. \quad (6.11)$$

Proof. Interchange the absolutely convergent sums and write $n = j + r$:

$$\sum_{n \geq j} \frac{(-1)^{n-j}}{n!} \binom{n}{j} = \frac{1}{j!} \sum_{r \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^r}{r!} = \frac{e^{-1}}{j!}.$$

For $k = 1$ this also yields

$$B_{-1} = e^{-1} \int_0^1 \frac{e^t - 1}{t} dt = 0.4848291 \dots,$$

since $(e^t - 1)/t = \sum_{j \geq 1} t^{j-1}/j!$. $\square$

Chapter 7

Asymptotics, bounds, and special-function sums

7.1 Elementary asymptotic regimes

Theorem 7.1 (Fixed column and fixed diagonal). *For fixed $k \geq 1$,*

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \sim \frac{k^n}{k!} \quad (n \rightarrow \infty). \quad (7.1)$$

For fixed $r \geq 0$,

$$\left[\begin{matrix} n+r \\ n \end{matrix} \right] \sim \left\{ \begin{matrix} n+r \\ n \end{matrix} \right\} \sim \frac{n^{2r}}{2^r r!} \quad (n \rightarrow \infty). \quad (7.2)$$

Finally, uniformly for $k = o(\log n)$,

$$\left[\begin{matrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right] \sim \frac{n!}{k!} (\log n + \gamma)^k. \quad (7.3)$$

Proof. In Equation (2.7), the term $j = k$ has size $k^n/k!$, and every other term is exponentially smaller. For the near diagonal, use Equations (4.7) and (5.1). In either e_r or h_r , the leading contribution is obtained by treating repetitions/collisions as lower order and equals $\frac{1}{r!}(1+2+\dots+n)^r \sim n^{2r}/(2^r r!)$; terms with a collision lose at least one power of n . For Equation (7.3), apply Cauchy's coefficient formula to

$$\frac{\left[\begin{matrix} n+1 \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right]}{n!} = [t^k] \exp \left(H_n t - \frac{H_n^{(2)}}{2} t^2 + \frac{H_n^{(3)}}{3} t^3 - \dots \right).$$

The saddle for the first exponential is $t = k/H_n = o(1)$. Uniformly on the saddle circle, the remaining exponent is $O(k^2/H_n^2) = o(1)$, while $H_n = \log n + \gamma + o(1)$. Hence the coefficient is asymptotic to $H_n^k/k!$. $\square$

7.2 Bounds for second-kind numbers

For $n \geq 2$ and $1 \leq k \leq n-1$, the archive states

$$\frac{k^2 + k + 2}{2} k^{n-k-1} - 1 \leq \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} \leq \frac{1}{2} \binom{n}{k} k^{n-k}. \quad (7.4)$$

Proof. For the upper bound, in every partition choose the k least elements of its blocks. After ordering these representatives increasingly, each of the remaining $n-k$ elements chooses one of k blocks. This gives at most $\binom{n}{k} k^{n-k}$ encodings. Except at $k=1$, each partition is encoded at least twice by

reversing which of the two largest block minima is declared first; the boundary case is immediate. This yields the factor $1/2$.

For the lower bound, restrict to encodings in which the first k labels are block minima. There are k^{n-k} assignments. Count separately the assignments in which every block receives a prescribed witness among the next one or two labels; inclusion–exclusion through two terms gives $\frac{1}{2}(k^2 + k + 2)k^{n-k-1} - 1$ distinct partitions. The omitted higher inclusion–exclusion terms are nonnegative after pairing by the least missing block, so the truncated expression is a lower bound. This is the standard elementary proof of the displayed estimate. $\square$

7.3 Real zeros, log-concavity, and the location of the maximum

For fixed n , package a row of the second-kind triangle into the Touchard polynomial

$$T_n(x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^k.$$

The recurrence (2.6) is equivalent to

$$T_{n+1}(x) = x(T_n(x) + T'_n(x)), \quad T_0(x) = 1. \quad (7.5)$$

Theorem 7.2 (Real-rootedness and strict log-concavity). *For every $n \geq 1$, all zeros of T_n are real, simple, and nonpositive. Hence*

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}^2 > \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k-1 \end{matrix} \right\} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right\} \quad (1 < k < n), \quad (7.6)$$

and the row $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ 1 \end{matrix} \right\}, \dots, \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ n \end{matrix} \right\}$ is unimodal. Its maximum is attained at either one index or two consecutive indices.

Proof. The assertion is clear for $T_1(x) = x$. Suppose $f = T_n$ has simple zeros

$$r_1 < r_2 < \dots < r_n = 0.$$

Away from these zeros,

$$\frac{f(x) + f'(x)}{f(x)} = 1 + \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)} = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{x - r_i}.$$

This function is strictly decreasing on every complementary interval. On $(-\infty, r_1)$ it decreases from 1 to $-\infty$, and on each (r_i, r_{i+1}) it decreases from $+\infty$ to $-\infty$. Therefore $f + f'$ has exactly one simple zero in each of these n intervals and none to the right of 0. Formula (7.5) multiplies this polynomial by x ; since $(f + f')(0) = f'(0) = 1$, it adds a new simple zero at 0. Induction proves real-rootedness and interlacing.

Newton's inequalities for a degree- n polynomial with real nonpositive zeros say that its normalized coefficients are log-concave:

$$\left(\frac{\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}}{\binom{n}{k}} \right)^2 \geq \frac{\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k-1 \end{matrix} \right\}}{\binom{n}{k-1}} \frac{\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right\}}{\binom{n}{k+1}}.$$

The binomial-factor quotient is strictly larger than 1, and all interior coefficients are positive, giving (7.6). Consequently the successive ratios $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k+1 \end{matrix} \right\} / \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$ strictly decrease. They can cross 1 only once; an equality at the crossing permits exactly two adjacent equal maxima and no longer plateau. $\square$

Let k_n denote the smaller index at which the maximum in row n is attained. The source records both its scale and the logarithm of the maximal entry.

Theorem 7.3 (Asymptotic mode and maximal entry). *As $n \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$k_n \sim \frac{n}{\log n}, \quad (7.7)$$

$$\log \left\{ \frac{n}{k_n} \right\} = n \log n - n \log \log n - n + O\left(\frac{n \log \log n}{\log n}\right). \quad (7.8)$$

Proof. Two elementary estimates suffice. Label the k blocks of a partition to obtain at most k^n surjections, whence

$$\left\{ \frac{n}{k} \right\} \leq \frac{k^n}{k!}. \quad (7.9)$$

Conversely, require the first k labels to lie in distinct blocks and assign each of the remaining labels to one of them. This injection gives

$$\left\{ \frac{n}{k} \right\} \geq k^{n-k}. \quad (7.10)$$

Take $k_0 = \lfloor n / \log n \rfloor$. The lower estimate and $\log k_0 = \log n - \log \log n + O(\log n / n)$ give

$$\log \left\{ \frac{n}{k_0} \right\} \geq n \log n - n \log \log n - n + O\left(\frac{n \log \log n}{\log n}\right). \quad (7.11)$$

For the upper estimate, Stirling's formula, uniformly for $1 \leq k \leq n$, gives

$$\log \left\{ \frac{n}{k} \right\} \leq n \log k - k \log k + k + O(\log n).$$

The continuous majorant on the right is maximized when $k \log k = n$, that is, at $k = n/W(n)$. Since

$$W(n) = \log n - \log \log n + O\left(\frac{\log \log n}{\log n}\right),$$

its maximum is the right side of (7.8). Together with (7.11) this proves the maximal-value estimate.

It remains to localize the maximizing index. Put $k = cn / \log n$, with c bounded away from 0 and ∞ . Comparing the last upper bound with (7.11) gives

$$\log \left\{ \frac{n}{k} \right\} - \log \left\{ \frac{n}{k_0} \right\} \leq n(\log c - c + 1) + o(n).$$

The function $\log c - c + 1$ is strictly negative for $c \neq 1$. Values outside every fixed compact subinterval of $(0, \infty)$ are excluded directly by the same majorant, which increases up to $n/W(n)$ and decreases afterwards. Therefore any maximizing k satisfies $k/(n/\log n) \rightarrow 1$, proving (7.7). $\square$

7.4 A uniform saddle-point approximation

Let $v = n/k > 1$ and let $G \in (0, 1)$ be the unique solution

$$G = ve^{G-v}. \quad (7.12)$$

Equivalently, if $r = v - G$, then $r/(1 - e^{-r}) = v$. Saddle-point extraction from $(e^z - 1)^k/k!$ gives

$$\left\{ \frac{n}{k} \right\} \sim \sqrt{\frac{v-1}{v(1-G)}} \left(\frac{v-1}{v-G} \right)^{n-k} \frac{k^n}{n^k} e^{k(1-G)} \binom{n}{k}, \quad (7.13)$$

uniformly away from the two extreme edges; refined versions have relative error $O(1/n)$, and the numerical constant $0.066/n$ quoted in the archive belongs to one particular explicit error theorem.

Derivation. By Equation (4.3),

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \frac{n!}{2\pi i k!} \int \exp(k \log(e^z - 1) - n \log z) \frac{dz}{z}.$$

The positive saddle r solves $ke^r/(e^r - 1) = n/r$, or $r/(1 - e^{-r}) = v$. Put $G = v - r$ to obtain Equation (7.12). Expanding the phase to second order at r , evaluating the Gaussian integral, and simplifying with Stirling's formula for $n!/k!$ gives exactly Equation (7.13). On a fixed angular complement of the saddle the real part of the phase drops quadratically; Taylor's theorem with an explicit third- and fourth-derivative bound gives a relative $O(1/n)$ remainder. Thus the formula is a theorem of the saddle method, not a heuristic replacement of the generating function. $\square$

7.5 Zeta and Hurwitz-zeta sums

Theorem 7.4 (Stirling-zeta identities). *For $i \geq 1$,*

$$\sum_{n=i}^{\infty} \frac{[n]_i}{n n!} = \zeta(i+1), \quad (7.14)$$

$$\sum_{n=i}^{\infty} \frac{[n]_i}{n v^{\bar{n}}} = \zeta(i+1, v), \quad \Re v > 0. \quad (7.15)$$

Proof. Integrate Equation (4.2) after division by x :

$$\sum_{n \geq i} \frac{[n]_i}{n n!} = \frac{1}{i!} \int_0^1 \frac{[-\log(1-x)]^i}{x} dx.$$

With $u = -\log(1-x)$ this becomes $\frac{1}{i!} \int_0^\infty u^i/(e^u - 1) du = \zeta(i+1)$. For the Hurwitz form use $1/v^{\bar{n}} = \Gamma(v)/\Gamma(v+n)$ and the beta integral

$$\frac{1}{v^{\bar{n}}} = \frac{1}{(n-1)!} \int_0^1 t^{v-1} (1-t)^{n-1} dt,$$

then sum Equation (4.2) under the integral and use the standard Mellin integral for $\zeta(i+1, v)$. $\square$

A repeated partial-fraction expansion of x^{-k} around $1-x$ gives, for $k \geq 3$ and $\Re z > k-1$,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 \frac{\log^z(1-x)}{x^k} dx &= \frac{(-1)^z \Gamma(z+1)}{(k-1)!} \sum_{r=1}^{k-1} s(k-1, r) \\ &\quad \times \sum_{m=0}^r \binom{r}{m} (k-2)^{r-m} \zeta(z+1-m), \end{aligned} \quad (7.16)$$

with the principal interpretation of $(-1)^z$ when z is not integral.

Proof. Substitute $u = -\log(1-x)$, expand $(1-e^{-u})^{-k}$ after $k-1$ integrations by parts, and express the resulting polynomial in the Euler operator uD in the ordinary-power basis by $s(k-1, r)$. Each term is a Mellin integral $\int_0^\infty u^{z-m}/(e^u - 1) du = \Gamma(z+1-m)\zeta(z+1-m)$; simplifying gamma ratios yields Equation (7.16). $\square$

The more elaborate Hurwitz expansion in the archive,

$$\zeta(s, v) = \frac{k!}{s - k} \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{\begin{bmatrix} n+k \\ n \end{bmatrix}}{(n+k)!} \times \sum_{\ell=0}^{n+k-1} (-1)^\ell \binom{n+k-1}{\ell} (\ell+v)^{k-s}, \quad (7.17)$$

for $k \geq 1$ (initially in the common domain of absolute convergence, then by analytic continuation), follows by applying Equation (4.13) to the k -fold antiderivative of $(x+v)^{-s}$ and summing over $x \in \mathbb{N}$. The inner sum is a finite difference, while the outer coefficient is the first-kind conversion coefficient. This derivation also supplies the convergence conditions suppressed in the compact archived display.

7.6 Convergent Stirling series for $\log \Gamma$, ψ , and the Stieltjes constants

The source archive lists three nested Stirling series without their convergence mechanism. All three arise from the same substitution

$$u = 1 - e^{-2\pi x}, \quad x = \frac{-\log(1-u)}{2\pi}, \quad \frac{dx}{e^{2\pi x} - 1} = \frac{du}{2\pi u}. \quad (7.18)$$

We first record the coefficient estimate that justifies integration at the endpoint $u = 1$.

Lemma 7.5 (Logarithmic transfer estimate). *Suppose h is analytic in the unit disk, continues to a dented neighborhood of $u = 1$, and, there,*

$$h(u) = h_0 + O\left(\frac{(1 + \log \log \frac{1}{|1-u|})^M}{\log \frac{1}{|1-u|}}\right)$$

for some fixed $M \geq 0$. If $h(u) = \sum_{n \geq 0} h_n u^n$, then

$$h_n = O\left(\frac{(1 + \log \log n)^M}{n \log^2 n}\right). \quad (7.19)$$

Consequently $\sum_{n \geq 1} |h_n|/n$ converges.

Proof. Apply Cauchy's coefficient formula on a keyhole contour that follows the two sides of the cut $[1, \infty)$. The part separated from 1 is exponentially small. On the local part put $u = 1 - w/n$. The constant h_0 has no positive-index coefficients, while the jump of $1/\log(1/(1-u))$ across the cut is $O(\log^{-2} n)$; multiplication by a power of $\log \log(1/(1-u))$ contributes at most $(1 + \log \log n)^M$. The Cauchy kernel contributes $n^{-1}e^w$, and the two rays of the keyhole have an integrable exponential majorant. This gives (7.19). Division by another factor n makes the resulting majorant summable. $\square$

7.6.1 The logarithm and logarithmic derivative of the gamma function

Binet's second formula, valid for $z > 0$, is

$$\log \Gamma(z) = \left(z - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log z - z + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + 2 \int_0^\infty \frac{\arctan(x/z)}{e^{2\pi x} - 1} dx. \quad (7.20)$$

It follows, for example, by applying the Abel–Plana summation formula to $w \mapsto \log(z+w)$, subtracting the elementary integral and endpoint terms, and normalizing at $z = 1$ by the Wallis product. Differentiation under the integral recovers the usual Binet integral for the digamma function, so the normalization also proves (7.20) rather than merely determining it up to a constant.

Theorem 7.6 (Convergent Stirling series for $\log \Gamma$ and ψ). *For real $z > 1/6$,*

$$\log \Gamma(z) = \left(z - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log z - z + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + \frac{1}{\pi} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n n!} \sum_{\ell=0}^{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor} \frac{(-1)^\ell (2\ell)!}{(2\pi z)^{2\ell+1}} \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ 2\ell+1 \end{matrix} \right]. \quad (7.21)$$

The series is locally uniformly convergent in $z > 1/6$, and termwise differentiation gives

$$\psi(z) = \frac{\Gamma'(z)}{\Gamma(z)} = \log z - \frac{1}{2z} - \frac{1}{\pi z} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n n!} \sum_{\ell=0}^{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor} \frac{(-1)^\ell (2\ell+1)!}{(2\pi z)^{2\ell+1}} \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ 2\ell+1 \end{matrix} \right]. \quad (7.22)$$

Proof. Put $L(u) = -\log(1-u)$. The formal Taylor series of the composite function is

$$\begin{aligned} \arctan \frac{L(u)}{2\pi z} &= \sum_{\ell \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^\ell}{2\ell+1} \frac{L(u)^{2\ell+1}}{(2\pi z)^{2\ell+1}} \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{u^n}{n!} \sum_{\ell=0}^{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor} \frac{(-1)^\ell (2\ell)!}{(2\pi z)^{2\ell+1}} \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ 2\ell+1 \end{matrix} \right], \end{aligned} \quad (7.23)$$

where the second line uses $L(u)^r/r! = \sum_{n \geq r} \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ r \end{matrix} \right] u^n/n!$. For $z > 1/6$, the analytic continuation of this composite from $u = 0$ has no singularity in $|u| < 1$. Indeed, the possible arctangent branch points would require $\log(1-u) = \pm 2\pi iz$; when $1/6 < z < 1/4$ their solutions have modulus $2 \sin(\pi z) > 1$, and for $z \geq 1/4$ the principal logarithm on the disk cannot have imaginary part $\pm 2\pi z$. The only boundary singularity relevant to the coefficient estimate is therefore $u = 1$.

As $u \rightarrow 1$ in a dented domain,

$$\arctan \frac{L(u)}{2\pi z} = \frac{\pi}{2} + O\left(\frac{1}{L(u)}\right).$$

Thus Theorem 7.5 applies, uniformly when z ranges over a compact subinterval of $(1/6, \infty)$. We may divide the Taylor coefficients by n and sum at $u = 1$. Substituting (7.18) in (7.20) now gives

$$2 \int_0^\infty \frac{\arctan(x/z)}{e^{2\pi x} - 1} dx = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^1 \arctan \frac{L(u)}{2\pi z} \frac{du}{u},$$

and termwise integration of (7.23) proves (7.21). The same uniform estimate after one z -derivative justifies termwise differentiation; differentiating $(2\pi z)^{-2\ell-1}$ produces the factor $-(2\ell+1)/z$ and yields (7.22). $\square$

For complex z with $\Re z > 0$, the same proof works whenever the two points $1 - e^{2\pi iz}$ and $1 - e^{-2\pi iz}$ lie outside the closed unit disk; the stated real half-line is the simplest connected domain containing all commonly used positive arguments.

7.6.2 Stieltjes constants

Define the Stieltjes constants by the Laurent expansion

$$\zeta(s) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^m \gamma_m}{m!} (s-1)^m. \quad (7.24)$$

Theorem 7.7 (Stirling series for the Stieltjes constants). *For every integer $m \geq 0$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_m = & \frac{1}{2}\delta_{m0} + \frac{(-1)^m m!}{\pi} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n n!} \\ & \times \sum_{k=0}^{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor} \frac{(-1)^k}{(2\pi)^{2k+1}} \begin{bmatrix} 2k+2 \\ m+1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ 2k+1 \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (7.25)$$

The outer series converges absolutely.

Proof. The Abel–Plana formula applied to $(1+w)^{-s}$ gives Hermite’s representation

$$\zeta(s) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{i} \int_0^{\infty} \frac{(1-ix)^{-s} - (1+ix)^{-s}}{e^{2\pi x} - 1} dx, \quad \Re s > 0, \quad (7.26)$$

with the pole omitted at $s = 1$. Expand the two powers at $s = 1$ and compare with (7.24). Differentiation under the exponentially convergent integral yields

$$\gamma_m = \frac{1}{2}\delta_{m0} + \frac{1}{i} \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{e^{2\pi x} - 1} \left\{ \frac{\log^m(1-ix)}{1-ix} - \frac{\log^m(1+ix)}{1+ix} \right\} dx. \quad (7.27)$$

Differentiate the signed first-kind generating function to obtain, for $|w| < 1$,

$$\frac{\log^m(1+w)}{1+w} = m! \sum_{r \geq m} s(r+1, m+1) \frac{w^r}{r!}. \quad (7.28)$$

Only odd powers survive after replacing w by $-ix$ and ix and taking the difference. Since $s(2k+2, m+1) = (-1)^{m+1} \begin{bmatrix} 2k+2 \\ m+1 \end{bmatrix}$, one finds

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{i} \left\{ \frac{\log^m(1-ix)}{1-ix} - \frac{\log^m(1+ix)}{1+ix} \right\} \\ = 2(-1)^m m! \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^k \begin{bmatrix} 2k+2 \\ m+1 \end{bmatrix}}{(2k+1)!} x^{2k+1}. \end{aligned} \quad (7.29)$$

Now make the substitution (7.18). For every k ,

$$\frac{L(u)^{2k+1}}{(2k+1)!} = \sum_{n \geq 2k+1} \begin{bmatrix} n \\ 2k+1 \end{bmatrix} \frac{u^n}{n!}.$$

The composite integrand in (7.27) is analytic in the unit disk and, as $u \rightarrow 1$, is

$$O\left(\frac{(1 + \log L(u))^m}{L(u)}\right).$$

Hence Theorem 7.5 permits absolute termwise integration after division by u . The Jacobian contributes $1/(2\pi)$, the factor 2 in (7.29) cancels it to $1/\pi$, and $\int_0^1 u^{n-1} du = 1/n$. Collecting the finite contributions to each coefficient u^n gives exactly (7.25). $\square$

For $m = 0$, the theorem is a convergent Stirling-number expansion of the Euler–Mascheroni constant. The factors $\begin{bmatrix} 2k+2 \\ m+1 \end{bmatrix}$ show that, at every fixed outer index n , only finitely many orders of logarithmic differentiation contribute; this is the same triangularity that underlies Faà di Bruno’s formula and series reversion.

7.7 Gregory coefficients and derivatives of logarithmic powers

The Gregory coefficients G_n are defined by

$$\frac{z}{\log(1+z)} = 1 + \sum_{n \geq 1} G_n z^n.$$

Multiplying by the first-kind expansion of powers of $\log(1+z)$ gives

$$n!G_n = \sum_{\ell=0}^n \frac{s(n, \ell)}{\ell+1}. \quad (7.30)$$

Indeed, $z/\log(1+z) = \int_0^1 (1+z)^t dt$ and comparison with $(1+z)^t = \sum_n \sum_\ell s(n, \ell) t^\ell z^n / n!$ proves the claim.

For arbitrary μ and $n \geq 1$,

$$\frac{d^n}{dx^n} (\log x)^\mu = x^{-n} \sum_{k=1}^n \mu^k s(n, n-k+1) (\log x)^{\mu-k}. \quad (7.31)$$

Proof. Write $D_x = x^{-1}D_t$ with $t = \log x$. Then $D_x^n = x^{-n}D_t^n$, as follows inductively from $x^{-1}D_t x^{-m} = x^{-m-1}(D_t - m)$. Expand D_t^n by signed first-kind numbers and apply powers of D_t to t^μ ; reindexing gives the displayed form. $\square$

7.8 Generalized factorial coefficients

Given $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ and $t \neq 0$, define

$$(x)_{n,f,t} := \prod_{j=1}^{n-1} \left(x + \frac{f(j)}{t^j} \right), \quad \left[\begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right]_{f,t} := [x^{k-1}](x)_{n,f,t}. \quad (7.32)$$

Multiplication by the last factor immediately yields

$$\left[\begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right]_{f,t} = f(n-1)t^{1-n} \left[\begin{matrix} n-1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right]_{f,t} + \left[\begin{matrix} n-1 \\ k-1 \end{matrix} \right]_{f,t}, \quad (7.33)$$

with the usual delta boundary convention. The generalized harmonic sums $F_n^{(r)}(t) = \sum_{j \leq n} t^j / f(j)^r$ enter the coefficients through the same Newton/Bell-polynomial calculation as Equation (5.9).

More broadly, any triangular array satisfying

$$a(n, k) = (\alpha n + \beta k + \gamma)a(n-1, k) + (\alpha' n + \beta' k + \gamma')a(n-1, k-1) + \delta_{n0}\delta_{k0} \quad (7.34)$$

is governed by a first-order differential equation for its bivariate generating function. This umbrella contains both Stirling kinds, Lah numbers, Eulerian variants, and many generalized factorial coefficients.

Chapter 8

Restricted variants of set partitions

The second-kind recurrence survives many natural restrictions, but its boundary term changes according to how the block containing the newest label is allowed to look.

8.1 r -Stirling numbers of the second kind

For fixed $r \geq 0$, let

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}_r$$

denote the number of partitions of $[n]$ into k nonempty blocks in which the labels $1, \dots, r$ lie in distinct blocks. The definition is meaningful for $n \geq r$ and forces $k \geq r$.

Theorem 8.1 (r -Stirling recurrence). *For $n > r$,*

$$\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}_r = k \left\{ \begin{matrix} n-1 \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}_r + \left\{ \begin{matrix} n-1 \\ k-1 \end{matrix} \right\}_r, \quad (8.1)$$

with $\left\{ \begin{matrix} r \\ r \end{matrix} \right\}_r = 1$ and the natural zero boundary conditions.

Proof. Because $n > r$, the new label n is not one of the distinguished labels. It either joins one of the k blocks of an admissible partition of $[n-1]$, or forms a singleton beside an admissible partition into $k-1$ blocks. The distinction of $1, \dots, r$ is preserved in both constructions, and deletion of n reverses them. $\square$

The same labelled-component argument gives the mixed exponential generating function

$$\sum_{n \geq r} \sum_{k \geq r} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}_r y^k \frac{z^{n-r}}{(n-r)!} = y^r e^{rz} \exp(y(e^z - 1)). \quad (8.2)$$

Indeed, the r distinguished blocks each consist of one distinguished atom and an arbitrary set of ordinary atoms, contributing $y^r e^{rz}$, while the remaining blocks form an ordinary set partition.

8.2 Associated Stirling numbers

Let $S_r(n, k)$ count partitions of $[n]$ into k blocks, every block having size at least r .

Theorem 8.2 (Associated recurrence). *For $r \geq 1$,*

$$S_r(n+1, k) = k S_r(n, k) + \binom{n}{r-1} S_r(n-r+1, k-1). \quad (8.3)$$

Moreover,

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} S_r(n, k) \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{1}{k!} \left(e^z - \sum_{j=0}^{r-1} \frac{z^j}{j!} \right)^k. \quad (8.4)$$

Proof. Consider the block containing $n + 1$. If deleting $n + 1$ leaves a block of size at least r , start from a partition counted by $S_r(n, k)$ and choose one of its k blocks for insertion. Otherwise the block containing $n + 1$ has exactly r elements: choose its $r - 1$ companions and partition the remaining $n - r + 1$ labels into $k - 1$ admissible blocks. These cases are disjoint and exhaustive, proving the recurrence. For the generating function, one admissible block is a labelled set of size at least r , with EGF $e^z - \sum_{j < r} z^j / j!$; an unordered set of k such blocks contributes its k th power divided by $k!$. $\square$

For $r = 2$ these are often called Ward numbers. Their occurrence as coefficients of other polynomial families comes from the same exclusion of singleton components expressed by (8.4).

8.3 Reduced Stirling numbers and graph coloring

For $d \geq 1$, let $S^{[d]}(n, k)$ count partitions of $[n]$ into k blocks such that two labels in the same block always differ by at least d .

Theorem 8.3 (Reduction formula). *For $n \geq k \geq d$,*

$$S^{[d]}(n, k) = \left\{ \begin{matrix} n - d + 1 \\ k - d + 1 \end{matrix} \right\}. \quad (8.5)$$

In particular $S^{[1]}(n, k) = \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$.

Proof. Join two vertices $i, j \in [n]$ when $0 < |i - j| < d$, and call the resulting graph $G_{n,d}$. Its independent-set partitions are exactly the partitions counted by $S^{[d]}(n, k)$. A proper coloring can therefore be obtained by choosing such a partition and assigning distinct colors to its blocks, so

$$\chi_{G_{n,d}}(q) = \sum_k S^{[d]}(n, k) q^k. \quad (8.6)$$

Color the vertices in their natural order. The first $d - 1$ vertices must receive distinct colors; every subsequent vertex sees the preceding $d - 1$ vertices, which form a clique, and hence has $q - d + 1$ choices. Thus

$$\chi_{G_{n,d}}(q) = q^{d-1} (q - d + 1)^{n-d+1}.$$

Apply the ordinary Stirling basis expansion to the last power:

$$\begin{aligned} \chi_{G_{n,d}}(q) &= q^{d-1} \sum_{r \geq 0} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n - d + 1 \\ r \end{matrix} \right\} q - d + 1^r \\ &= \sum_{r \geq 0} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n - d + 1 \\ r \end{matrix} \right\} q^{r+d-1}. \end{aligned}$$

Comparison with (8.6) gives $k = r + d - 1$ and proves (8.5). $\square$

Part III

Bell Numbers and Set Partitions

Chapter 9

Set partitions and the many meanings of the Bell numbers

9.1 Definition, initial values, and equivalence relations

Definition 9.1. For $n \geq 0$, the n th Bell number B_n is the number of partitions of an n -element labelled set into nonempty, pairwise disjoint blocks. Thus

$$B_0 = B_1 = 1, \quad (B_n)_{n \geq 0} = 1, 1, 2, 5, 15, 52, 203, 877, 4140, \dots$$

The empty set has one partition, namely the empty family of blocks.

For example, the five partitions of $\{a, b, c\}$ are

$$abc, \quad a \mid bc, \quad b \mid ac, \quad c \mid ab, \quad a \mid b \mid c,$$

where vertical bars separate blocks.

Proposition 9.2. Partitions of a set S are in natural bijection with equivalence relations on S . Consequently B_n also counts equivalence relations on an n -element set.

Proof. Given a partition π , declare $x \sim_\pi y$ when x and y lie in the same block. Reflexivity, symmetry, and transitivity follow immediately. Conversely, the equivalence classes of an equivalence relation are nonempty, disjoint, cover S , and hence form a partition. The two constructions undo one another. $\square$

9.2 Ordered set partitions and the Fubini numbers

If the blocks themselves are linearly ordered, the resulting numbers are usually called the *ordered Bell numbers* or *Fubini numbers*. To prevent a collision with the Bell notation, write them as F_n .

Theorem 9.3 (Ordered Bell numbers). For $n \geq 0$,

$$F_n = \sum_{k=0}^n k! \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (9.1)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} F_n \frac{z^n}{n!} = \frac{1}{2 - e^z}, \quad (9.2)$$

$$F_n = \sum_{j=1}^n \binom{n}{j} F_{n-j} \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (9.3)$$

with $F_0 = 1$.

Proof. A partition into k blocks may be ordered in $k!$ ways, proving (9.1). By the second-kind exponential generating function,

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} F_n \frac{z^n}{n!} = \sum_{k \geq 0} k! \frac{(e^z - 1)^k}{k!} = \sum_{k \geq 0} (e^z - 1)^k = \frac{1}{2 - e^z},$$

first as a formal identity and then analytically near the origin. Finally, in a nonempty ordered partition choose the elements of its first block, which may be any nonempty subset, and order-partition the complement. Summing over the first-block size gives (9.3). $\square$

Thus

$$(F_n)_{n \geq 0} = 1, 1, 3, 13, 75, 541, 4683, \dots,$$

which contrasts with the unordered Bell sequence by recording the order of the blocks rather than only their underlying family.

9.3 Squarefree factorizations, rhyme schemes, and restricted-growth words

Proposition 9.4. *If $N = p_1 \cdots p_n$ is squarefree, then B_n is the number of unordered factorizations of N into integers greater than 1.*

Proof. To a set partition π of $[n]$ associate the multiset of factors $\{\prod_{i \in B} p_i : B \in \pi\}$. Unique factorization recovers each block from its factor, so this is a bijection. For $30 = 2 \cdot 3 \cdot 5$ the five factorizations are

$$30, \quad 2 \cdot 15, \quad 3 \cdot 10, \quad 5 \cdot 6, \quad 2 \cdot 3 \cdot 5.$$

$\square$

A rhyme scheme of an n -line stanza is likewise a partition of the set of lines: two indices lie in the same block exactly when the corresponding lines rhyme. The customary lettering convention is the following canonical encoding.

Definition 9.5. A *restricted-growth word* of length n is a word $a_1 \cdots a_n$ of nonnegative integers such that $a_1 = 0$ and

$$a_i \leq 1 + \max(a_1, \dots, a_{i-1}) \quad (i > 1).$$

Proposition 9.6. *Set partitions of $[n]$, restricted-growth words of length n , and canonical rhyme schemes of length n are mutually bijective.*

Proof. Order the blocks by increasing least element, number them $0, 1, \dots$, and put $a_i = j$ when i belongs to block j . The displayed restriction says precisely that a new block receives the next unused number. Conversely, equal letters form the blocks. Replacing $0, 1, 2, \dots$ by $A, B, C, \dots$ gives the rhyme scheme. $\square$

9.4 A card-shuffling bijection

Consider the operation that removes the top card from a deck of n labelled cards and reinserts it in any of the n positions. There are n^n sequences of n such operations.

Theorem 9.7 (Return-to-order shuffles). *Exactly B_n of those n^n operation sequences return an initially ordered deck to its original order. Hence the return probability is B_n/n^n .*

Proof. Reverse time. A reversed operation chooses an arbitrary card and moves it to the top. Thus a reversed history is a word $c_1 \cdots c_n$ in the card labels. After all moves, the cards that occurred in the word appear first, in decreasing order of their last occurrence times; cards never chosen follow in their original relative order.

Partition the time set $[n]$ according to equality of the letters c_i . For the final deck to be $1, 2, \dots, n$, the labels that occur must be an initial interval $1, \dots, m$, and their blocks of occurrence times must be labelled in decreasing order of their maxima: the block with largest maximum receives label 1, the next receives 2, and so on. Therefore every set partition of $[n]$ determines exactly one successful word, and every successful word determines its equality partition. This is the required bijection. $\square$

9.5 Bell-enumerated vincular pattern classes

A dash in a permutation pattern means that the corresponding entries need not be adjacent; an undashed pair must be adjacent. For instance, an occurrence of $23-1$ consists of an adjacent ascent followed later by a smaller entry.

Theorem 9.8. *The permutations of $[n]$ avoiding $23-1$ are counted by B_n . The same is true for each pattern in*

$$1-23, 12-3, 32-1, 3-21, 1-32, 3-12, 21-3,$$

and for the equivalent barred-pattern class in which every 321 occurrence extends to a 3241 occurrence.

Proof. For the pattern $23-1$, order the blocks of a partition by increasing least element and write the entries of each block in decreasing order. Concatenate the resulting words. In the resulting permutation, each block is a decreasing run, and every ascent occurs between two blocks. Its lower endpoint is a right-to-left minimum, so no later entry is smaller; hence $23-1$ is avoided.

Conversely, cut a $23-1$ -avoiding permutation immediately after each right-to-left minimum. Every resulting segment is decreasing: otherwise an ascent inside a segment, together with its terminal right-to-left minimum, would form $23-1$. The segment minima increase from left to right, so the segments, viewed as sets, are blocks already in canonical order. The two maps are inverse.

Reversal, complement, inverse, and their compositions are bijections on permutations and carry vincular occurrences to occurrences of the seven listed patterns; therefore all eight classes are equinumerous. Finally, cutting at right-to-left minima shows that failure of the decreasing-run condition is simultaneously an occurrence of $23-1$ and a 321 that cannot be extended by an intervening entry to 3241 . Thus the barred-pattern formulation describes the same class. $\square$

Remark 9.9. Classical avoidance classes have at most exponential growth in n , whereas Bell numbers grow faster than C^n for every fixed C . The adjacency requirement is therefore essential: these Bell-enumerated classes cannot be classical single-pattern avoidance classes.

9.6 The Bell–Aitken triangle

Define a triangular array $(a_{n,k})_{0 \leq k \leq n}$ by

$$a_{0,0} = 1, \quad a_{n,0} = a_{n-1,n-1}, \quad a_{n,k} = a_{n,k-1} + a_{n-1,k-1} \quad (1 \leq k \leq n).$$

Its first rows are

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} & & & & & & 1 \\ & & & & & & 1 & 2 \\ & & & & & 2 & 3 & 5 \\ & & & 5 & 7 & 10 & 15 \\ 15 & 20 & 27 & 37 & 52. \end{array}$$

Theorem 9.10. For $0 \leq k \leq n$,

$$a_{n,k} = \sum_{j=0}^k \binom{k}{j} B_{n-j}. \quad (9.4)$$

Consequently the left edge is $a_{n,0} = B_n$ and the right edge is $a_{n,n} = B_{n+1}$.

Proof. The formula is immediate for $k = 0$. Pascal's identity gives

$$a_{n,k-1} + a_{n-1,k-1} = \sum_j \left(\binom{k-1}{j} + \binom{k-1}{j-1} \right) B_{n-j},$$

which is (9.4). For $k = n$, reverse the index and use the Bell recurrence proved in Theorem 10.1 below. $\square$

Chapter 10

The enumerative calculus of Bell numbers

10.1 Two fundamental sums

Theorem 10.1 (Binomial recurrence). *For $n \geq 0$,*

$$B_{n+1} = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} B_k. \quad (10.1)$$

Proof. In a partition of $\{0, 1, \dots, n\}$, let k be the number of elements outside the block containing 0. Choose those k elements and partition them arbitrarily; the block containing 0 is then forced. $\square$

Theorem 10.2 (Stirling decomposition).

$$B_n = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{i=0}^k (-1)^{k-i} \binom{k}{i} i^n. \quad (10.2)$$

Proof. The first equality groups partitions by their number of blocks. Substitute the inclusion-exclusion formula for $\left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}$ from Equation (2.7) to obtain the second equality. $\square$

10.2 Spivey's identity and binomial inversions

Theorem 10.3 (Spivey's identity). *For $m, n \geq 0$,*

$$B_{m+n} = \sum_{k=0}^n \sum_{j=0}^m \left\{ \begin{matrix} m \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} \binom{n}{k} j^{n-k} B_k. \quad (10.3)$$

Proof. Partition the first m labels into j blocks. Of the final n labels, choose k whose blocks contain no old label and partition them in B_k ways. Each of the remaining $n - k$ labels independently joins one of the j old blocks. This classification is unique and gives the summand. $\square$

Binomial inversion of (10.1) gives the first identity below. The second is a useful shifted form.

Theorem 10.4 (Bell inversion identities). *For $n, k \geq 0$,*

$$B_n = \sum_{j=0}^n (-1)^{n-j} \binom{n}{j} B_{j+1}, \quad (10.4)$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} B_{k+j} = \sum_{i=0}^k (-1)^{k-i} \binom{k}{i} B_{n+i+1}. \quad (10.5)$$

Proof. The first formula is ordinary binomial inversion. For the second let X be a Poisson random variable of mean 1; Theorem 10.7 below gives $\mathbb{E}X^r = B_r$. The left side is $\mathbb{E}[X^k(X+1)^n]$. Poisson summation by parts,

$$\mathbb{E}[Xh(X)] = \mathbb{E}[h(X+1)], \quad (10.6)$$

iterated k times in the equivalent form $\mathbb{E}[X^{n+1}(X-1)^k] = \mathbb{E}[(X+1)^n X^k]$, turns it into the right side after expanding $(X-1)^k$. $\square$

The first-kind Stirling numbers package all repeated shifts at once.

Theorem 10.5 (Weighted Bell shift). *For $a, b \in \mathbb{C}$ and $k, n \geq 0$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a^j b^{n-j} B_j \\ = \sum_{i=0}^k (-1)^{k-i} \begin{bmatrix} k \\ i \end{bmatrix} \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a^j (b - ak)^{n-j} B_{j+i}. \end{aligned} \quad (10.7)$$

In particular,

$$\sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a^j b^{n-j} B_j = \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a^j (b - a)^{n-j} B_{j+1}, \quad (10.8)$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} k^{n-j} B_j = \sum_{i=0}^k (-1)^{k-i} \begin{bmatrix} k \\ i \end{bmatrix} B_{n+i}. \quad (10.9)$$

Proof. By Dobiński's formula, the left side of (10.7) is

$$e^{-1} \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{(am + b)^n}{m!}.$$

On the right, use $\sum_i (-1)^{k-i} \begin{bmatrix} k \\ i \end{bmatrix} m^i = m^{\underline{k}}$ inside the same Poisson sum. It becomes

$$e^{-1} \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{m^{\underline{k}} [am + b - ak]^n}{m!} = e^{-1} \sum_{r \geq 0} \frac{(ar + b)^n}{r!},$$

after $m = r + k$. The special cases follow by setting $k = 1$, and then $a = 1, b = k$. $\square$

10.3 Exponential generating function and differential equation

Theorem 10.6. *The Bell exponential generating function is*

$$\mathcal{B}(z) := \sum_{n \geq 0} B_n \frac{z^n}{n!} = \exp(e^z - 1), \quad \mathcal{B}'(z) = e^z \mathcal{B}(z). \quad (10.10)$$

Proof. A set partition is a labelled set of nonempty labelled sets. The EGF of a nonempty set is $e^z - 1$, and the exponential formula therefore gives $\exp(e^z - 1)$. Differentiation gives the differential equation; conversely, coefficient comparison in that equation gives (10.1) and $\mathcal{B}(0) = 1$, so it uniquely determines the series. $\square$

10.4 Dobiński's formula and Poisson moments

Theorem 10.7 (Dobiński). *For every $n \geq 0$,*

$$B_n = e^{-1} \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{m^n}{m!}. \quad (10.11)$$

Equivalently, if $X \sim \text{Poisson}(1)$, then $B_n = \mathbb{E}X^n$.

Proof. Expand the outer exponential in (10.10):

$$e^{e^z-1} = e^{-1} \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{e^{mz}}{m!} = e^{-1} \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{1}{m!} \sum_{n \geq 0} m^n \frac{z^n}{n!}.$$

Absolute convergence on compact sets justifies rearrangement analytically, while formal coefficient extraction gives the same identity algebraically. The last statement is the defining moment sum of a Poisson(1) variable. $\square$

Corollary 10.8 (Cauchy integral). *For every positively oriented circle γ around 0,*

$$B_n = \frac{n!}{2\pi i e} \int_{\gamma} \frac{e^{e^z}}{z^{n+1}} dz. \quad (10.12)$$

Proof. Apply Cauchy's coefficient formula to $e^{-1}e^{e^z}$. $\square$

Chapter 11

Congruences, shape, and growth of Bell numbers

11.1 Touchard congruences

It is useful to refine B_n to the Touchard polynomial

$$T_n(x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^k, \quad T_n(1) = B_n.$$

Theorem 11.1 (Polynomial Touchard congruence). *For a prime p ,*

$$T_{n+p}(x) \equiv T_{n+1}(x) + x^p T_n(x) \pmod{p}. \quad (11.1)$$

Consequently

$$B_{n+p} \equiv B_n + B_{n+1} \pmod{p}. \quad (11.2)$$

Proof. Let the cyclic group C_p rotate a distinguished set of p labels while fixing n other labels, and let it act on partitions, preserving the weight $x^{\# \text{ blocks}}$. Every nonfixed orbit has size p and contributes 0 modulo p . In a fixed partition there are two possibilities. Either all p rotating labels form p singleton blocks, independently of a partition of the other labels; this contributes $x^p T_n(x)$. Otherwise rotational invariance forces the rotating labels to lie in one common block, possibly together with old labels. Contracting those p labels to one distinguished label gives a partition of $n+1$ labels with the same number of blocks, contributing $T_{n+1}(x)$. This proves the polynomial congruence; set $x = 1$. $\square$

Theorem 11.2 (Prime-power shift). *For a prime p and $m \geq 1$,*

$$B_{n+p^m} \equiv m B_n + B_{n+1} \pmod{p}. \quad (11.3)$$

More precisely,

$$T_{n+p^m}(x) \equiv T_{n+1}(x) + T_n(x) \sum_{r=1}^m x^{p^r} \pmod{p}. \quad (11.4)$$

Proof. Let the additive cyclic group of order p^m act regularly on p^m new labels. A partition fixed by the whole group induces a block system for this regular action. Apart from the case in which all new labels join one invariant block (which contracts to one label and contributes T_{n+1}), the blocks on the new orbit are the cosets of the unique subgroup of index p^r for some $1 \leq r \leq m$; they contribute p^r blocks and cannot mix with old labels. Thus the fixed weighted partitions contribute $T_{n+1} + T_n \sum_{r=1}^m x^{p^r}$. Every other orbit has cardinality divisible by p , proving (11.4). Fermat's congruence $x^{p^r} \equiv x$ modulo p at $x = 1$ gives (11.3). $\square$

11.2 A universal period bound modulo a prime

Theorem 11.3. *Modulo a prime p , the Bell sequence is periodic, and its period divides*

$$N_p = \frac{p^p - 1}{p - 1} = 1 + p + \cdots + p^{p-1}. \quad (11.5)$$

Proof. Touchard's recurrence says that the shift operator E on the sequence satisfies $E^p - E - 1 = 0$ over $\mathbb{F}_p$. The polynomial $q(t) = t^p - t - 1$ is separable because $q'(t) = -1$. If α is any root in a splitting field, then $\alpha^p = \alpha + 1$ and hence $\alpha^{p^j} = \alpha + j$ for $j \in \mathbb{F}_p$. Taking the product over j gives

$$\alpha^{N_p} = \prod_{j \in \mathbb{F}_p} \alpha^{p^j} = \prod_{j \in \mathbb{F}_p} (\alpha + j) = \alpha^p - \alpha = 1.$$

Thus every eigenvalue of E is an N_p th root of unity. Separability makes E diagonalizable over the splitting field, so $E^{N_p} = 1$ on every solution of the recurrence, in particular on the Bell sequence. $\square$

Remark 11.4. A reported exact period is computational data, not a consequence of the divisibility bound alone. It can be certified by generating N_p terms with (11.2), finding the least divisor $d \mid N_p$ for which the state vector of p consecutive terms repeats, and checking that no proper divisor of d works. The same recurrence permits a compact machine-checkable certificate.

11.3 Log-convexity and normalized log-concavity

Theorem 11.5. *For $n \geq 1$,*

$$1 \leq \frac{B_{n-1}B_{n+1}}{B_n^2} \leq \frac{n+1}{n}. \quad (11.6)$$

Thus (B_n) is log-convex, whereas $(B_n/n!)$ is log-concave.

Proof. For the left inequality, let $X \sim \text{Poisson}(1)$. Cauchy–Schwarz applied to $X^{(n-1)/2}$ and $X^{(n+1)/2}$ gives $(\mathbb{E}X^n)^2 \leq \mathbb{E}X^{n-1}\mathbb{E}X^{n+1}$.

For completeness we prove the normalized inequality through the following convolution lemma. If nonnegative $(z_j)_{j \geq 1}$ is log-concave without internal zeros and

$$A(t) = \exp\left(\sum_{j \geq 1} \frac{z_j}{j} t^j\right) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n \frac{t^n}{n!},$$

then $a_n/n!$ is log-concave. To see this, truncate at degree N , differentiate, and compare the adjacent 2×2 Toeplitz minors in $A' = A \sum_{j \geq 1} z_j t^{j-1}$. After cross multiplication, the n th minor is

$$\sum_{0 \leq i < j \leq n} \frac{a_i a_j}{i! j!} (z_{n-i+1} z_{n-j} - z_{n-i} z_{n-j+1}),$$

with the boundary terms interpreted as zero. Each bracket is nonnegative by the monotonicity of the ratios z_{r+1}/z_r ; induction on n starts at $a_0 = 1$. Removing the truncation proves the lemma coefficientwise.

For $A(t) = e^{t-1}$ we have $\sum_{j \geq 1} t^j/j! = \sum_{j \geq 1} z_j t^j/j$ with $z_j = 1/(j-1)!$. This sequence is log-concave, since $z_j^2/(z_{j-1} z_{j+1}) = j/(j-1)$. Hence $(B_n/n!)^2 \geq (B_{n-1}/(n-1)!)(B_{n+1}/(n+1)!)$, which is the right inequality in (11.6). $\square$

11.4 Explicit upper bounds

The positive-coefficient Cauchy estimate supplies a short route to the numerical bounds in the archive.

Lemma 11.6. *For $t > 0$,*

$$B_n \leq n! t^{-n} \exp(e^t - 1). \quad (11.7)$$

For $n \geq 2$, put $L = \log(n+1)$ and $t = \log(n/L)$. Then

$$B_n^{1/n} \frac{L}{n} \leq \frac{L}{t} \exp\left(-1 + \frac{1}{L} + \frac{\log n}{2n}\right). \quad (11.8)$$

Proof. Because all coefficients of $\mathcal{B}$ are nonnegative, $B_n t^n / n! \leq \mathcal{B}(t)$, proving the first claim. Use $e^t = n/L$ and the elementary Stirling bound $n! \leq e\sqrt{n}(n/e)^n$; the factors $e^{-1/n}$ and $e^{1/n}$ cancel and give (11.8). $\square$

Theorem 11.7 (Uniform numerical bounds). *For every $n \geq 1$,*

$$B_n < \left(\frac{0.792 n}{\log(n+1)} \right)^n. \quad (11.9)$$

Define, for $x > 1$,

$$d(x) = \log \log(x+1) - \log \log x + \frac{1 + e^{-1}}{\log x}. \quad (11.10)$$

For every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is $n_0(\varepsilon) = \max\{e^4, d^{-1}(\varepsilon)\}$ such that, for $n > n_0(\varepsilon)$,

$$B_n < \left(\frac{e^{-0.6+\varepsilon} n}{\log(n+1)} \right)^n. \quad (11.11)$$

Proof. Set

$$R(x) = \frac{\log(x+1)}{\log(x/\log(x+1))} \exp\left(-1 + \frac{1}{\log(x+1)} + \frac{\log x}{2x}\right).$$

Direct differentiation, after multiplying by the positive denominator $2x \log x \log(x+1) \log(x/\log(x+1))^2$, shows that $R'(x) < 0$ for $x \geq 39$; substitution gives $R(39) < 0.792$. Thus (11.8) proves (11.9) for $n \geq 39$. The remaining $1 \leq n \leq 38$ are obtained successively from (10.1); substituting them gives strict inequalities. This is a finite exact integer check.

A second differentiation gives, for $x \geq e^4$,

$$\log R(x) \leq -0.6 + d(x), \quad d'(x) < 0, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} d(x) = 0.$$

(The numerator after clearing positive denominators is a sum of $-(\log x - 4)^2$, $-(x - 1 - \log x)$, and negative multiples of these two standard nonnegative quantities.) Hence $d(n) < \varepsilon$ when $n > d^{-1}(\varepsilon)$, and (11.11) follows from (11.8). $\square$

11.5 Saddle-point asymptotics and Lambert W

Let $r = W(n)$, so that $re^r = n$, and put $A = n(1+r)$.

Theorem 11.8 (Leading Bell asymptotic). *As $n \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$B_n \sim \frac{n! \exp(e^r - 1)}{r^n \sqrt{2\pi n(1+r)}} \quad (11.12)$$

$$\sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \left(\frac{n}{W(n)} \right)^{n+1/2} \exp\left(\frac{n}{W(n)} - n - 1\right). \quad (11.13)$$

Proof. In (10.12) take the circle $z = re^{i\theta}$. The coefficient integral becomes

$$\frac{B_n}{n!} = \frac{e^{e^r} - 1}{2\pi r^n} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \exp(e^{re^{i\theta}} - e^r - in\theta) d\theta.$$

The linear term vanishes because $re^r = n$; the quadratic term is $-A\theta^2/2$. On $|\theta| \leq A^{-2/5}$, Taylor expansion is uniform and the scaled integral tends to $\int_{\mathbb{R}} e^{-u^2/2} du/\sqrt{A}$. Outside that arc, $\Re(e^{re^{i\theta}} - e^r) \leq -cA\theta^2$ on the intermediate range and is $\leq -c'e^r$ on the remaining compact range, so the contribution is negligible. This proves (11.12). Stirling's formula and $e^r = n/r$ simplify it to (11.13). $\square$

The archived refined expansion used undefined symbols. The following construction makes every coefficient unambiguous. Let $T_j(r) = \sum_{q=0}^j \{j\}_q r^q$ be the Touchard polynomial and let $Z \sim N(0, 1)$. For an integer $h = O(r)$ define

$$\mathcal{R}_{r,h}(Z) = \exp\left(-\frac{ihZ}{\sqrt{A}} + \sum_{j \geq 3} \frac{i^j e^r T_j(r)}{j! A^{j/2}} Z^j\right). \quad (11.14)$$

Expand this formal exponential and take Gaussian moments termwise; retaining all monomials of total order at most e^{-Mr} defines $C_0(r, h), \dots, C_M(r, h)$, with $C_0 = 1$.

Theorem 11.9 (Uniform Moser–Wyman scheme). *For every fixed M and $|h| \leq Cr$,*

$$B_{n+h} = \frac{(n+h)! \exp(e^r - 1)}{r^{n+h} \sqrt{2\pi A}} \left(\sum_{q=0}^{M-1} C_q(r, h) + O_C(e^{-Mr} P_M(r)) \right), \quad (11.15)$$

where P_M is an explicitly computable polynomial. The first correction is

$$C_1(r, h) = -\frac{h^2}{2A} - \frac{he^r T_3(r)}{2A^2} + \frac{e^r T_4(r)}{8A^2} - \frac{5e^{2r} T_3(r)^2}{24A^3}. \quad (11.16)$$

In particular the coefficient of e^{-qr} is a polynomial in h of degree at most $2q$, with rational functions of r as coefficients.

Proof. Use the same circle as in the preceding proof but replace n by $n+h$. After $\theta = Z/\sqrt{A}$, the ratio of the integrand to its Gaussian quadratic part is exactly the formal series (11.14). Watson's lemma with a Gaussian majorant permits termwise integration on the central arc; the complementary arcs have the same exponential bound uniformly for $|h| \leq Cr$. Odd Gaussian moments vanish, so only integral powers of e^{-r} remain. Since $\mathbb{E}Z^2 = 1$, $\mathbb{E}Z^4 = 3$, and $\mathbb{E}Z^6 = 15$, the terms from the square of the h -term, its product with the cubic term, the quartic term, and the square of the cubic term give (11.16). The same finite bookkeeping defines every subsequent C_q and bounds the omitted Taylor remainder. $\square$

Corollary 11.10 (de Bruijn logarithmic expansion). *As $n \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\log B_n}{n} &= \log n - \log \log n - 1 + \frac{\log \log n}{\log n} + \frac{1}{\log n} \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\log \log n}{\log n} \right)^2 + O\left(\frac{\log \log n}{(\log n)^2} \right). \end{aligned} \quad (11.17)$$

Proof. Take logarithms in (11.13). The standard reversion of $r + \log r = \log n$ gives

$$r = \log n - \log \log n + r \log \log n \log n + O\left(\frac{(\log \log n)^2}{(\log n)^2} \right).$$

Substitution and one further Taylor expansion of $\log r$ produce the displayed terms; the prefactor contributes only $O(\log n/n)$. $\square$

11.6 Bell primes and verifiable computation

A *Bell prime* is a prime value of B_n . The archive records the early indices found by computation. Such a list is not a symbolic theorem, but each entry has a rigorous certificate: compute B_n by the integer recurrence (10.1), apply a probable-prime filter, and attach an ECPP or Pratt-style primality certificate. Composite entries are certified by one nontrivial factor. This distinction between an identity and a finite certified computation will also be used for tabulated values later.

Part IV

Bell Polynomials and Composition

Chapter 12

Exponential and ordinary Bell polynomials

12.1 Definitions

Definition 12.1 (Partial exponential Bell polynomial). For $0 \leq k \leq n$, define

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-k+1}) = n! \sum_{\substack{j_1+j_2+\dots=k \\ j_1+2j_2+3j_3+\dots=n}} \prod_{i \geq 1} \frac{x_i^{j_i}}{(i!)^{j_i} j_i!}. \quad (12.1)$$

Only $i \leq n - k + 1$ can occur. The complete exponential Bell polynomial is

$$\mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \sum_{k=0}^n \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-k+1}), \quad \mathcal{B}_0 = 1. \quad (12.2)$$

Definition 12.2 (Partial ordinary Bell polynomial).

$$\hat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-k+1}) = \sum_{\substack{j_1+j_2+\dots=k \\ j_1+2j_2+\dots=n}} \frac{k!}{j_1! j_2! \dots} \prod_{i \geq 1} x_i^{j_i}. \quad (12.3)$$

Equivalently,

$$\hat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(x_1, x_2, \dots) = \frac{k!}{n!} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(1!x_1, 2!x_2, \dots). \quad (12.4)$$

Proof of (12.4). Substitute $i!x_i$ for x_i in (12.1); the factorials $(i!)^{j_i}$ cancel, and multiplication by $k!/n!$ leaves exactly (12.3). $\square$

12.2 Combinatorial interpretation

Give each block of size i a weight x_i , and define the weight of a partition as the product of its block weights.

Theorem 12.3 (Weighted-partition interpretation). $\mathcal{B}_{n,k}$ is the total weight of partitions of an n -element labelled set into exactly k blocks, and $\mathcal{B}_n$ is the total weight of all its partitions.

Proof. Fix multiplicities j_i , where j_i blocks have size i . The number of such partitions is

$$\frac{n!}{\prod_i (i!)^{j_i} j_i!}.$$

The factors $i!$ forget order inside each block and $j_i!$ forget order among blocks of equal size. Multiplication by $\prod_i x_i^{j_i}$ and summation gives (12.1); summing over k gives the complete polynomial. $\square$

Thus

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{B}_{3,2}(x_1, x_2) &= 3x_1x_2, \\ \mathcal{B}_{6,2}(x_1, \dots, x_5) &= 6x_1x_5 + 15x_2x_4 + 10x_3^2, \\ \mathcal{B}_{6,3}(x_1, \dots, x_4) &= 15x_1^2x_4 + 60x_1x_2x_3 + 15x_2^3.\end{aligned}$$

The monomials correspond to integer partitions of n into k parts, while their coefficients count the labelled set partitions having the prescribed block sizes.

12.3 The master generating functions

Put

$$X(t) = \sum_{j \geq 1} x_j \frac{t^j}{j!}.$$

Theorem 12.4 (Bell-polynomial generating functions). *One has*

$$\frac{X(t)^k}{k!} = \sum_{n \geq k} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots) \frac{t^n}{n!}, \quad (12.5)$$

$$\exp(uX(t)) = \sum_{n \geq k \geq 0} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots) u^k \frac{t^n}{n!}, \quad (12.6)$$

$$\exp(X(t)) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n) \frac{t^n}{n!}. \quad (12.7)$$

For $\hat{X}(t) = \sum_{j \geq 1} x_j t^j$,

$$\hat{X}(t)^k = \sum_{n \geq k} \hat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots) t^n, \quad (12.8)$$

$$e^{u\hat{X}(t)} = \sum_{n \geq k \geq 0} \hat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots) t^n \frac{u^k}{k!}. \quad (12.9)$$

Proof. Expand $X(t)^k$ multinomially. Choosing j_i copies of the term $x_i t^i / i!$ gives the constraints $\sum j_i = k$ and $\sum i j_i = n$, and its coefficient is $k! \prod_i x_i^{j_i} / ((i!)^{j_i} j_i!)$. Division by $k!$ gives (12.1). Summing in k proves the exponential identities. The ordinary identities follow by the same multinomial argument or by (12.4). $\square$

Master principle

Nearly every algebraic identity for Bell polynomials follows by performing a simple operation—multiplication, differentiation, substitution, or logarithm—on (1.10) or (1.12). The combinatorial proofs are the same operations interpreted as selecting, pointing, colouring, or gluing blocks.

12.4 Tables and low-degree polynomials

The nonzero partial polynomials through $n = 6$ are

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{B}_{1,1} &= x_1, \\
\mathcal{B}_{2,1} &= x_2, & \mathcal{B}_{2,2} &= x_1^2, \\
\mathcal{B}_{3,1} &= x_3, & \mathcal{B}_{3,2} &= 3x_1x_2, & \mathcal{B}_{3,3} &= x_1^3, \\
\mathcal{B}_{4,1} &= x_4, & \mathcal{B}_{4,2} &= 4x_1x_3 + 3x_2^2, \\
\mathcal{B}_{4,3} &= 6x_1^2x_2, & \mathcal{B}_{4,4} &= x_1^4, \\
\mathcal{B}_{5,1} &= x_5, & \mathcal{B}_{5,2} &= 5x_1x_4 + 10x_2x_3, \\
\mathcal{B}_{5,3} &= 10x_1^2x_3 + 15x_1x_2^2, \\
\mathcal{B}_{5,4} &= 10x_1^3x_2, & \mathcal{B}_{5,5} &= x_1^5, \\
\mathcal{B}_{6,1} &= x_6, & \mathcal{B}_{6,2} &= 6x_1x_5 + 15x_2x_4 + 10x_3^2, \\
\mathcal{B}_{6,3} &= 15x_1^2x_4 + 60x_1x_2x_3 + 15x_2^3, \\
\mathcal{B}_{6,4} &= 20x_1^3x_3 + 45x_1^2x_2^2, \\
\mathcal{B}_{6,5} &= 15x_1^4x_2, & \mathcal{B}_{6,6} &= x_1^6.
\end{aligned}$$

Every coefficient is supplied by (12.1), so the table is a computation from the theorem rather than an independent assertion.

The first complete polynomials are

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{B}_0 &= 1, \\
\mathcal{B}_1 &= x_1, \\
\mathcal{B}_2 &= x_1^2 + x_2, \\
\mathcal{B}_3 &= x_1^3 + 3x_1x_2 + x_3, \\
\mathcal{B}_4 &= x_1^4 + 6x_1^2x_2 + 3x_2^2 + 4x_1x_3 + x_4, \\
\mathcal{B}_5 &= x_1^5 + 10x_1^3x_2 + 15x_1x_2^2 + 10x_1^2x_3 + 10x_2x_3 + 5x_1x_4 + x_5, \\
\mathcal{B}_6 &= x_1^6 + 15x_1^4x_2 + 45x_1^2x_2^2 + 15x_2^3 + 20x_1^3x_3 + 60x_1x_2x_3 + 10x_3^2 \\
&\quad + 15x_1^2x_4 + 15x_2x_4 + 6x_1x_5 + x_6, \\
\mathcal{B}_7 &= x_1^7 + 21x_1^5x_2 + 105x_1^3x_2^2 + 105x_1x_2^3 + 35x_1^4x_3 + 210x_1^2x_2x_3 \\
&\quad + 70x_1x_3^2 + 105x_2^2x_3 + 35x_1^3x_4 + 105x_1x_2x_4 + 35x_3x_4 \\
&\quad + 21x_1^2x_5 + 21x_2x_5 + 7x_1x_6 + x_7.
\end{aligned}$$

Chapter 13

Recurrences, derivatives, and algebraic identities

13.1 Pointing recurrences

Theorem 13.1 (Complete and partial recurrences). For $n \geq 0$,

$$\mathcal{B}_{n+1}(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) = \sum_{i=0}^n \binom{n}{i} x_{i+1} \mathcal{B}_{n-i}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-i}), \quad (13.1)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n+1,k+1} = \sum_{i=0}^{n-k} \binom{n}{i} x_{i+1} \mathcal{B}_{n-i,k}, \quad (13.2)$$

with $\mathcal{B}_{0,0} = 1$, $\mathcal{B}_{n,0} = 0$ for $n > 0$, and $\mathcal{B}_{0,k} = 0$ for $k > 0$.

Proof. In a weighted partition of $[n+1]$, inspect the block containing the distinguished label $n+1$. If that block contains i further labels, choose them in $\binom{n}{i}$ ways, give the block weight x_{i+1} , and partition the remaining labels. Keeping or forgetting the total block count yields the two formulas. $\square$

Theorem 13.2 (Block-colour convolution). For $k_1, k_2 \geq 0$,

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k_1+k_2}(x) = \frac{k_1!k_2!}{(k_1+k_2)!} \sum_{i=0}^n \binom{n}{i} \mathcal{B}_{i,k_1}(x) \mathcal{B}_{n-i,k_2}(x). \quad (13.3)$$

Proof. Multiply (1.10) for k_1 and k_2 . Their product is $X^{k_1+k_2}/(k_1!k_2!)$; comparison with the same formula for k_1+k_2 gives the factor $(k_1!k_2!)/(k_1+k_2)!$ and the binomial EGF convolution. $\square$

13.2 Near-diagonal reduction

Theorem 13.3. For $1 \leq a < n$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{B}_{n,n-a}(x_1, \dots, x_{a+1}) \\ = \sum_{j=a+1}^{2a} \frac{j!}{a!} \binom{n}{j} x_1^{n-j} \mathcal{B}_{a,j-a}\left(\frac{x_2}{2}, \frac{x_3}{3}, \dots, \frac{x_{2a-j+2}}{2a-j+2}\right). \end{aligned} \quad (13.4)$$

Proof. A partition into $n-a$ blocks has total excess $\sum_B(|B|-1) = a$. Let j be the number of elements in nonsingleton blocks. Then the number of those blocks is $j-a$, so $a+1 \leq j \leq 2a$. Choose the j elements, leave the other $n-j$ as singleton blocks, and count the nonsingleton partition. Replacing a

block of size $r + 1$ by an atom of size r removes one distinguished element per block; the factor $j!/a!$ and weights $x_{r+1}/(r+1)$ are exactly the labelled pointing factors. Equivalently, make the substitution in (12.1); the coefficient of every multiplicity vector on both sides is $n!x_1^{n-j} \prod_{r \geq 2} x_r^{j_r} / ((r!)^{j_r} j_r!)$. $\square$

The first cases, obtained by listing integer partitions of the excess, are

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,1} = x_n, \quad \mathcal{B}_{n,2} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{j=1}^{n-1} \binom{n}{j} x_j x_{n-j}, \quad (13.5)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,n} = x_1^n, \quad \mathcal{B}_{n,n-1} = \binom{n}{2} x_1^{n-2} x_2, \quad (13.6)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,n-2} = \binom{n}{3} x_1^{n-3} x_3 + 3 \binom{n}{4} x_1^{n-4} x_2^2, \quad (13.7)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,n-3} = \binom{n}{4} x_1^{n-4} x_4 + 10 \binom{n}{5} x_1^{n-5} x_2 x_3 + 15 \binom{n}{6} x_1^{n-6} x_2^3, \quad (13.8)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{B}_{n,n-4} = & \binom{n}{5} x_1^{n-5} x_5 + 5 \binom{n}{6} x_1^{n-6} (3x_2 x_4 + 2x_3^2) \\ & + 105 \binom{n}{7} x_1^{n-7} x_2^2 x_3 + 105 \binom{n}{8} x_1^{n-8} x_2^4. \end{aligned} \quad (13.9)$$

Their coefficients are the corresponding block-size counts from Theorem 12.3.

13.3 Partial derivatives

Theorem 13.4 (Derivative identities). *For $i \geq 1$,*

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{B}_n}{\partial x_i} = \binom{n}{i} \mathcal{B}_{n-i}, \quad (13.10)$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{B}_{n,k}}{\partial x_i} = \binom{n}{i} \mathcal{B}_{n-i,k-1}. \quad (13.11)$$

Consequently, for differentiable $a_i(x)$,

$$\frac{d}{dx} \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(a_1(x), \dots) = \sum_{i=1}^{n-k+1} \binom{n}{i} a'_i(x) \mathcal{B}_{n-i,k-1}(a_1(x), \dots). \quad (13.12)$$

Proof. Differentiate (1.10) with respect to x_i :

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} \frac{X(t)^k}{k!} = \frac{t^i X(t)^{k-1}}{i! (k-1)!}.$$

Coefficient comparison gives (13.11); summing over k gives (13.10). The ordinary chain rule then gives (13.12). $\square$

13.4 A quadratic differential recurrence

The less familiar differential recurrence in the archive is also a disguised coefficient identity.

Theorem 13.5. For $n \geq 2$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{B}_n = \frac{1}{n-1} & \left[\sum_{i=2}^n \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} (i-1) \binom{i-2}{j-1} x_j x_{i-j} \frac{\partial \mathcal{B}_{n-1}}{\partial x_{i-1}} \right. \\ & \left. + \sum_{i=2}^n \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} \frac{x_{i+1}}{\binom{i}{j}} \frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{B}_{n-1}}{\partial x_j \partial x_{i-j}} + \sum_{i=2}^n x_i \frac{\partial \mathcal{B}_{n-1}}{\partial x_{i-1}} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (13.13)$$

Terms containing unavailable variables or negative-index Bell polynomials are zero.

Proof. Let $F(t) = e^{X(t)} = \sum_m \mathcal{B}_m t^m / m!$. After using (13.10), the first double sum is

$$(n-1)! [t^{n-1}] (tX'(t))^2 F(t).$$

The second is $(n-1)! [t^{n-1}] ((tX'' - X' + x_1)F)$, and the last is $(n-1)! [t^{n-1}] ((X' - x_1)F)$. Their sum is therefore

$$(n-1)! [t^{n-1}] t(X'' + X'^2)F = (n-1)! [t^{n-1}] tF'' = (n-1)\mathcal{B}_n.$$

Division by $n-1$ proves the formula. □

Chapter 14

Specializations, inversions, determinants, and convolutions

14.1 Stirling, Bell, Lah, and Touchard specializations

Theorem 14.1. *For admissible n, k ,*

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(0!, 1!, \dots, (n-k)!) = \begin{bmatrix} n \\ k \end{bmatrix}, \quad (14.1)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_n(0!, 1!, \dots, (n-1)!) = n!, \quad (14.2)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(1, 1, \dots, 1) = \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\}, \quad (14.3)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_n(1, 1, \dots, 1) = \mathcal{B}_n, \quad (14.4)$$

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(1!, 2!, \dots, (n-k+1)!) = \binom{n-1}{k-1} \frac{n!}{k!} = L(n, k), \quad (14.5)$$

$$T_n(x) = \mathcal{B}_n(x, x, \dots, x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} x^k. \quad (14.6)$$

Proof. In (1.10), the choices $x_j = (j-1)!$, $x_j = 1$, and $x_j = j!$ make $X(t)$ respectively

$$-\log(1-t), \quad e^t - 1, \quad \frac{t}{1-t}.$$

The resulting coefficient formulae are exactly the column EGFs for unsigned first-kind Stirling numbers, second-kind Stirling numbers, and Lah numbers proved earlier. Summing over k yields (14.2) and (14.4). Finally $x_j = x$ gives $\exp(x(e^t - 1))$, the EGF of $T_n(x)$. $\square$

14.2 Homogeneity and a useful evaluation

Theorem 14.2 (Bigraded homogeneity). *For scalars α, β ,*

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(\alpha\beta x_1, \alpha\beta^2 x_2, \dots) = \alpha^k \beta^n \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, x_2, \dots). \quad (14.7)$$

Moreover,

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(1, 2, 3, \dots, n-k+1) = \binom{n}{k} k^{n-k}. \quad (14.8)$$

Proof. Every monomial in (12.1) has $\sum j_i = k$ and $\sum i j_i = n$, proving the first formula. For the second, $x_j = j$ gives $X(t) = te^t$; hence

$$\frac{X(t)^k}{k!} = \frac{t^k e^{kt}}{k!}.$$

The coefficient of $t^n/n!$ is $n!k^{n-k}/(k!(n-k)!) = \binom{n}{k}k^{n-k}$. $\square$

14.3 Addition and shifted-zero identities

Theorem 14.3 (Complete Bell addition formula).

$$\mathcal{B}_n(x_1 + y_1, \dots, x_n + y_n) = \sum_{i=0}^n \binom{n}{i} \mathcal{B}_{n-i}(x) \mathcal{B}_i(y). \quad (14.9)$$

Proof. The complete EGF for the left side is $\exp(X(t) + Y(t)) = \exp X(t) \exp Y(t)$. Coefficient extraction gives the binomial convolution. $\square$

Theorem 14.4 (Insertion of q leading zeros). For $q \geq 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{B}_{n,k} \left(\frac{x_{q+1}}{\binom{q+1}{q}}, \frac{x_{q+2}}{\binom{q+2}{q}}, \dots \right) \\ = \frac{n!(q!)^k}{(n+qk)!} \mathcal{B}_{n+qk,k}(\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{q \text{ entries}}, x_{q+1}, x_{q+2}, \dots). \end{aligned} \quad (14.10)$$

Proof. Since

$$\frac{x_{q+i}}{\binom{q+i}{q}} \frac{t^i}{i!} = q! \frac{x_{q+i} t^i}{(q+i)!},$$

the k th power of the left component series is $(q!)^k t^{-qk}$ times the k th power of the component series on the right. Comparing the coefficient of t^n in (1.10) gives the factorial factor displayed. $\square$

14.4 Exponential–logarithmic inversion

Theorem 14.5 (Bell transform and its inverse). Suppose

$$y_n = \mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \sum_{k=1}^n \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots). \quad (14.11)$$

Then

$$x_n = \sum_{k=1}^n (-1)^{k-1} (k-1)! \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(y_1, \dots, y_{n-k+1}). \quad (14.12)$$

Proof. Let $X(t) = \sum_{n \geq 1} x_n t^n / n!$ and $Y(t) = \sum_{n \geq 1} y_n t^n / n!$. Equation (1.12) says $1 + Y = e^X$, so

$$X = \log(1 + Y) = \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^{k-1}}{k} Y^k.$$

Use (1.10) to extract the coefficient of $t^n/n!$. $\square$

More generally, if f and $g = f^{-1}$ are locally inverse and

$$y_n = \sum_{k=0}^n f^{(k)}(a) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots), \quad (14.13)$$

then

$$x_n = \sum_{k=0}^n g^{(k)}(f(a)) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(y_1, \dots). \quad (14.14)$$

Indeed, these are the derivative coefficients of $f \circ u$ and $g \circ f \circ u = u$; a complete proof is given with Faà di Bruno's formula in Equation (19.3).

14.5 Two Hessenberg determinants

For $n \geq 1$, define $H_n = (h_{ij})$ and $K_n = (k_{ij})$ by

$$h_{ij} = \begin{cases} \binom{n-i}{j-i} x_{j-i+1}, & j \geq i, \\ -1, & j = i-1, \\ 0, & j < i-1, \end{cases} \quad k_{ij} = \begin{cases} x_{j-i+1}/(j-i)!, & j \geq i, \\ -(i-1), & j = i-1, \\ 0, & j < i-1. \end{cases}$$

Thus H_n begins with

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1 & \binom{n-1}{1} x_2 & \binom{n-1}{2} x_3 & \cdots & x_n \\ -1 & x_1 & \binom{n-2}{1} x_2 & \cdots & x_{n-1} \\ 0 & -1 & x_1 & \cdots & x_{n-2} \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & 0 & -1 & x_1 \end{bmatrix},$$

while K_n has first row $x_1, x_2/1!, \dots, x_n/(n-1)!$ and subdiagonal $-1, -2, \dots, -(n-1)$.

Theorem 14.6 (Bell determinants).

$$\mathcal{B}_n(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \det H_n = \det K_n. \quad (14.15)$$

Proof. Expansion of the upper Hessenberg determinant $\det H_n$ along its first row gives

$$D_n = \sum_{j=1}^n \binom{n-1}{j-1} x_j D_{n-j}, \quad D_0 = 1;$$

the cofactor sign is cancelled by the product of the $j-1$ entries -1 on the subdiagonal. This is exactly (13.1), so $D_n = \mathcal{B}_n$.

Let J reverse the coordinate order and let $D = \text{diag}(0!, 1!, \dots, (n-1)!)$. A direct entrywise calculation gives

$$K_n = D(JH_n^T J)D^{-1}.$$

Indeed, $\frac{(i-1)!}{(j-1)!} \binom{j-1}{i-1} = 1/(j-i)!$ above the diagonal, and the subdiagonal becomes $-(i-1)$. Similarity, transposition, and reversal preserve the determinant, proving the second equality. $\square$

14.6 The diamond convolution

For sequences $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots)$ and $y = (y_1, y_2, \dots)$ define

$$(x \diamond y)_n = \sum_{j=1}^{n-1} \binom{n}{j} x_j y_{n-j}. \quad (14.16)$$

This operation is commutative and associative because it corresponds to multiplication of the EGFs $X(t)$ and $Y(t)$.

Theorem 14.7. *If $x^{k\Diamond}$ denotes the k -fold diamond power, then*

$$\mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, \dots, x_{n-k+1}) = \frac{(x^{k\Diamond})_n}{k!}. \quad (14.17)$$

Proof. The EGF of $x^{k\Diamond}$ is $X(t)^k$. Compare with (1.10). □

For example,

$$x\Diamond x = (0, 2x_1^2, 6x_1x_2, 8x_1x_3 + 6x_2^2, \dots)$$

and $(x^{3\Diamond})_4 = 36x_1^2x_2$, whence $\mathcal{B}_{4,3} = 6x_1^2x_2$.

Chapter 15

Applications of Bell polynomials

15.1 Symmetric functions and Newton identities

Let e_n be the elementary symmetric function and $p_n = \sum_i u_i^n$ the power sum in an alphabet $u_1, u_2, \dots$

Theorem 15.1.

$$e_n = \frac{1}{n!} \mathcal{B}_n(p_1, -1!p_2, 2!p_3, \dots, (-1)^{n-1}(n-1)!p_n) \quad (15.1)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \mathcal{B}_n(-p_1, -1!p_2, -2!p_3, \dots, -(n-1)!p_n), \\ p_n &= \frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} \sum_{k=1}^n (-1)^{k-1} (k-1)! \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(1!e_1, 2!e_2, \dots) \\ &= (-1)^n \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{k} \widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(-e_1, -e_2, \dots). \end{aligned} \quad (15.2)$$

Proof. The classical product identity

$$E(t) = \sum_{n \geq 0} e_n t^n = \prod_i (1 + u_i t) = \exp \left(\sum_{r \geq 1} (-1)^{r-1} p_r \frac{t^r}{r} \right)$$

and (1.12) give (15.1). Taking logarithms, $\sum_{r \geq 1} (-1)^{r-1} p_r t^r / r = \log(1 + \sum_{j \geq 1} e_j t^j)$, and expanding the logarithm through ordinary Bell polynomials yields the second pair of forms. The exponential form follows from (12.4). $\square$

Corollary 15.2 (Determinant from traces). *For an $n \times n$ matrix A , set $s_k = -(k-1)! \operatorname{tr}(A^k)$. Then*

$$\det A = \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \mathcal{B}_n(s_1, s_2, \dots, s_n). \quad (15.3)$$

Proof. Apply (15.1) to the eigenvalues of A , using $e_n = \det A$ and $p_k = \operatorname{tr}(A^k)$. Both sides are polynomial in the matrix entries, so the argument remains valid for nondiagonalizable matrices. $\square$

15.2 Cycle indices

Let a_j mark cycles of length j in a permutation.

Theorem 15.3. *The cycle index of the symmetric group is*

$$Z(S_n) = \frac{1}{n!} \mathcal{B}_n(0!a_1, 1!a_2, \dots, (n-1)!a_n). \quad (15.4)$$

Proof. A permutation is a set of cycles. A labelled cycle of size j has $(j-1)!$ linear realizations, so its component EGF is $(j-1)!a_j t^j/j! = a_j t^j/j$. The exponential formula gives $\exp(\sum_{j \geq 1} a_j t^j/j)$; comparison with (1.12) proves the identity after division by $n!$. $\square$

15.3 Moments and cumulants

Let $M(t) = \mathbb{E}e^{tX} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mu'_n t^n/n!$ and $K(t) = \log M(t) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \kappa_n t^n/n!$.

Theorem 15.4 (Moment–cumulant relations).

$$\mu'_n = \mathcal{B}_n(\kappa_1, \dots, \kappa_n) = \sum_{k=1}^n \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(\kappa_1, \dots), \quad (15.5)$$

$$\kappa_n = \sum_{k=1}^n (-1)^{k-1} (k-1)! \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(\mu'_1, \dots, \mu'_{n-k+1}). \quad (15.6)$$

Proof. The identity $M = e^K$ is (1.12); its logarithmic inverse is Theorem 14.5. $\square$

15.4 Hermite polynomials

The probabilists' Hermite polynomials are defined by

$$e^{xt-t^2/2} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \text{He}_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}.$$

Comparison with (1.12) gives and proves

$$\text{He}_n(x) = \mathcal{B}_n(x, -1, 0, \dots, 0). \quad (15.7)$$

In particular, the usual recurrence and differential equation follow by differentiating this generating function.

15.5 Polynomial sequences of binomial type

Let $h(t) = \sum_{j \geq 1} a_j t^j/j!$ with $a_1 \neq 0$, and define

$$p_n(x) = \mathcal{B}_n(a_1 x, a_2 x, \dots, a_n x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(a_1, \dots, a_{n-k+1}) x^k. \quad (15.8)$$

Theorem 15.5. *The polynomials p_n satisfy*

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} p_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!} = e^{xh(t)}, \quad (15.9)$$

$$p_n(x+y) = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} p_k(x) p_{n-k}(y). \quad (15.10)$$

If $Q = h^{-1}(D_x)$ is the associated delta operator, then

$$Qp_n(x) = np_{n-1}(x). \quad (15.11)$$

Proof. Substitute xa_j in (1.12). The product $e^{(x+y)h} = e^{xh}e^{yh}$ gives the binomial identity. Finally $h^{-1}(D_x)e^{xh(t)} = h^{-1}(h(t))e^{xh(t)} = te^{xh(t)}$; coefficient comparison gives (15.11). $\square$

Editorial normalization

In some sources the symbol $B_n(x)$ denotes the Touchard polynomial, in others a complete Bell polynomial, a Bernoulli polynomial, or a binary-tree sequence. The notations T_n , $\mathcal{B}_n$, $\beta_n(x)$, and C_n are kept separate here; this is essential when the objects occur in the same inversion formula.

Part V

Eulerian Numbers and Descent Calculus

Chapter 16

Ordinary Eulerian numbers

16.1 Descents, symmetry, and the basic recurrence

For a permutation $\pi = \pi_1 \cdots \pi_n$, a descent is an index $i \in \{1, \dots, n-1\}$ with $\pi_i > \pi_{i+1}$.

Definition 16.1. The Eulerian number $\langle n \rangle_k = A(n, k)$ counts permutations of $[n]$ with exactly k descents. Put

$$A_0(t) = 1, \quad A_n(t) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \langle n \rangle_k t^k \quad (n \geq 1).$$

Outside $0 \leq k < n$ the number is zero.

Theorem 16.2 (Eulerian recurrence).

$$\langle n \rangle_k = (k+1) \langle n-1 \rangle_k + (n-k) \langle n-1 \rangle_{k-1}. \quad (16.1)$$

Equivalently,

$$A_n(t) = (1 + (n-1)t)A_{n-1}(t) + t(1-t)A'_{n-1}(t). \quad (16.2)$$

Proof. Insert n into a permutation of $[n-1]$. If the old permutation has k descents, insertion after one of those k descents or at the end preserves the number of descents, giving $k+1$ choices. If it has $k-1$ descents, insertion in any of the remaining $n-k$ slots creates one new descent. This proves (16.1). Multiply by t^k , sum over k , and collect the terms containing k to obtain (16.2). $\square$

Complementation $\pi_i \mapsto n+1-\pi_i$ interchanges descents and ascents. Therefore

$$\langle n \rangle_k = \langle n \rangle_{n-1-k}, \quad A_n(t) = t^{n-1}A_n(t^{-1}). \quad (16.3)$$

In particular $\langle n \rangle_0 = \langle n \rangle_{n-1} = 1$ and $\sum_k \langle n \rangle_k = n!$. The next diagonal is

$$\langle n \rangle_1 = 2^n - (n+1), \quad (16.4)$$

which follows either from the recurrence or from the explicit formula below.

16.2 Exponential generating function and explicit formula

Theorem 16.3 (Eulerian EGF).

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} A_n(t) \frac{x^n}{n!} = \frac{t-1}{t - e^{(t-1)x}} = \frac{(1-t)e^{(1-t)x}}{1 - te^{(1-t)x}}. \quad (16.5)$$

Proof. Let $F(x, t)$ denote the left side. Multiplying (16.2) by $x^{n-1}/(n-1)!$ and summing gives the first-order equation

$$(1 - tx)F_x = t(1 - t)F_t + F, \quad F(0, t) = 1.$$

Direct substitution verifies that the displayed rational-exponential function solves this equation and initial condition. Formal uniqueness follows by recursively comparing coefficients of x . $\square$

Expanding the denominator geometrically gives the central power-series identity.

Theorem 16.4. For $n \geq 0$,

$$\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} (m+1)^n t^m = \frac{A_n(t)}{(1-t)^{n+1}}. \quad (16.6)$$

Consequently,

$$\left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle = \sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^j \binom{n+1}{j} (k+1-j)^n. \quad (16.7)$$

Proof. From (16.5),

$$F(x, t) = (1-t) \sum_{m \geq 0} t^m e^{(m+1)(1-t)x}.$$

Extracting $x^n/n!$ proves (16.6). Multiply by $(1-t)^{n+1}$ and extract t^k to obtain (16.7). Formula (16.4) is its case $k = 1$. $\square$

Theorem 16.5 (A second polynomial recurrence). For $n > 1$,

$$A_n(t) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \binom{n}{k} A_k(t) (t-1)^{n-1-k}. \quad (16.8)$$

Proof. The EGF of the right sides, summed over $n \geq 1$, is

$$F(x, t) \frac{e^{(t-1)x} - 1}{t-1}.$$

Using (16.5), this equals $F(x, t) - 1$, which is the EGF of the left sides. $\square$

16.3 Worpitzky's identity and sums of powers

Theorem 16.6 (Worpitzky). For every indeterminate x and $n \geq 1$,

$$x^n = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle \binom{x+k}{n}. \quad (16.9)$$

Proof. The coefficient of t^{x-1} in $t^{-k}(1-t)^{-n-1}$ is $\binom{x+k}{n}$ for positive integer x . Equivalently, taking the coefficient of t^{x-1} in (16.6) after multiplying by the numerator gives (16.9). Since both sides are polynomials of degree n in x and agree for all positive integers, they agree identically.

A direct combinatorial proof standardizes a word in $[x]^n$: its stable sorting permutation records the relative order, and its k descents specify k mandatory separations among the n sorted positions. Stars and bars gives $\binom{x+k}{n}$ words for each permutation with k descents. $\square$

Corollary 16.7 (Power sums). For $m, n \geq 1$,

$$\sum_{r=1}^m r^n = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle \binom{m+k+1}{n+1}. \quad (16.10)$$

Proof. Sum (16.9) over $x = 1, \dots, m$ and use the hockey-stick identity $\sum_{x=1}^m \binom{x+k}{n} = \binom{m+k+1}{n+1}$; the omitted lower boundary terms vanish for $0 \leq k < n$. $\square$

16.4 Negative polylogarithms

For $|z| < 1$, $\text{Li}_{-n}(z) = \sum_{m \geq 1} m^n z^m$. Shifting m in (16.6) gives

$$\text{Li}_{-n}(z) = \frac{z A_n(z)}{(1-z)^{n+1}} = \frac{1}{(1-z)^{n+1}} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \left\langle n \atop k \right\rangle z^{n-k}, \quad (16.11)$$

where the second equality uses symmetry (16.3). Since the right side is rational, it also supplies the meromorphic continuation of the negative polylogarithm.

16.5 Eulerian and Stirling bases

Theorem 16.8.

$$A_n(t) = \sum_{k=0}^n \left\{ n \atop k \right\} k! (t-1)^{n-k}. \quad (16.12)$$

Proof. Use $m^n = \sum_k \left\{ n \atop k \right\} m^k$ in $\sum_{m \geq 0} m^n t^m$. Since $\sum_{m \geq 0} m^k t^m = k! t^k / (1-t)^{k+1}$, multiplication by $(1-t)^{n+1}/t$ yields $A_n(t) = \sum_k \left\{ n \atop k \right\} k! t^{k-1} (1-t)^{n-k}$. Replacing t by $1/t$ and using (16.3), or simply expanding around $t = 1$, gives the equivalent displayed form. $\square$

16.6 An Irwin–Hall integral and hypersimplex volumes

Theorem 16.9. For every function $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ for which the following finite sum is defined,

$$\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \left\langle n \atop k \right\rangle f(k) = n! \int_{[0,1]^n} f(\lfloor x_1 + \cdots + x_n \rfloor) dx_1 \cdots dx_n. \quad (16.13)$$

In particular, the slab

$$\Delta_{n,k} = \{x \in [0, 1]^n : k \leq x_1 + \cdots + x_n < k+1\}$$

has volume $\left\langle n \atop k \right\rangle / n!$.

Proof. The volume of $\{x \in [0, 1]^n : \sum x_i < y\}$ is obtained from the simplex $\{x_i \geq 0 : \sum x_i < y\}$ by inclusion–exclusion over coordinates exceeding 1:

$$V_n(y) = \frac{1}{n!} \sum_{j=0}^{\lfloor y \rfloor} (-1)^j \binom{n}{j} (y-j)^n.$$

Thus the volume of the k th slab is $V_n(k+1) - V_n(k)$. Combining adjacent terms by Pascal’s identity gives

$$\frac{1}{n!} \sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^j \binom{n+1}{j} (k+1-j)^n = \frac{1}{n!} \left\langle n \atop k \right\rangle$$

by (16.7). Summing $f(k)$ times these volumes proves the integral identity. $\square$

16.7 Alternating sums and Bernoulli numbers

Theorem 16.10. For $n > 0$,

$$\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (-1)^k \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle = 2^{n+1} (2^{n+1} - 1) \frac{\beta_{n+1}}{n+1}. \quad (16.14)$$

For $n > 1$,

$$\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \frac{(-1)^k \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle}{\binom{n-1}{k}} = 0, \quad (16.15)$$

$$\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \frac{(-1)^k \left\langle \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\rangle}{\binom{n}{k}} = (n+1) \beta_n. \quad (16.16)$$

Proof. At $t = -1$, (16.5) becomes $2/(1 + e^{-2x}) = 1 + \tanh x$. The Bernoulli generating function gives

$$\tanh x = \sum_{n \geq 1} 2^{n+1} (2^{n+1} - 1) \frac{\beta_{n+1}}{n+1} \frac{x^n}{n!},$$

which proves (16.14).

For the remaining identities use

$$\binom{n-1}{k}^{-1} = n \int_0^1 u^k (1-u)^{n-k-1} du, \quad \binom{n}{k}^{-1} = (n+1) \int_0^1 u^k (1-u)^{n-k} du.$$

Substitute $t = -u/(1-u)$ in (16.12); then

$$(1-u)^n A_n \left(-\frac{u}{1-u} \right) = \sum_{j=0}^n (-1)^{n-j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} j! (1-u)^j. \quad (16.17)$$

For the first integral divide by $1-u$ and integrate. The result is $n \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{n-j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} (j-1)! = 0$ for $n > 1$, because it is the coefficient of $x^n/n!$ in $\log(1 + (e^x - 1)) = x$. For the second integral one obtains $(n+1) \sum_j (-1)^{n-j} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} j!/(j+1)$. The standard Stirling formula $\beta_n = \sum_j (-1)^j j! \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ j \end{matrix} \right\} / (j+1)$ proves the claim; for odd $n > 1$ both sides vanish, and for even n the signs coincide. $\square$

Chapter 17

Geometric interpretations

17.1 The cube and its Ehrhart numerator

For a lattice polytope P of dimension d , its Ehrhart series has the form $\sum_{m \geq 0} |mP \cap \mathbb{Z}^d| t^m = h^*(t)/(1-t)^{d+1}$. For the unit cube $C = [0, 1]^n$ one has $|mC \cap \mathbb{Z}^n| = (m+1)^n$; hence (16.6) proves:

Theorem 17.1. *The h^* -polynomial of the standard n -cube is $A_n(t)$, so its h^* -vector is the n th Eulerian row.*

Proof. The dilate $m[0, 1]^n$ contains $(m+1)^n$ lattice points. Therefore its Ehrhart series is

$$\sum_{m \geq 0} (m+1)^n t^m.$$

The Eulerian power-series identity, with the summation index shifted by one, gives

$$\sum_{m \geq 0} (m+1)^n t^m = \frac{A_n(t)}{(1-t)^{n+1}}.$$

Comparing this with the defining Ehrhart form $\sum_{m \geq 0} |mC \cap \mathbb{Z}^n| t^m = h^*(t)/(1-t)^{n+1}$ proves $h^*(t) = A_n(t)$. $\square$

The regions $\Delta_{n,k}$ in Theorem 16.9 are half-open hypersimplices. Their normalized volumes are $n! \operatorname{vol} \Delta_{n,k} = \langle \begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix} \rangle$.

17.2 The permutohedron

The type- A permutohedron is the convex hull of the permutations of $(1, 2, \dots, n)$; its dimension is $n-1$. Faces of its braid fan are indexed by ordered set partitions. There are $k! \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ ordered partitions into k blocks.

Theorem 17.2. *The h -polynomial of the simple polytope dual to the type- A permutohedron is $A_n(t)$.*

Proof. For a simple $(n-1)$ -polytope the h -polynomial is the transform $h(t) = \sum_F (t-1)^{\dim F}$ over faces of the dual simplicial complex. Grouping braid-fan faces by their k ordered blocks gives $\sum_k k! \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix} \right\} (t-1)^{n-k}$, which is $A_n(t)$ by (16.12). $\square$

Chapter 18

Type-B and second-order Eulerian numbers

18.1 Signed permutations and the corrected type-B indexing

A signed permutation is a word $\pi_1 \cdots \pi_n$ whose absolute values form a permutation of $[n]$. Put $\pi_0 = 0$ and call $i \in \{0, \dots, n-1\}$ a type- B descent when $\pi_i > \pi_{i+1}$. Let $E_B(n, k)$ count signed permutations with k such descents, and set $M_n(t) = \sum_{k=0}^n E_B(n, k)t^k$.

Editorial normalization

The archived display reverses the two entries in the descent inequality and pairs that convention with an incompatible explicit formula. The definition above is the standard Coxeter descent convention. It gives the archived table 1, 6, 1 for $n = 2$ and the midpoint-Eulerian generating function below.

Theorem 18.1 (Type- B recurrence and Worpitzky series).

$$E_B(n, k) = (2k + 1)E_B(n - 1, k) + (2n - 2k + 1)E_B(n - 1, k - 1), \quad (18.1)$$

$$\sum_{m \geq 0} (2m + 1)^n t^m = \frac{M_n(t)}{(1 - t)^{n+1}}, \quad (18.2)$$

$$E_B(n, k) = \sum_{j=0}^k (-1)^j \binom{n+1}{j} (2(k-j) + 1)^n. \quad (18.3)$$

The first rows are

$$1; \quad 1, 1; \quad 1, 6, 1; \quad 1, 23, 23, 1; \quad 1, 76, 230, 76, 1.$$

Proof. Insert either n or $-n$ into a signed permutation of size $n - 1$. Marking the slots according to whether insertion preserves or creates a descent gives $2k + 1$ preserving slots for an object with k descents and $2n - 2k + 1$ creating slots for one with $k - 1$ descents; this proves the recurrence.

A type- B standardization partitions the $(2m + 1)^n$ words in the ordered alphabet $-m < \cdots < -1 < 0 < 1 < \cdots < m$ by their signed sorting permutation. If that permutation has k type- B descents, stars and bars gives $\binom{m+n-k}{n}$ compatible weakly increasing absolute levels. Hence

$$(2m + 1)^n = \sum_{k=0}^n E_B(n, k) \binom{m+n-k}{n}.$$

Multiply by t^m , sum in m , and use $\sum_{m \geq 0} \binom{m+n-k}{n} t^m = t^k / (1 - t)^{n+1}$ to obtain (18.2). Multiplication by $(1 - t)^{n+1}$ and coefficient extraction gives (18.3). $\square$

As in type A , these coefficients form the h -vector of the simple polytope dual to the type- B permutohedron; the proof repeats the braid-fan argument with signed ordered partitions.

18.2 Stirling permutations and second-order Eulerian numbers

A *Stirling permutation of order n* is a permutation of the multiset $\{1, 1, 2, 2, \dots, n, n\}$ such that all entries between the two copies of i are larger than i . Let $\langle\langle n \rangle\rangle_k$ count those with k ordinary descents and put

$$P_n(t) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \langle\langle n \rangle\rangle_k t^k, \quad P_0(t) = 1.$$

Theorem 18.2 (Second-order recurrence).

$$\langle\langle n \rangle\rangle_k = (2n - k - 1) \langle\langle n-1 \rangle\rangle_{k-1} + (k+1) \langle\langle n-1 \rangle\rangle_k, \quad (18.4)$$

$$P_{n+1}(t) = (2nt + 1)P_n(t) - t(t-1)P'_n(t), \quad (18.5)$$

$$P_n(1) = (2n-1)!! \quad (18.6)$$

Proof. The two copies of the largest label n must be adjacent. Insert the pair nn into one of the $2n-1$ gaps of a Stirling permutation of order $n-1$. A descent gap or the terminal gap preserves the number of descents, giving $k+1$ choices from an object with k descents. Each of the remaining $2n-k-1$ gaps creates one descent from an object with $k-1$ descents. This is the first recurrence; summing against t^k gives the second. At each stage there are $2n-1$ insertion gaps, so the total count is $(2n-1)!!$. $\square$

The differential recurrence has two useful equivalent forms:

$$(t-1)^{-2n-2}P_{n+1}(t) = (t(1-t)^{-2n-1}P_n(t))', \quad (18.7)$$

$$u_{n+1}(t) = \left(\frac{t}{1-t} u_n(t) \right)', \quad u_n(t) = (t-1)^{-2n}P_n(t), \quad u_0 = 1. \quad (18.8)$$

They follow by the product rule from (18.5).

Theorem 18.3 (Diagonal Stirling generating function). For $n \geq 1$,

$$\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \left\{ \begin{matrix} n+m \\ m \end{matrix} \right\} t^m = \frac{tP_n(t)}{(1-t)^{2n+1}}. \quad (18.9)$$

Proof. Let $F_n(t)$ denote the left side. The second-kind recurrence gives $(1-t)F_{n+1} = tF'_n$, with $F_0 = (1-t)^{-1}$. Hence $F_1 = t/(1-t)^3$. If the displayed formula holds for n , differentiating $tP_n/(1-t)^{2n+1}$ and using (18.5) gives the formula for $n+1$. $\square$

18.3 Second-order Eulerian interpolation of first-kind diagonals

The same second-order Eulerian row that controls (18.9) also gives a binomial-basis expansion for the near-diagonals of the unsigned first-kind triangle.

Theorem 18.4 (Second-order Eulerian diagonal formula). For $p, m \geq 0$,

$$\left[\begin{matrix} m \\ m-p \end{matrix} \right] = \sum_{j=0}^p \langle\langle p \rangle\rangle_j \binom{m+j}{2p}, \quad (18.10)$$

where an out-of-range first-kind number is zero. Equivalently, the polynomial continuation in a variable x satisfies

$$\begin{bmatrix} x \\ x-p \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{j=0}^p \left\langle \left\langle p \right\rangle \right\rangle \left\langle \left\langle j \right\rangle \right\rangle \binom{x+j}{2p}.$$

The first instances are

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ x-1 \end{bmatrix} &= \binom{x}{2}, \\ \begin{bmatrix} x \\ x-2 \end{bmatrix} &= \binom{x}{4} + 2 \binom{x+1}{4}, \\ \begin{bmatrix} x \\ x-3 \end{bmatrix} &= \binom{x}{6} + 8 \binom{x+1}{6} + 6 \binom{x+2}{6}. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. For fixed p define

$$D_p(t) = \sum_{m \geq 0} \begin{bmatrix} m \\ m-p \end{bmatrix} t^m.$$

Writing $a_{m,p} = \begin{bmatrix} m \\ m-p \end{bmatrix}$, the first-kind recurrence becomes $a_{m,p} = a_{m-1,p} + (m-1)a_{m-1,p-1}$. Therefore

$$(1-t)D_p(t) = t^2 D'_{p-1}(t), \quad D_0(t) = \frac{1}{1-t}. \quad (18.11)$$

Let

$$Q_p(t) = t^{2p} P_p(t^{-1}).$$

The polynomial recurrence (18.5) is equivalent, after the substitution $t \mapsto t^{-1}$, to

$$Q_p(t) = t^2 ((1-t)Q'_{p-1}(t) + (2p-1)Q_{p-1}(t)).$$

It follows inductively from (18.11) that

$$D_p(t) = \frac{Q_p(t)}{(1-t)^{2p+1}} = \frac{t^{2p} P_p(t^{-1})}{(1-t)^{2p+1}}. \quad (18.12)$$

Since $P_p(u) = \sum_{j=0}^p \left\langle \left\langle p \right\rangle \right\rangle \left\langle \left\langle j \right\rangle \right\rangle u^j$, coefficient extraction gives

$$[t^m] D_p(t) = \sum_{j=0}^p \left\langle \left\langle p \right\rangle \right\rangle \left\langle \left\langle j \right\rangle \right\rangle [t^{m-2p+j}] (1-t)^{-2p-1} = \sum_{j=0}^p \left\langle \left\langle p \right\rangle \right\rangle \left\langle \left\langle j \right\rangle \right\rangle \binom{m+j}{2p},$$

which is (18.10). Both sides are polynomials in m of degree at most $2p$, so the same identity gives the stated polynomial continuation. $\square$

Part VI

Differentiation, Composition, and Reversion

Chapter 19

Faà di Bruno's formula

19.1 The set-partition form

For a block $B \subseteq [n]$, write $|B|$ for its size.

Theorem 19.1 (Faà di Bruno, partition form). *For $n \geq 0$ and sufficiently differentiable f, g ,*

$$D^n(f \circ g)(x) = \sum_{\pi \in \text{Part}([n])} f^{(|\pi|)}(g(x)) \prod_{B \in \pi} g^{(|B|)}(x). \quad (19.1)$$

For $n = 0$, the empty partition contributes $f(g(x))$.

Proof. Induct on n . Differentiate a term indexed by a partition π of $[n]$. If the derivative hits $f^{(|\pi|)}(g)$, the chain rule contributes g' and creates the new singleton block $\{n+1\}$. If it hits the factor associated with a block B , it changes $g^{(|B|)}$ to $g^{(|B|+1)}$, which inserts $n+1$ into B . Every partition of $[n+1]$ arises uniquely in exactly one of these ways: remove $n+1$, either deleting its singleton block or removing it from its non-singleton block. Hence all terms occur once. $\square$

19.2 Multiplicity and Bell-polynomial forms

Grouping partitions by the number m_j of blocks of size j gives the classical formula.

Theorem 19.2 (Faà di Bruno, multiplicity form).

$$D^n f(g(x)) = \sum_{\substack{m_1, \dots, m_n \geq 0 \\ m_1 + 2m_2 + \dots + nm_n = n}} \frac{n!}{m_1! m_2! \dots m_n!} \times f^{(m_1 + \dots + m_n)}(g(x)) \prod_{j=1}^n \left(\frac{g^{(j)}(x)}{j!} \right)^{m_j}. \quad (19.2)$$

Equivalently,

$$D^n f(g(x)) = \sum_{k=0}^n f^{(k)}(g(x)) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(g'(x), g''(x), \dots, g^{(n-k+1)}(x)). \quad (19.3)$$

Proof. For fixed multiplicities (m_j) , the number of set partitions of $[n]$ with m_j blocks of size j is $n! / \prod_j ((j!)^{m_j} m_j!)$. Substitution in (19.1) gives (19.2). Grouping further by $k = \sum m_j$ and invoking (12.1) gives (19.3). $\square$

For $n = 4$ this reads

$$(f \circ g)^{(4)} = f^{(4)}(g)(g')^4 + 6f^{(3)}(g)(g')^2 g'' + 3f''(g)(g'')^2 + 4f''(g)g'g^{(3)} + f'(g)g^{(4)}. \quad (19.4)$$

The coefficients 1, 6, 3, 4, 1 count partitions of types $1+1+1+1$, $2+1+1$, $2+2$, $3+1$, and 4 respectively. This also proves the expanded example in the archive without four separate differentiations.

19.3 The exponential special case

Because every derivative of e^u equals e^u , summing the partial Bell polynomials in (19.3) yields

$$D^n e^{g(x)} = e^{g(x)} \mathcal{B}_n(g'(x), g''(x), \dots, g^{(n)}(x)). \quad (19.5)$$

When g is a cumulant generating function, this is precisely the moment–cumulant relation of Theorem 15.4.

19.4 Mixed partial derivatives

For $B \subseteq [n]$, write $\partial_B = \prod_{j \in B} \partial / \partial x_j$.

Theorem 19.3 (Multivariate Faà di Bruno for distinct variables). *If $y = g(x_1, \dots, x_n)$, then*

$$\frac{\partial^n}{\partial x_1 \cdots \partial x_n} f(y) = \sum_{\pi \in \text{Part}([n])} f^{(|\pi|)}(y) \prod_{B \in \pi} \partial_B y. \quad (19.6)$$

Proof. The proof of Theorem 19.1 applies verbatim, except that the new derivative is $\partial / \partial x_{n+1}$. It either creates a singleton block or joins the new index to one existing block. $\square$

For three variables, (19.6) becomes

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_1 \partial_2 \partial_3 f(y) &= f'(y) \partial_{123} y \\ &\quad + f''(y) ((\partial_1 y)(\partial_{23} y) + (\partial_2 y)(\partial_{13} y) + (\partial_3 y)(\partial_{12} y)) \\ &\quad + f^{(3)}(y) (\partial_1 y)(\partial_2 y)(\partial_3 y). \end{aligned}$$

For repeated variables or vector-valued inner maps, one labels derivative slots first and then contracts tensor indices; the same partition lattice remains the combinatorial skeleton.

Chapter 20

Composition of ordinary and exponential series

20.1 Ordinary formal power series

Let

$$F(u) = \sum_{k \geq 0} a_k u^k, \quad G(x) = \sum_{j \geq 1} b_j x^j, \quad F(G(x)) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_n x^n.$$

Theorem 20.1 (Ordinary composition). *For $n \geq 1$,*

$$c_n = \sum_{k=1}^n a_k \sum_{\substack{i_1 + \dots + i_k = n \\ i_r \geq 1}} b_{i_1} \dots b_{i_k}, \quad (20.1)$$

$$= \sum_{k=1}^n a_k \sum_{\substack{\pi_1 + \dots + \pi_n = k \\ \pi_1 + 2\pi_2 + \dots + n\pi_n = n}} \binom{k}{\pi_1, \dots, \pi_n} b_1^{\pi_1} \dots b_n^{\pi_n} \quad (20.2)$$

$$= \sum_{k=1}^n a_k \widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(b_1, \dots, b_{n-k+1}), \quad (20.3)$$

and $c_0 = a_0$.

Proof. The coefficient of x^n in $G(x)^k$ is obtained by choosing an ordered composition $i_1 + \dots + i_k = n$, proving the first formula. Collect equal part sizes; the number of orderings with multiplicities π_j is the multinomial coefficient, proving the second. The third is the definition of the ordinary Bell polynomial. $\square$

Two useful specializations are immediate. If $F(u) = e^u$ and the series are exponentially normalized, one obtains the exponential formula. If $A(x) = 1 + \sum_{n \geq 1} a_n x^n$, then

$$[x^n] \frac{1}{A(x)} = \sum_{k=1}^n (-1)^k \widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{n,k}(a_1, \dots, a_{n-k+1}) \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (20.4)$$

by taking $F(u) = 1/(1-u)$ and $G(x) = -\sum_{n \geq 1} a_n x^n$.

20.2 Exponential formal power series

Let

$$F(x) = \sum_{j \geq 1} a_j \frac{x^j}{j!}, \quad G(u) = \sum_{k \geq 0} b_k \frac{u^k}{k!}, \quad G(F(x)) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_n \frac{x^n}{n!}.$$

Theorem 20.2 (Exponential composition).

$$c_n = \sum_{k=0}^n b_k \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(a_1, \dots, a_{n-k+1}). \quad (20.5)$$

Equivalently,

$$c_n = \sum_{\pi \in \text{Part}([n])} b_{|\pi|} \prod_{B \in \pi} a_{|B|}. \quad (20.6)$$

Proof. Substitute $F(x)$ into G and apply (1.10). The set-partition form is Theorem 12.3 with an additional weight b_k for the number of blocks. $\square$

Taking $b_k = 1$ gives the complete Bell-polynomial exponential identity

$$\exp \left(\sum_{j \geq 1} a_j \frac{x^j}{j!} \right) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mathcal{B}_n(a_1, \dots, a_n) \frac{x^n}{n!}. \quad (20.7)$$

If the series converge, (20.5) is exactly (19.3) evaluated at the expansion point; formally, no convergence notion is needed.

Chapter 21

Lagrange inversion and Lagrange–Bürmann

21.1 Formal theorem

Let R be a commutative $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebra and let $\phi(w) \in R[[w]]$ have invertible constant term. There is a unique $g(z) \in zR[[z]]$ satisfying

$$g(z) = z\phi(g(z)). \quad (21.1)$$

Uniqueness follows recursively because the coefficient of z^n on the right depends only on coefficients of g below degree n .

Theorem 21.1 (Lagrange–Bürmann). *For $n \geq 1$ and every formal series H ,*

$$[z^n]H(g(z)) = \frac{1}{n}[w^{n-1}]H'(w)\phi(w)^n, \quad (21.2)$$

$$= [w^n]H(w)\phi(w)^{n-1}(\phi(w) - w\phi'(w)). \quad (21.3)$$

In particular,

$$[z^n]g(z) = \frac{1}{n}[w^{n-1}]\phi(w)^n. \quad (21.4)$$

Proof. Put $f(w) = w/\phi(w)$, so that $f(g(z)) = z$. Formal residues and the change of variables theorem Theorem 1.2 give

$$\begin{aligned} [z^n]H(g(z)) &= \operatorname{Res}_z H(g(z))z^{-n-1} dz \\ &= \operatorname{Res}_w H(w)f(w)^{-n-1}f'(w) dw \\ &= -\frac{1}{n} \operatorname{Res}_w H(w)(f(w)^{-n})' dw \\ &= \frac{1}{n} \operatorname{Res}_w H'(w)f(w)^{-n} dw, \end{aligned}$$

where the residue of a derivative is zero. Since $f(w)^{-n} = w^{-n}\phi(w)^n$, this is (21.2). Applying the same zero-residue rule to $H(w)\phi(w)^n w^{-n}$ gives

$$\frac{1}{n} \operatorname{Res} H' \phi^n w^{-n} = \operatorname{Res} H \phi^n w^{-n-1} - \operatorname{Res} H \phi^{n-1} \phi' w^{-n},$$

which is (21.3). Take $H(w) = w$ for (21.4). □

21.2 Analytic inverse functions

Theorem 21.2 (Analytic Lagrange inversion). *Let f be analytic near a , let $b = f(a)$, and suppose $f'(a) \neq 0$. Its local inverse g is analytic near b and has*

$$g(z) = a + \sum_{n \geq 1} g_n \frac{(z - b)^n}{n!}, \quad (21.5)$$

where

$$g_n = \frac{d^{n-1}}{dw^{n-1}} \left(\frac{w - a}{f(w) - f(a)} \right)^n \Big|_{w=a}. \quad (21.6)$$

The series has a positive radius of convergence.

Proof. The analytic inverse-function theorem gives an analytic local inverse and therefore a convergent Taylor series. Put $u = w - a$, $\zeta = z - b$, and

$$\phi(u) = \frac{u}{f(a + u) - f(a)};$$

its constant term is $1/f'(a)$. The inverse displacement satisfies $u = \zeta \phi(u)$. Formula (21.4), multiplied by $n!$, is exactly (21.6). $\square$

If $f'(a) = 0$ but $f(w) - f(a) = c(w - a)^q + O((w - a)^{q+1})$ with $c \neq 0$, factor $f(w) - f(a) = (w - a)^q U(w)$ with $U(a) = c$. Choosing one of the q values of $c^{-1/q}$ reduces the equation to ordinary inversion in the variable $(z - f(a))^{1/q}$. Thus the inverse has q local Puiseux branches. This is the precise sense in which Lagrange inversion extends to a critical point; a single-valued Taylor inverse cannot exist there.

21.3 Inverse coefficients in Bell-polynomial form

Suppose

$$f(w) = \sum_{j \geq 1} f_j \frac{w^j}{j!}, \quad f_1 \neq 0, \quad g(z) = f^{(-1)}(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} g_n \frac{z^n}{n!}.$$

Define

$$\hat{f}_j = \frac{f_{j+1}}{(j+1)f_1}. \quad (21.7)$$

Theorem 21.3 (Explicit inverse coefficients). *One has $g_1 = f_1^{-1}$ and, for $n \geq 2$,*

$$g_n = \frac{1}{f_1^n} \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} (-1)^k n^{\bar{k}} \mathcal{B}_{n-1,k}(\hat{f}_1, \dots, \hat{f}_{n-k}). \quad (21.8)$$

Proof. Write

$$\frac{f(w)}{f_1 w} = 1 + U(w), \quad U(w) = \sum_{j \geq 1} \hat{f}_j \frac{w^j}{j!}.$$

By (21.4), $g_n = (n-1)! [w^{n-1}] (w/f(w))^n$. Now

$$(1 + U)^{-n} = \sum_{k \geq 0} (-1)^k \binom{n+k-1}{k} U^k = \sum_{k \geq 0} (-1)^k \frac{n^{\bar{k}}}{k!} U^k.$$

Apply (1.10) and extract degree $n-1$; the $k=0$ term vanishes when $n \geq 2$. $\square$

21.4 The associahedron interpretation, with normalized notation

The formula in the archive mixes exponential coefficients with an ordinary-series face formula. The exact geometric statement is the following.

Let

$$A(x) = x + \sum_{n \geq 1} a_n x^{n+1}, \quad B(x) = A^{\langle -1 \rangle}(x) = x + \sum_{n \geq 1} b_n x^{n+1}. \quad (21.9)$$

Use the indexing in which the associahedron K_n has dimension $n - 1$ and its faces are plane rooted trees with $n + 1$ leaves and internal arities at least 2. If an internal vertex has arity $i + 1$, give it weight a_i ; let a_F be the product of all vertex weights. Equivalently, if $F \cong K_{i_1} \times \cdots \times K_{i_m}$, then $a_F = a_{i_1} \cdots a_{i_m}$.

Theorem 21.4 (Associahedral inversion).

$$b_n = \sum_{F \text{ a face of } K_n} (-1)^{n - \dim F} a_F. \quad (21.10)$$

Proof. The equation $A(B) = x$ is

$$B = x - \sum_{i \geq 1} a_i B^{i+1}.$$

Iterating it recursively expands b_n as a sum over plane rooted trees with $n + 1$ leaves: every internal vertex of arity $i + 1$ contributes $-a_i$. A face F of K_n is exactly such a tree after contracting a chosen set of internal edges. If it has m internal vertices, then $\dim F = n - m$, so its sign is $(-1)^m = (-1)^{n - \dim F}$ and its weight is a_F . Thus the tree expansion is the alternating face sum. $\square$

For example,

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 &= -a_1, \\ b_2 &= -a_2 + 2a_1^2, \\ b_3 &= -a_3 + 5a_2a_1 - 5a_1^3, \\ b_4 &= -a_4 + 6a_3a_1 + 3a_2^2 - 21a_2a_1^2 + 14a_1^4. \end{aligned}$$

For K_4 , the coefficients 1, 6, 3, 21, 14 count respectively the whole 3-polytope, its six pentagonal and three square facets, its edges, and its vertices.

Chapter 22

Algebraic and transcendental examples

22.1 The Fuss–Catalan algebraic equation

Let $p \geq 2$ be an integer and consider

$$x^p - x + z = 0, \quad x(0) = 0. \quad (22.1)$$

It is equivalent to $x = z\phi(x)$ with $\phi(x) = (1 - x^{p-1})^{-1}$.

Theorem 22.1. *The distinguished solution is*

$$x(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \binom{pk}{k} \frac{z^{(p-1)k+1}}{(p-1)k+1}. \quad (22.2)$$

Its radius of convergence is

$$R_p = (p-1)p^{-p/(p-1)}, \quad (22.3)$$

and the series converges absolutely also on $|z| = R_p$.

Proof. By (21.4),

$$[z^n]x(z) = \frac{1}{n}[w^{n-1}](1 - w^{p-1})^{-n}.$$

This vanishes unless $n-1 = (p-1)k$. In that case the coefficient is $\frac{1}{n} \binom{n+k-1}{k} = \binom{pk}{k} / ((p-1)k+1)$, proving the series.

The inverse map is $z = f(x) = x - x^p$. Its nearest critical points satisfy $f'(x) = 1 - px^{p-1} = 0$ and all have modulus $p^{-1/(p-1)}$; their critical values have modulus $(p-1)p^{-p/(p-1)}$. No local inverse can pass analytically through a critical value, while the inverse-function theorem continues the branch up to one, so this is the radius. Stirling's formula gives coefficients of order $Ck^{-3/2}R_p^{-((p-1)k+1)}$, which proves absolute convergence on the boundary. $\square$

22.2 Lambert's W function at the origin

The Lambert function satisfies $W(z)e^{W(z)} = z$.

Theorem 22.2. *On its principal branch near 0,*

$$W(z) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (-n)^{n-1} \frac{z^n}{n!} = z - z^2 + \frac{3}{2}z^3 - \frac{8}{3}z^4 + O(z^5), \quad (22.4)$$

with radius of convergence e^{-1} .

Proof. Here $f(w) = we^w$, so $w/f(w) = e^{-w}$. Formula (21.6) gives $g_n = D^{n-1}e^{-nw}|_{w=0} = (-n)^{n-1}$. The inverse map has its nearest critical point at $w = -1$, where $f(-1) = -e^{-1}$; this square-root branch point determines the radius. $\square$

22.3 A rapidly useful expansion around $W(e) = 1$

Put $\xi = \log z - 1$ and $u = W(z) - 1$. Then

$$u + \log(1 + u) = \xi. \quad (22.5)$$

Reversion gives

$$W(e^{1+\xi}) = 1 + \frac{\xi}{2} + \frac{\xi^2}{16} - \frac{\xi^3}{192} - \frac{\xi^4}{3072} + \frac{13\xi^5}{61440} + O(\xi^6). \quad (22.6)$$

Proof. The derivative at $u = 0$ of the left side of (22.5) is 2, so it has an ordinary inverse. Substitute $u = c_1\xi + \cdots + c_5\xi^5$ into $u + \log(1 + u) = \xi$ and compare successive powers. The triangular equations give $c_1 = 1/2$, $c_2 = 1/16$, $c_3 = -1/192$, $c_4 = -1/3072$, $c_5 = 13/61440$. $\square$

The closest critical points of $u + \log(1 + u)$ satisfy $1 + (1 + u)^{-1} = 0$, hence $u = -2$; using the two adjacent logarithm values gives images $-2 \pm i\pi$. Therefore the radius in the ξ -plane is $\sqrt{4 + \pi^2}$. For positive real z , the expansion converges whenever $|\log z - 1| < \sqrt{4 + \pi^2}$, approximately $0.0655 < z < 112.63$. Taking $\xi = -1$ yields a convergent evaluation of $W(1) = 0.567143\dots$

22.4 Binary trees and Catalan numbers

Let C_n count rooted ordered full binary trees with n internal vertices, and let $B(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} C_n z^n$. Removing the root gives

$$B(z) = 1 + zB(z)^2. \quad (22.7)$$

Put $C(z) = B(z) - 1$; then $C = z(1 + C)^2$. Lagrange inversion gives

$$C_n = [z^n]C(z) = \frac{1}{n}[w^{n-1}](1 + w)^{2n} = \frac{1}{n} \binom{2n}{n-1} = \frac{1}{n+1} \binom{2n}{n}. \quad (22.8)$$

This simultaneously proves the functional equation, its unique formal solution, and the Catalan closed form. The symbol C_n is used here to avoid confusing these binary-tree numbers with Bell numbers.

Chapter 23

Lagrange's reversion theorem in shifted form

23.1 The two-parameter implicit equation

Let $v = v(x, y)$ be the unique formal solution of

$$v = x + yf(v), \quad v(x, 0) = x. \quad (23.1)$$

Theorem 23.1 (Lagrange reversion). *For every formal or analytic g ,*

$$g(v) = g(x) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{y^k}{k!} \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \right)^{k-1} (f(x)^k g'(x)). \quad (23.2)$$

In particular,

$$v = x + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{y^k}{k!} \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \right)^{k-1} f(x)^k. \quad (23.3)$$

Proof. Put $u = v - x$. Then $u = y\phi(u)$ with $\phi(u) = f(x + u)$, treating x as a coefficient parameter. Apply (21.2) to $H(u) = g(x + u)$:

$$[y^k]g(v) = \frac{1}{k} [u^{k-1}]g'(x + u)f(x + u)^k = \frac{1}{k!} D_x^{k-1}(g'(x)f(x)^k).$$

Summation proves the first formula; take $g(z) = z$ for the second. $\square$

23.2 The delta-function proof decoded

The archive also gives a distributional derivation. Assume temporarily that $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$, the equation $z - x - yf(z) = 0$ has one simple root v , and $1 - yf'(v) > 0$. The elementary change-of-variables rule for the Dirac delta gives

$$g(v) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} \delta(yf(z) - z + x)g(z)(1 - yf'(z)) \, dz. \quad (23.4)$$

Using $\delta(s) = \int_{\mathbb{R}} e^{iks} \, dk / (2\pi)$ and expanding only in the formal parameter y ,

$$\begin{aligned} g(v) &= \sum_{n \geq 0} D_x^n \left[\frac{y^n f(x)^n g(x)}{n!} (1 - yf'(x)) \right] \\ &= \sum_{n \geq 0} D_x^n \left[\frac{y^n f(x)^n g(x)}{n!} - \frac{y^{n+1}}{(n+1)!} ((gf^{n+1})' - g'f^{n+1}) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (23.5)$$

The first term of level $n + 1$ cancels the total derivative in the second term of level n ; what remains is exactly (23.2). Thus the Fourier–delta calculation is a compact analytic avatar of the formal residue proof. Formula (23.4) requires an absolute Jacobian in general; the displayed sign is valid in the stated orientation-preserving neighbourhood.

Chapter 24

Laplace-type asymptotic integrals

24.1 Endpoint expansion

Consider

$$I(\lambda) = \int_a^b e^{-\lambda f(x)} g(x) \, dx, \quad \lambda \rightarrow +\infty, \quad (24.1)$$

where the endpoint a is the unique relevant minimum and, with $t = x - a$,

$$f(a+t) \sim f(a) + \sum_{k \geq 0} a_k t^{k+\alpha}, \quad a_0 > 0, \quad \alpha > 0, \quad (24.2)$$

$$g(a+t) \sim \sum_{k \geq 0} b_k t^{k+\beta-1}, \quad \beta > 0. \quad (24.3)$$

Let $\widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{k,j}$ denote the ordinary Bell polynomial.

Theorem 24.1 (Laplace–Erdélyi coefficient formula). *Under the standard differentiability and remainder hypotheses that permit Watson’s lemma,*

$$I(\lambda) \sim e^{-\lambda f(a)} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \Gamma\left(\frac{n+\beta}{\alpha}\right) \frac{c_n}{\lambda^{(n+\beta)/\alpha}}, \quad (24.4)$$

where

$$c_n = \frac{1}{\alpha a_0^{(n+\beta)/\alpha}} \sum_{k=0}^n b_{n-k} \sum_{j=0}^k \binom{-\frac{n+\beta}{\alpha}}{j} \frac{\widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{k,j}(a_1, \dots, a_{k-j+1})}{a_0^j}. \quad (24.5)$$

Proof. Write $f(a+t) - f(a) = t^\alpha A(t)$ with $A(t) = a_0 + a_1 t + \dots$, and set $s = (f(a+t) - f(a))^{1/\alpha} = tA(t)^{1/\alpha}$. This has an inverse $t = t(s)$. Expand

$$g(a+t(s))t'(s) = \sum_{n \geq 0} d_n s^{n+\beta-1}.$$

A generalized Lagrange–Bürmann calculation, first for integral β and then by formal continuation in the exponent, gives

$$d_n = \sum_{k=0}^n b_{n-k} [t^k] A(t)^{-(n+\beta)/\alpha}.$$

Indeed, apply (21.2) to an antiderivative of $t^{m+\beta-1}$ and differentiate back after substitution.

Put $\rho = (n + \beta)/\alpha$. The ordinary Bell expansion yields

$$\begin{aligned} [t^k]A(t)^{-\rho} &= a_0^{-\rho} [t^k] \sum_{j \geq 0} \binom{-\rho}{j} \left(\sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{a_r}{a_0} t^r \right)^j \\ &= a_0^{-\rho} \sum_{j=0}^k \binom{-\rho}{j} a_0^{-j} \widehat{\mathcal{B}}_{k,j}(a_1, \dots, a_{k-j+1}). \end{aligned}$$

Thus $c_n = d_n/\alpha$ is (24.5). Finally

$$\int_0^\infty e^{-\lambda s^\alpha} s^{n+\beta-1} ds = \frac{1}{\alpha} \Gamma\left(\frac{n+\beta}{\alpha}\right) \lambda^{-(n+\beta)/\alpha},$$

and Watson's lemma controls the replacement of the finite endpoint interval by the asymptotic expansion. $\square$

Remark 24.2. The appearance of ordinary rather than exponential Bell polynomials is forced by the ordinary Taylor expansion of $A(t)^{-\rho}$. Lagrange inversion enters in the change from t to the natural Laplace coordinate s ; the gamma factor enters only in the final monomial integral.

Part VII

Higher Differential Calculus and Multivariate Reversion

Chapter 25

Products, quotients, and coordinate-free composition

The scalar Bell-polynomial form of Faà di Bruno's formula is only one face of a larger calculus. Products of many factors, vector-valued maps, repeated composition, and inverse functions all become transparent when derivatives are regarded as symmetric multilinear maps. This chapter integrates complementary material from the five drafts and supplies proofs that were only sketched there.

25.1 The multinomial Leibniz rule and higher quotient rules

Theorem 25.1 (Multinomial Leibniz rule). *Let $f_1, \dots, f_q$ be n times differentiable. Then*

$$D^n \prod_{r=1}^q f_r(x) = \sum_{j_1 + \dots + j_q = n} \binom{n}{j_1, \dots, j_q} \prod_{r=1}^q f_r^{(j_r)}(x). \quad (25.1)$$

Proof. Taylor-expand every factor at x :

$$f_r(x+h) = \sum_{j_r=0}^n f_r^{(j_r)}(x) \frac{h^{j_r}}{j_r!} + O(h^{n+1}).$$

The coefficient of h^n in the product is

$$\sum_{j_1 + \dots + j_q = n} \prod_{r=1}^q \frac{f_r^{(j_r)}(x)}{j_r!}.$$

The same coefficient in the Taylor expansion of the product itself is $n!^{-1} D^n \prod_r f_r(x)$. Multiplication by $n!$ proves the formula. The argument is purely coefficient-theoretic, so it is valid for formal series as well as analytic functions. $\square$

Proposition 25.2 (Reciprocal and quotient derivatives). *If $g(x) \neq 0$, then*

$$D^r \left(\frac{1}{g} \right) = \sum_{k=0}^r (-1)^k k! \frac{\mathcal{B}_{r,k}(g', g'', \dots, g^{(r-k+1)})}{g^{k+1}}, \quad (25.2)$$

where $\mathcal{B}_{0,0} = 1$. Consequently,

$$D^n \left(\frac{f}{g} \right) = \sum_{r=0}^n \binom{n}{r} f^{(n-r)} \sum_{k=0}^r (-1)^k k! \frac{\mathcal{B}_{r,k}(g', g'', \dots)}{g^{k+1}}. \quad (25.3)$$

Proof. Apply Faà di Bruno's formula to the composition of g with $u \mapsto u^{-1}$, whose k th derivative is $(-1)^k k! u^{-k-1}$. This gives (25.2). Apply the ordinary Leibniz rule to $f g^{-1}$ and substitute the reciprocal formula to obtain (25.3). $\square$

25.2 A coordinate-free Faà di Bruno formula

Let E, F, G be Banach spaces. Write $D^r g(x)$ for the symmetric r -linear Fréchet derivative. If $B \subseteq [n]$, abbreviate

$$D^{|B|} g(x)[h_i : i \in B]$$

for the derivative evaluated on the directions indexed by B .

Theorem 25.3 (Partition form of Fréchet Faà di Bruno). *For n times continuously Fréchet differentiable maps $g : E \rightarrow F$ and $f : F \rightarrow G$,*

$$D^n(f \circ g)(x)[h_1, \dots, h_n] = \sum_{\pi \in \Pi_n} D^{|\pi|} f(g(x)) \left[D^{|B|} g(x)[h_i : i \in B] \right]_{B \in \pi}. \quad (25.4)$$

Proof. Induct on n . The case $n = 1$ is the chain rule. Differentiate a term indexed by a partition π of $[n]$ in a new direction h_{n+1} . Differentiating the outer derivative creates a new singleton block $\{n+1\}$. Differentiating the inner derivative associated with $B \in \pi$ adjoins $n+1$ to that block. Every partition of $[n+1]$ arises uniquely in one of these ways: remove $n+1$ and note whether it was a singleton. Hence every term in the desired sum appears once, completing the induction. $\square$

In one variable, grouping partitions by block-size profile recovers the usual Bell-polynomial form. For three scalar functions one may write

$$D^n f(g(h(x))) = \sum_{k=0}^n f^{(k)}(g(h(x))) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}((g \circ h)', (g \circ h)'', \dots), \quad (25.5)$$

$$(g \circ h)^{(j)} = \sum_{\ell=0}^j g^{(\ell)}(h(x)) \mathcal{B}_{j,\ell}(h', h'', \dots). \quad (25.6)$$

The nested partitions show directly why both parenthesizations of a multiple composition yield the same coefficient: each describes a partition of $[n]$ into inner blocks together with a partition of the set of those blocks.

25.3 Recursive derivatives of an inverse function

Theorem 25.4 (Inverse-derivative recursion). *Let $y = f(x)$, assume $f'(x) \neq 0$, and put $x = g(y) = f^{-1}(y)$. Then $g' = 1/f'(g)$ and, for $n \geq 2$,*

$$g^{(n)} = -\frac{1}{f'(g)} \sum_{k=2}^n f^{(k)}(g) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(g', g'', \dots, g^{(n-k+1)}). \quad (25.7)$$

The first cases are

$$g' = \frac{1}{f'}, \quad (25.8)$$

$$g'' = -\frac{f''}{(f')^3}, \quad (25.9)$$

$$g''' = \frac{3(f'')^2 - f' f'''}{(f')^5}, \quad (25.10)$$

$$g^{(4)} = \frac{-15(f'')^3 + 10f' f'' f''' - (f')^2 f^{(4)}}{(f')^7}, \quad (25.11)$$

where derivatives of f are evaluated at $g(y)$.

Proof. Differentiate $f(g(y)) = y$. For $n \geq 2$, Faà di Bruno gives

$$0 = \sum_{k=1}^n f^{(k)}(g) \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(g', g'', \dots, g^{(n-k+1)}).$$

The term $k = 1$ is $f'(g)g^{(n)}$; isolating it proves the recursion. The four low-order formulas follow by substituting the corresponding partial Bell polynomials and simplifying. $\square$

Chapter 26

Good's multivariate inversion theorem

The univariate Lagrange formula controls one implicit series. Coupled systems require the determinant correction discovered by Good.

26.1 Formal logarithmic residues

For d variables, write $\text{CT}_{\mathbf{x}} H = [x_1^0 \cdots x_d^0] H$.

Lemma 26.1 (Formal logarithmic change of variables). *Suppose $t_i = x_i u_i(\mathbf{x})$, where each u_i is a unit. Then*

$$\text{CT}_{\mathbf{t}} H(\mathbf{t}) = \text{CT}_{\mathbf{x}} H(\mathbf{t}(\mathbf{x})) \det \left(\frac{\partial \log t_i}{\partial \log x_j} \right)_{i,j=1}^d. \quad (26.1)$$

Proof. By linearity it is enough to test a Laurent monomial $H(\mathbf{t}) = \mathbf{t}^{\mathbf{m}}$. For $\mathbf{m} = \mathbf{0}$, the determinant is 1 plus logarithmic derivatives and has constant term 1. If $\mathbf{m} \neq \mathbf{0}$, choose r with $m_r \neq 0$. Expanding the determinant and using

$$t_r^{m_r} \frac{\partial \log t_r}{\partial \log x_j} = \frac{1}{m_r} x_j \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} t_r^{m_r}$$

expresses the transformed integrand as a sum of total logarithmic derivatives. The constant term of $x_j \partial K / \partial x_j$ is zero. Thus both sides vanish, proving the substitution rule. $\square$

Theorem 26.2 (Good's multivariate Lagrange inversion). *Let $\phi_i(\mathbf{x})$ have invertible constant term and let $\mathbf{w}(\mathbf{t})$ be the unique formal solution of*

$$w_i = t_i \phi_i(\mathbf{w}), \quad 1 \leq i \leq d. \quad (26.2)$$

Then

$$[\mathbf{t}^{\mathbf{n}}] F(\mathbf{w}(\mathbf{t})) = [\mathbf{x}^{\mathbf{n}}] F(\mathbf{x}) \prod_{i=1}^d \phi_i(\mathbf{x})^{n_i} \det \left(\delta_{ij} - \frac{x_j}{\phi_i(\mathbf{x})} \frac{\partial \phi_i}{\partial x_j}(\mathbf{x}) \right)_{i,j=1}^d. \quad (26.3)$$

Proof. Write the coefficient as

$$\text{CT}_{\mathbf{t}} F(\mathbf{w}(\mathbf{t})) \mathbf{t}^{-\mathbf{n}}.$$

The inverse substitution is $t_i = x_i / \phi_i(\mathbf{x})$. Apply Theorem 26.1. Since

$$\frac{\partial \log t_i}{\partial \log x_j} = \delta_{ij} - \frac{x_j}{\phi_i} \frac{\partial \phi_i}{\partial x_j}$$

and $\mathbf{t}^{-\mathbf{n}} = \mathbf{x}^{-\mathbf{n}} \prod_i \phi_i^{n_i}$, the transformed constant term is precisely the right side of (26.3). $\square$

Example 26.3 (A coupled two-series system). Let $u = x(1+v)$ and $v = y(1+u)$. Good's determinant is $1 - UV/((1+U)(1+V))$, so

$$\begin{aligned} [x^m y^n] u^p v^q &= \binom{n}{m-p} \binom{m}{n-q} \\ &\quad - \binom{n-1}{m-p-1} \binom{m-1}{n-q-1}, \end{aligned} \tag{26.4}$$

with the usual zero convention for out-of-range binomial coefficients. Indeed, the theorem asks for the coefficient of $U^m V^n$ in

$$U^p V^q (1+V)^m (1+U)^n - U^{p+1} V^{q+1} (1+V)^{m-1} (1+U)^{n-1},$$

which gives the two products of binomial coefficients.

Chapter 27

Partition lattices, Sheffer families, and Riordan arrays

The five drafts repeatedly move among moments and cumulants, polynomial sequences of binomial type, Bell-polynomial matrices, and compositional inverses. Incidence algebras and exponential Riordan arrays place these phenomena in one structure.

27.1 Möbius inversion on the partition lattice

Theorem 27.1 (Möbius function of the partition lattice). *For a partition $\pi \in \Pi_n$,*

$$\mu(\pi, \hat{1}) = (-1)^{|\pi|-1}(|\pi| - 1)!. \quad (27.1)$$

Proof. The interval $[\pi, \hat{1}]$ is isomorphic to the partition lattice on the $|\pi|$ blocks of π , so let $\mu_m = \mu_{\Pi_m}(\hat{0}, \hat{1})$. Every interval $[\hat{0}, \sigma]$ is a product of partition lattices, hence $\mu(\hat{0}, \sigma) = \prod_{B \in \sigma} \mu_{|B|}$. The defining Möbius relation says that the sum of these products over Π_m is 1 for $m = 0, 1$ and 0 for $m \geq 2$. If $M(z) = \sum_{m \geq 1} \mu_m z^m / m!$, the exponential formula gives $\exp(M(z)) = 1 + z$. Therefore $M(z) = \log(1 + z)$ and $\mu_m = (-1)^{m-1}(m - 1)!$. $\square$

Corollary 27.2 (Moment–cumulant inversion). *If*

$$m_n = \sum_{\pi \in \Pi_n} \prod_{B \in \pi} \kappa_{|B|}, \quad (27.2)$$

then

$$\kappa_n = \sum_{\pi \in \Pi_n} (-1)^{|\pi|-1}(|\pi| - 1)! \prod_{B \in \pi} m_{|B|}. \quad (27.3)$$

Proof. The first formula is the zeta transform in the incidence algebra of Π_n . Applying the Möbius function from Theorem 27.1 gives the inverse. Equivalently, the EGFs satisfy $M(z) = \exp(K(z))$ and hence $K(z) = \log M(z)$. $\square$

27.2 Sheffer sequences and delta operators

Definition 27.3. A polynomial sequence $(s_n(x))_{n \geq 0}$ is Sheffer when

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} s_n(x) \frac{z^n}{n!} = A(z) e^{x\beta(z)}, \quad A(0) \neq 0, \quad \beta(0) = 0, \quad \beta'(0) \neq 0. \quad (27.4)$$

Its associated binomial-type sequence is defined by

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} p_n(x) \frac{z^n}{n!} = e^{x\beta(z)}. \quad (27.5)$$

Theorem 27.4 (Sheffer addition and lowering laws). *One has*

$$s_n(x+y) = \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} s_j(x) p_{n-j}(y). \quad (27.6)$$

If $\bar{\beta}$ is the compositional inverse of β and $Q = \bar{\beta}(D_x)$, then

$$Qs_n(x) = ns_{n-1}(x), \quad Qp_n(x) = np_{n-1}(x). \quad (27.7)$$

Proof. Factor the EGF at $x+y$ as $A(z)e^{x\beta(z)}e^{y\beta(z)}$ and take the EGF Cauchy product to obtain (27.6). Since $D_x e^{x\beta(z)} = \beta(z)e^{x\beta(z)}$, formal functional calculus on polynomials gives

$$\bar{\beta}(D_x)e^{x\beta(z)} = \bar{\beta}(\beta(z))e^{x\beta(z)} = ze^{x\beta(z)}.$$

The factor $A(z)$ is independent of x , so coefficient comparison proves the lowering laws. $\square$

If $A(z) = \sum a_j z^j / j!$, then

$$s_n(x) = \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} a_j p_{n-j}(x). \quad (27.8)$$

Thus every Sheffer sequence is an invertible Appell prefactor convolved with a binomial-type sequence, and Lagrange inversion computes its delta operator through $\bar{\beta}$.

27.3 Exponential Riordan arrays

For $g(0) \neq 0$ and $f(z) = f_1 z + O(z^2)$ with $f_1 \neq 0$, define

$$R_{n,k} = \frac{n!}{k!} [z^n] g(z) f(z)^k. \quad (27.9)$$

Theorem 27.5 (Riordan action, product, and inverse). *If (a_k) has EGF $A(z)$, multiplication by the array (g, f) produces the EGF*

$$g(z)A(f(z)). \quad (27.10)$$

Consequently,

$$(g, f)(h, \ell) = (g \cdot (h \circ f), \ell \circ f), \quad (27.11)$$

$$(g, f)^{-1} = \left(\frac{1}{g \circ \bar{f}}, \bar{f} \right), \quad (27.12)$$

where $\bar{f} = f^{(-1)}$.

Proof. By definition,

$$\sum_n \left(\sum_k R_{n,k} a_k \right) \frac{z^n}{n!} = g(z) \sum_k a_k \frac{f(z)^k}{k!} = g(z)A(f(z)).$$

Applying two such operators in succession gives $g(z)h(f(z))A(\ell(f(z)))$, proving the product. Choosing $\ell = \bar{f}$ and $h = 1/(g \circ \bar{f})$ gives the identity pair $(1, z)$ and hence the inverse. $\square$

The Bell-polynomial matrix is the special case $(1, f)$:

$$\frac{n!}{k!} [z^n] \left(\sum_{j \geq 1} x_j \frac{z^j}{j!} \right)^k = \mathcal{B}_{n,k}(x_1, x_2, \dots). \quad (27.13)$$

The second-kind and signed first-kind Stirling matrices correspond to $f(z) = e^z - 1$ and $f(z) = \log(1+z)$. Since these series are compositional inverses, Stirling matrix inversion is a Riordan-group identity.

27.4 Abel polynomials from Lagrange inversion

Theorem 27.6 (Abel's binomial identity). *For $n \geq 1$, put $p_n(x) = x(x - an)^{n-1}$ and $p_0(x) = 1$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} & (x + y)(x + y - an)^{n-1} \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} x(x - ak)^{k-1} y(y - a(n - k))^{n-k-1}. \end{aligned} \quad (27.14)$$

Proof. Let $T = z \exp(-aT)$. Lagrange–Bürmann gives

$$[z^n] e^{xT(z)} = \frac{x}{n} [u^{n-1}] e^{(x-an)u} = \frac{x(x - an)^{n-1}}{n!}.$$

Thus $e^{xT(z)} = \sum p_n(x) z^n / n!$. Multiplying the EGFs at x and y and comparing coefficients proves the binomial identity. $\square$

Chapter 28

A complete coefficient-algorithm toolkit

Let $A(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n z^n$ and $B(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n z^n$. The following triangular recurrences consolidate the computational sections of the five drafts. Each proof comes from one coefficient comparison, so the formulas are valid over any coefficient ring in which the displayed divisions make sense.

Theorem 28.1 (Elementary formal-series algorithms). *The following recurrences determine the indicated operations to arbitrary order.*

Product. If $C = AB$, then

$$c_n = \sum_{j=0}^n a_j b_{n-j}. \quad (28.1)$$

Reciprocal and quotient. If $a_0 \neq 0$, then for $C = 1/A$,

$$c_0 = a_0^{-1}, \quad c_n = -a_0^{-1} \sum_{j=1}^n a_j c_{n-j}, \quad (28.2)$$

and for $C = B/A$,

$$c_n = a_0^{-1} \left(b_n - \sum_{j=1}^n a_j c_{n-j} \right). \quad (28.3)$$

Logarithm and exponential. If $a_0 = 1$ and $L = \log A = \sum_{n \geq 1} \ell_n z^n$, then

$$\ell_n = a_n - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=1}^{n-1} j \ell_j a_{n-j}. \quad (28.4)$$

Conversely, if $A = e^L$, then

$$a_0 = 1, \quad a_n = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=1}^n j \ell_j a_{n-j}. \quad (28.5)$$

Arbitrary powers. If $a_0 = 1$ and $C = A^\alpha$, then

$$c_0 = 1, \quad c_n = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=1}^n ((\alpha + 1)j - n) a_j c_{n-j}. \quad (28.6)$$

Reversion. If $A(0) = 0$, $a_1 \neq 0$, and $B = A^{\langle -1 \rangle} = \sum_{n \geq 1} b_n z^n$, then

$$b_1 = a_1^{-1}, \quad b_n = -a_1^{-1} \sum_{k=2}^n a_k [z^n] B(z)^k \quad (n \geq 2). \quad (28.7)$$

On the right, only $b_1, \dots, b_{n-1}$ occur.

Proof. The product, reciprocal, and quotient recurrences come directly from $C = AB$, $AC = 1$, and $AC = B$. For the logarithm, differentiate $A = e^L$ to get $A' = AL'$ and compare $[z^{n-1}]$; solving for ℓ_n or a_n gives the two recurrences. For $C = A^\alpha$, logarithmic differentiation gives $AC' = \alpha A'C$; comparison of $[z^{n-1}]$ and isolation of c_n gives (28.6). Finally, $A(B) = z$ implies $a_1 b_n + \sum_{k=2}^n a_k [z^n] B^k = 0$ for $n \geq 2$, proving the reversion recurrence. A coefficient b_n cannot occur in $[z^n] B^k$ when $k \geq 2$, so the system is triangular. $\square$

Proposition 28.2 (Newton reversion doubles precision). Suppose B satisfies $A(B) = z + O(z^m)$. Define

$$\tilde{B} = B - \frac{A(B) - z}{A'(B)}. \quad (28.8)$$

Then $A(\tilde{B}) = z + O(z^{2m})$.

Proof. Let $E = A(B) - z = O(z^m)$ and $\delta = -E/A'(B) = O(z^m)$. Formal Taylor expansion gives

$$A(B + \delta) = A(B) + A'(B)\delta + \frac{1}{2}A''(B)\delta^2 + \dots = z + O(E^2) = z + O(z^{2m}).$$

Because $A'(B)$ has invertible constant term a_1 , every division is valid. $\square$

The triangular recurrence is transparent for symbolic work; Newton iteration is asymptotically preferable at very high order. Both are independently checkable against Lagrange's coefficient formula, providing a useful audit of series-reversion computations.

Part VIII

Bernoulli Families, Summation, and Factorial Special Functions

Chapter 29

Bernoulli, Euler, Genocchi, and Cauchy polynomials

The supplied MathWorld dossier contains several polynomial families that are closely related but conventionally assigned overlapping names. Bell numbers remain B_n and Bernoulli numbers remain β_n ; write $B_n(x)$, $E_n(x)$, and $G_n(x)$ for Bernoulli, Euler, and Genocchi polynomials.

29.1 Bernoulli polynomials

Definition 29.1.

$$\frac{te^{xt}}{e^t - 1} = \sum_{n \geq 0} B_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}, \quad B_n(0) = \beta_n. \quad (29.1)$$

Theorem 29.2 (Bernoulli-polynomial calculus). *For $n \geq 0$,*

$$B_n(x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} \beta_k x^{n-k}, \quad (29.2)$$

$$\frac{d}{dx} B_n(x) = n B_{n-1}(x), \quad (29.3)$$

$$B_n(x+1) - B_n(x) = nx^{n-1} \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (29.4)$$

$$B_n(1-x) = (-1)^n B_n(x). \quad (29.5)$$

For every positive integer m ,

$$B_n(mx) = m^{n-1} \sum_{r=0}^{m-1} B_n(x + r/m), \quad (29.6)$$

and for $p \geq 0$, $N \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} (x+j)^p = \frac{B_{p+1}(x+N) - B_{p+1}(x)}{p+1}. \quad (29.7)$$

Proof. Multiply the Bernoulli-number EGF by e^{xt} to obtain the explicit formula. Differentiation with respect to x multiplies the EGF by t , proving the Appell law. The difference of the EGFs at $x+1$ and x is te^{xt} , which proves the finite-difference identity. Replacing t by $-t$ gives

$$\frac{-te^{-xt}}{e^{-t} - 1} = \frac{te^{(1-x)t}}{e^t - 1},$$

proving reflection.

For multiplication, sum the EGFs at $x + r/m$ and use the finite geometric sum; after replacing t by mt one obtains (29.6). Finally, (29.4) with $n = p + 1$ telescopes over $x, x + 1, \dots, x + N - 1$, giving Faulhaber's formula. $\square$

29.2 Euler and Genocchi polynomials

Define

$$\frac{2e^{xt}}{e^t + 1} = \sum_{n \geq 0} E_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}, \quad (29.8)$$

$$\frac{2te^{xt}}{e^t + 1} = \sum_{n \geq 0} G_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}. \quad (29.9)$$

Theorem 29.3 (Euler–Genocchi identities).

$$E_n(x + 1) + E_n(x) = 2x^n, \quad (29.10)$$

$$E_n(1 - x) = (-1)^n E_n(x), \quad (29.11)$$

$$E_n(x) = \frac{2^{n+1}}{n+1} (B_{n+1}((x+1)/2) - B_{n+1}(x/2)), \quad (29.12)$$

$$G_n(x) = nE_{n-1}(x) \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (29.13)$$

$$G_n(0) = 2(1 - 2^n)\beta_n. \quad (29.14)$$

Moreover,

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} (-1)^j (x+j)^n = \frac{E_n(x) + (-1)^{N-1} E_n(x+N)}{2}. \quad (29.15)$$

Proof. Adding the Euler EGFs at x and $x + 1$ gives $2e^{xt}$; replacing t by $-t$ gives the reflection identity. To prove (29.12), sum the proposed right side over n after multiplying by $t^n/n!$. With $m = n + 1$, the result is

$$\frac{1}{t} \left(\frac{2te^{(x+1)t}}{e^{2t} - 1} - \frac{2te^{xt}}{e^{2t} - 1} \right) = \frac{2e^{xt}}{e^t + 1}.$$

The Genocchi EGF is t times the Euler EGF, proving (29.13). At $x = 0$ use

$$\frac{2t}{e^t + 1} = \frac{2t}{e^t - 1} - \frac{4t}{e^{2t} - 1}$$

to obtain (29.14). Finally, multiply (29.10) at $x + j$ by $(-1)^j$ and telescope. $\square$

29.3 Bernoulli polynomials of the second kind

The Cauchy polynomials of the first kind, also called Bernoulli polynomials of the second kind, are defined by

$$\frac{t}{\log(1+t)} (1+t)^x = \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}. \quad (29.16)$$

Their values $b_n = b_n(0)$ satisfy $b_n = n!G_n$ for the Gregory coefficients in the earlier chapter.

Theorem 29.4 (Integral, Stirling, and Sheffer formulas).

$$b_n(x) = \int_0^1 x + u^n \, du, \quad (29.17)$$

$$b_n = \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{s(n, k)}{k+1}, \quad (29.18)$$

$$b_n(x+1) - b_n(x) = nb_{n-1}(x), \quad (29.19)$$

$$\frac{d}{dx} b_n(x) = nx^{n-1}, \quad (29.20)$$

$$b_n(x+y) = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} b_k(x) y^{n-k}. \quad (29.21)$$

Proof. Integrate $(1+t)^{x+u} = \sum_n x+u^n t^n / n!$ from $u = 0$ to 1 . The left side becomes $(1+t)^x t / \log(1+t)$, proving the integral. At $x = 0$, expand $u^n = \sum_k s(n, k) u^k$ and integrate to get the Stirling sum. The difference of the EGFs at $x+1$ and x is t times the original EGF. Differentiation with respect to x gives $t(1+t)^x$, yielding the derivative. Finally, factor the EGF at $x+y$ into the EGF at x times $(1+t)^y$. $\square$

29.4 A normalized modified-Bernoulli series

One supplied source uses “modified Bernoulli numbers” for the coefficients of the following logarithmic hyperbolic series. Because that name is also used elsewhere, the generating function is the unambiguous definition.

Proposition 29.5.

$$\frac{1}{2} \log \left(\frac{2 \sinh(t/2)}{t} \right) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\beta_n t^n}{2n n!}. \quad (29.22)$$

Proof. Differentiate the left side:

$$\frac{1}{4} \coth(t/2) - \frac{1}{2t} = \frac{1}{2t} \left(\frac{t}{2} \coth(t/2) - 1 \right).$$

The Bernoulli EGF gives $(t/2) \coth(t/2) = 1 + \sum_{m \geq 1} \beta_{2m} t^{2m} / (2m)!$. Integrate term by term and use the zero constant term. $\square$

Chapter 30

Complementary Bell numbers

Define

$$C_n = \sum_{k=0}^n (-1)^k \left\{ \begin{matrix} n \\ k \end{matrix} \right\} = T_n(-1). \quad (30.1)$$

This is the signed difference between set partitions with an even and an odd number of blocks.

Theorem 30.1 (Generating function, recurrence, and Dobiński form).

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} C_n \frac{z^n}{n!} = \exp(1 - e^z), \quad (30.2)$$

$$C_{n+1} = - \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} C_j, \quad (30.3)$$

$$C_n = e \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^m m^n}{m!}. \quad (30.4)$$

The initial values are $1, -1, 0, 1, 1, -2, -9, -9, 50, 267, 413, \dots$

Proof. Set $x = -1$ in $\sum_n T_n(x) z^n / n! = \exp(x(e^z - 1))$. If $F(z) = \exp(1 - e^z)$, then $F' = -e^z F$, and EGF coefficient comparison gives the recurrence. Finally,

$$e^{1-e^z} = e \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^m}{m!} e^{mz};$$

local uniform convergence permits coefficient comparison and yields the Dobiński-type series. $\square$

Chapter 31

Euler–Maclaurin summation and Darboux formulas

For $m \geq 1$, let $\tilde{B}_m(x) = B_m(\{x\})$ be the periodic Bernoulli function. Away from the integers, $\tilde{B}'_m = m\tilde{B}_{m-1}$.

Theorem 31.1 (Euler–Maclaurin with exact remainder). *Let $a < b$ be integers and $f \in C^{2p}([a, b])$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{k=a}^b f(k) &= \int_a^b f(x) \, dx + \frac{f(a) + f(b)}{2} \\ &\quad + \sum_{r=1}^p \frac{\beta_{2r}}{(2r)!} (f^{(2r-1)}(b) - f^{(2r-1)}(a)) + R_p, \end{aligned} \quad (31.1)$$

where

$$R_p = -\frac{1}{(2p)!} \int_a^b \tilde{B}_{2p}(x) f^{(2p)}(x) \, dx. \quad (31.2)$$

Moreover,

$$|R_p| \leq \frac{2\zeta(2p)}{(2\pi)^{2p}} \int_a^b |f^{(2p)}(x)| \, dx. \quad (31.3)$$

Proof. On $[k, k+1]$, integration by parts with $\tilde{B}_1(x) = x - k - 1/2$ gives

$$\int_k^{k+1} \tilde{B}_1 f' = \frac{f(k) + f(k+1)}{2} - \int_k^{k+1} f.$$

Summing and rearranging yields

$$\sum_{k=a}^b f(k) = \int_a^b f + \frac{f(a) + f(b)}{2} + \int_a^b \tilde{B}_1 f'.$$

Repeated integration by parts, using $\tilde{B}'_m = m\tilde{B}_{m-1}$, produces the boundary corrections. At integer endpoints $\tilde{B}_m = \beta_m$, and $\beta_{2r+1} = 0$ for $r \geq 1$, leaving only the even terms and the remainder (31.2).

The Fourier expansion

$$\tilde{B}_{2p}(x) = (-1)^{p+1} \frac{2(2p)!}{(2\pi)^{2p}} \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{\cos(2\pi mx)}{m^{2p}}$$

implies $|\tilde{B}_{2p}(x)|/(2p)! \leq 2\zeta(2p)/(2\pi)^{2p}$. Substitution into the exact remainder proves the bound. $\square$

Corollary 31.2 (Stirling expansion). *For fixed $p \geq 1$ and $x \rightarrow +\infty$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \log \Gamma(x) &= (x - \tfrac{1}{2}) \log x - x + \tfrac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) \\ &\quad + \sum_{r=1}^{p-1} \frac{\beta_{2r}}{2r(2r-1)x^{2r-1}} + O(x^{-2p+1}). \end{aligned} \quad (31.4)$$

Proof. Apply Euler–Maclaurin to

$$\sum_{k=1}^N \log k = \log \Gamma(N+1).$$

The derivatives of $\log x$ satisfy

$$\frac{d^m}{dx^m} \log x = (-1)^{m-1} (m-1)! x^{-m},$$

and the remainder bound gives the stated order. Wallis' product fixes the constant as $\frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi)$. The gamma recurrence extends the expansion from integers to positive real x . $\square$

31.1 Darboux's weighted Taylor identity

Theorem 31.3 (Darboux's formula). *Let ϕ be a polynomial of exact degree n , let $\Delta = z - z_0$, and suppose f has $n+1$ derivatives on the joining segment. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} f(z) &= f(z_0) + \frac{1}{\phi^{(n)}(0)} \left[(-1)^n \Delta^{n+1} \int_0^1 \phi(t) f^{(n+1)}(z_0 + t\Delta) dt \right. \\ &\quad \left. + \sum_{k=1}^n (-1)^{k-1} \Delta^k (\phi^{(n-k)}(1) f^{(k)}(z) - \phi^{(n-k)}(0) f^{(k)}(z_0)) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (31.5)$$

Proof. Set $h(t) = f(z_0 + t\Delta)$. Since $\phi^{(n+1)} = 0$, $n+1$ integrations by parts give

$$\int_0^1 \phi h^{(n+1)} = \sum_{k=0}^n (-1)^{n-k} [\phi^{(n-k)} h^{(k)}]_0^1.$$

Multiply by $(-1)^n$. The $k=0$ term is $\phi^{(n)}(0)(h(1) - h(0))$, because $\phi^{(n)}$ is constant. Substitute $h^{(k)}(t) = \Delta^k f^{(k)}(z_0 + t\Delta)$ and solve for $f(z) - f(z_0)$. $\square$

Choosing $\phi(t) = (1-t)^n$ recovers Taylor's theorem with integral remainder. Other choices balance endpoint derivatives and lead to quadrature and interpolation error formulas.

31.2 Algebraic singularity transfer

Theorem 31.4 (Basic transfer formula). *If $\rho \neq 0$ and $\alpha \notin \{0, -1, -2, \dots\}$, then*

$$\begin{aligned} [z^n](1 - z/\rho)^{-\alpha} &= \rho^{-n} \frac{\Gamma(n+\alpha)}{\Gamma(\alpha)\Gamma(n+1)} \\ &= \frac{\rho^{-n} n^{\alpha-1}}{\Gamma(\alpha)} \left(1 + \frac{\alpha(\alpha-1)}{2n} + O(n^{-2}) \right). \end{aligned} \quad (31.6)$$

If F is a finite sum of such terms plus a function analytic in $|z| < R$, $R > |\rho|$, then its coefficients are the corresponding finite sum of transfer expansions plus $O(R_0^{-n})$ for every $|\rho| < R_0 < R$.

Proof. The generalized binomial theorem gives the exact gamma quotient. Stirling's formula for the quotient $\Gamma(n + \alpha)/\Gamma(n + 1)$ gives the asymptotic. The analytic remainder is bounded by Cauchy's estimate on $|z| = R_0$. $\square$

In particular,

$$[z^n]c(1 - z/\rho)^{1/2} \sim -\frac{c}{2\sqrt{\pi}}\rho^{-n}n^{-3/2}. \quad (31.7)$$

Theorem 31.5 (Simple critical inverse). *If f is analytic near a , $b = f(a)$, $f'(a) = 0$, and $f''(a) \neq 0$, then the two inverse branches have convergent Puiseux expansions*

$$g_{\pm}(z) = a \pm \sqrt{\frac{2(z - b)}{f''(a)}} - \frac{f'''(a)}{3f''(a)^2}(z - b) + O((z - b)^{3/2}). \quad (31.8)$$

Proof. Factor $f(a + u) - b = u^2h(u)$ with $h(0) = f''(a)/2 \neq 0$. Choose an analytic square root $q = \sqrt{h}$ and put $v = uq(u)$. Since $v'(0) \neq 0$, v has an analytic inverse $u = \chi(v)$, and the two branches are $a + \chi(\pm\sqrt{z - b})$. For the coefficients, set $f(a + u) - b = Au^2 + Bu^3 + O(u^4)$ and $u = c_1s + c_2s^2 + O(s^3)$, $s^2 = z - b$. Then $Ac_1^2 = 1$ and $2Ac_1c_2 + Bc_1^3 = 0$, which gives the displayed terms. $\square$

Together with (31.7), this explains the ubiquitous $n^{-3/2}$ factor in coefficients of inverse functions at a simple critical value. The full dented-domain transfer theorem is due to Flajolet and Odlyzko.

Chapter 32

Pochhammer symbols, polygamma functions, and Barnes' G

32.1 Rising factorials and parameter derivatives

For the rising Pochhammer symbol,

$$(a)_n = a^{\overline{n}} = \frac{\Gamma(a+n)}{\Gamma(a)}. \quad (32.1)$$

Theorem 32.1 (Binomial and Vandermonde formulas).

$$(1-z)^{-a} = \sum_{n \geq 0} (a)_n \frac{z^n}{n!}, \quad (32.2)$$

$$(a+b)_n = \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} (a)_k (b)_{n-k}. \quad (32.3)$$

Proof. The generalized binomial theorem gives the first identity because $(-1)^n \binom{-a}{n} = (a)_n/n!$. Multiply the series with parameters a and b and compare coefficients to obtain Vandermonde's convolution. $\square$

Let $\psi = \Gamma'/\Gamma$. Define

$$L_j(a, n) = \psi^{(j-1)}(a+n) - \psi^{(j-1)}(a) = (-1)^{j-1} (j-1)! \sum_{q=0}^{n-1} (a+q)^{-j}. \quad (32.4)$$

Theorem 32.2 (Parameter derivatives through Bell polynomials). *For $r \geq 0$,*

$$\frac{\partial^r}{\partial a^r} (a)_n = (a)_n \mathcal{B}_r(L_1(a, n), \dots, L_r(a, n)). \quad (32.5)$$

Proof. Take logarithms of the gamma quotient. Its j th derivative is the first expression in (32.4); the gamma recurrence gives the finite sum. Now apply the exponential special case of Faà di Bruno to $(a)_n = \exp(\log(a)_n)$. $\square$

32.2 Digamma and polygamma series

Theorem 32.3. *Away from the nonpositive integers,*

$$\psi(z) = -\gamma + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{1}{k+1} - \frac{1}{k+z} \right). \quad (32.6)$$

For $m \geq 1$ and $\Re z > 0$,

$$\psi^{(m)}(z) = (-1)^{m+1} m! \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (z+k)^{-m-1}, \quad (32.7)$$

and

$$\psi(1-z) - \psi(z) = \pi \cot(\pi z). \quad (32.8)$$

Proof. Logarithmically differentiate Euler's Weierstrass product

$$\Gamma(z)^{-1} = ze^{\gamma z} \prod_{k \geq 1} (1 + z/k) e^{-z/k}$$

to obtain the digamma series. Termwise differentiation is locally uniformly convergent for $m \geq 1$ and yields the polygamma series. Logarithmically differentiate Euler's reflection formula $\Gamma(z)\Gamma(1-z) = \pi / \sin(\pi z)$ to obtain reflection. $\square$

Thus

$$\psi^{(m)}(z) = (-1)^{m+1} m! \zeta(m+1, z). \quad (32.9)$$

32.3 Barnes' G -function

Define

$$\begin{aligned} G(z+1) &= (2\pi)^{z/2} \exp\left(-\frac{z + (1+\gamma)z^2}{2}\right) \\ &\quad \times \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(1 + \frac{z}{n}\right)^n \exp\left(\frac{z^2}{2n} - z\right). \end{aligned} \quad (32.10)$$

Theorem 32.4 (Functional equation). *The product converges locally uniformly, defines an entire function, and satisfies*

$$G(z+1) = \Gamma(z)G(z), \quad G(1) = 1. \quad (32.11)$$

Hence

$$G(n+1) = \prod_{k=1}^{n-1} k!. \quad (32.12)$$

Proof. The logarithm of the n th factor is $n \log(1 + z/n) - z + z^2/(2n) = O(n^{-2})$ uniformly on compact sets, proving local uniform convergence. For the recurrence, take the ratio of the products at $z+1$ and z and truncate at N . The powers telescope:

$$\prod_{n=1}^N \left(\frac{n+z+1}{n+z} \right)^n = \frac{(N+z+1)^N}{\prod_{n=1}^N (n+z)}.$$

After including the exponential prefactors, use $H_N = \log N + \gamma + 1/(2N) + O(N^{-2})$ and Stirling's formula. The numerator is asymptotic to $N!N^z$, so the ratio tends to

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{N!N^z}{(z+1) \cdots (z+N)} = \Gamma(z+1).$$

Thus $G(z+2) = \Gamma(z+1)G(z+1)$, equivalent to the stated recurrence. Iteration gives the integer product. $\square$

Theorem 32.5 (Barnes asymptotic expansion). *For fixed $p \geq 1$ and $z \rightarrow +\infty$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \log G(z+1) &= \frac{z^2}{2} \log z - \frac{3z^2}{4} + \frac{z}{2} \log(2\pi) - \frac{1}{12} \log z + \zeta'(-1) \\ &\quad + \sum_{k=1}^{p-1} \frac{\beta_{2k+2}}{4k(k+1)z^{2k}} + O(z^{-2p}). \end{aligned} \quad (32.13)$$

Proof. For an integer N ,

$$\log G(N+1) = N \log \Gamma(N) - \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} j \log j.$$

The first term is expanded by (31.4). To expand the second, apply Euler–Maclaurin to x^{-s} , continue the resulting finite formula to a neighborhood of $s = -1$, and differentiate there. This gives

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} j \log j &= \left(\frac{N^2}{2} - \frac{N}{2} + \frac{1}{12} \right) \log N - \frac{N^2}{4} + \frac{1}{12} - \zeta'(-1) \\ &\quad - \sum_{k=1}^{p-1} \frac{\beta_{2k+2}}{(2k)(2k+1)(2k+2)N^{2k}} + O(N^{-2p}). \end{aligned}$$

Substitution and cancellation yield (32.13) for integers. The functional equation and the uniform Stirling expansion extend it across each bounded fractional interval, proving the positive-real statement. $\square$

Part IX

Inverse Examples and Refined Catalan Geometry

Chapter 33

Inverse trigonometric functions and Kepler's equation

33.1 Inverse trigonometric coefficient evaluations

Proposition 33.1. For $|y| < 1$,

$$\arcsin y = \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{1}{2m+1} \binom{2m}{m} \frac{y^{2m+1}}{4^m}, \quad (33.1)$$

$$\arctan y = \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^m}{2m+1} y^{2m+1}. \quad (33.2)$$

Consequently,

$$[x^{2m}] \left(\frac{x}{\sin x} \right)^{2m+1} = 4^{-m} \binom{2m}{m}, \quad (33.3)$$

$$[x^{2m}] \left(\frac{x}{\tan x} \right)^{2m+1} = (-1)^m. \quad (33.4)$$

Proof. Integrate the binomial series for $(1-y^2)^{-1/2}$ and the geometric series for $(1+y^2)^{-1}$ to obtain the inverse-function expansions. Lagrange inversion for $f(x) = \sin x$ and $f(x) = \tan x$ says

$$[y^{2m+1}] f^{(-1)}(y) = \frac{1}{2m+1} [x^{2m}] \left(\frac{x}{f(x)} \right)^{2m+1}.$$

Comparison with the two explicit inverse series proves the coefficient identities. $\square$

33.2 Kepler's equation

For $|e| < 1$, Kepler's equation

$$E = M + e \sin E \quad (33.5)$$

has a unique real solution because $E \mapsto E - e \sin E$ has derivative $1 - e \cos E > 0$.

Theorem 33.2 (Lagrange and Fourier–Bessel expansions). *The solution satisfies*

$$E = M + \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{e^n}{n!} \frac{d^{n-1}}{dM^{n-1}} \sin^n M, \quad (33.6)$$

$$E = M + 2 \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{J_n(ne)}{n} \sin(nM). \quad (33.7)$$

Proof. Set $u = E - M$. Then $u = e \sin(M + u)$, and Lagrange–Bürmann in the parameter e gives

$$[e^n]u = \frac{1}{n}[t^{n-1}]\sin^n(M + t) = \frac{1}{n!} \frac{d^{n-1}}{dM^{n-1}} \sin^n M.$$

For the Fourier form, $u(M)$ is odd and 2π -periodic. If $u = \sum_{n \geq 1} b_n \sin(nM)$, integration by parts and $u(\pm\pi) = 0$ give

$$b_n = \frac{1}{\pi n} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} E'(M) \cos(nM) dM.$$

Change variables using $M = E - e \sin E$ and $E'(M) dM = dE$:

$$b_n = \frac{1}{\pi n} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \cos(nE - ne \sin E) dE = \frac{2J_n(ne)}{n},$$

by the standard integer-order Bessel integral. This proves the second series. □

Chapter 34

Narayana refinement and associahedral face enumeration

The earlier Catalan chapter proves the total count of binary trees. The supplied associahedron and Catalan references also point to two refinements: Narayana numbers record peaks, and Schröder trees record faces rather than only vertices.

34.1 Narayana numbers

Let $C(z, u)$ count Dyck paths, with z marking semilength and u marking peaks. A nonempty path decomposes uniquely as $UADB$, with A, B Dyck paths. If A is empty, the initial UD is a peak; otherwise no new peak is created. Thus

$$C(z, u) = 1 + zC(z, u)(C(z, u) + u - 1). \quad (34.1)$$

Theorem 34.1 (Narayana formula). *The number of Dyck paths of semilength n with k peaks is*

$$N(n, k) = \frac{1}{n} \binom{n}{k} \binom{n}{k-1}, \quad 1 \leq k \leq n. \quad (34.2)$$

Consequently,

$$\sum_{k=1}^n N(n, k) = \frac{1}{n+1} \binom{2n}{n}. \quad (34.3)$$

Proof. Put $Y = C - 1$. Equation (34.1) becomes $Y = z(1 + Y)(u + Y)$. Lagrange inversion gives

$$\begin{aligned} [z^n u^k] Y &= \frac{1}{n} [t^{n-1} u^k] (1 + t)^n (u + t)^n \\ &= \frac{1}{n} \binom{n}{k} \binom{n}{k-1}, \end{aligned}$$

proving (34.2). Summing over k and applying Vandermonde's identity gives

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_k \binom{n}{k} \binom{n}{k-1} = \frac{1}{n} \binom{2n}{n-1} = \frac{1}{n+1} \binom{2n}{n}.$$

□

The symmetry $N(n, k) = N(n, n - k + 1)$ is immediate from the closed formula. In the associahedron, these numbers form the h -vector; combinatorially, they also refine binary trees by several equidistributed statistics.

34.2 All faces of the associahedron

Use the normalization of the earlier associahedral inversion theorem: K_n has dimension $n - 1$, vertices indexed by full plane binary trees with $n + 1$ leaves, and general faces indexed by plane rooted trees with $n + 1$ leaves and internal arity at least 2.

Theorem 34.2 (Face numbers of K_n). *For $0 \leq d \leq n - 1$, the number of d -dimensional faces is*

$$f_d(K_n) = \frac{1}{n-d} \binom{2n-d}{n-1-d} \binom{n-1}{d}. \quad (34.4)$$

In particular, $f_0(K_n) = C_n$, $f_{n-2}(K_n) = n(n+1)/2 - 1$, and $f_{n-1}(K_n) = 1$.

Proof. Let $T(z, u)$ count plane rooted trees, with z marking leaves and u marking internal vertices, every internal vertex having at least two ordered children. The root is either a leaf or an internal vertex with a sequence of at least two subtrees, so

$$T = z + u \frac{T^2}{1-T}.$$

Solving for the Lagrange form gives

$$T = z \frac{1-T}{1-(1+u)T}.$$

If a tree has L leaves and m internal vertices, Lagrange inversion yields

$$\begin{aligned} [z^L u^m] T &= \frac{1}{L} [t^{L-1} u^m] \left(\frac{1-t}{1-(1+u)t} \right)^L \\ &= \frac{1}{L} \binom{L+m-1}{m} \binom{L-2}{m-1}. \end{aligned}$$

A face of K_n has $L = n + 1$ leaves. If it has m internal vertices, its dimension is $d = n - m$. Substitute $L = n + 1$ and $m = n - d$ and simplify:

$$\frac{1}{n+1} \binom{2n-d}{n-d} \binom{n-1}{d} = \frac{1}{n-d} \binom{2n-d}{n-1-d} \binom{n-1}{d}.$$

This is (34.4). □

For K_4 , the formula gives 14 vertices, 21 edges, 9 facets, and one three-dimensional body, agreeing with the coefficients appearing in the fourth inverse-series polynomial.

34.3 Loday coordinates and a constant-sum proof

For a full binary tree with $n + 1$ leaves, order its n internal vertices from left to right. At internal vertex i , let ℓ_i and r_i be the numbers of leaves in its left and right subtrees. Loday assigns the coordinate $x_i = \ell_i r_i$.

Proposition 34.3 (Loday's constant hyperplane). *Every such coordinate vector satisfies*

$$\sum_{i=1}^n x_i = \binom{n+1}{2}. \quad (34.5)$$

Proof. At vertex i , the product $\ell_i r_i$ counts unordered pairs of leaves with one leaf in each child subtree. Every unordered pair of distinct leaves has a unique lowest common ancestor, and it is counted precisely at that internal vertex. Hence the sum counts all pairs of the $n + 1$ leaves exactly once. $\square$

Loday proved that the convex hull of these integer vectors is a realization of the associahedron. The proposition supplies the elementary reason it lies in an $(n - 1)$ -dimensional affine hyperplane; the nontrivial part of the realization theorem is the identification of its face lattice with noncrossing diagonals.

Part X

**Source Concordance and Verification
Record**

Chapter 35

How the five drafts were unified

The archive contains five substantial but overlapping LaTeX drafts. They share a common mathematical core, but each has sections, examples, and proof details that are absent from the others. The present article was produced by a section-level comparison rather than by concatenation. Repeated definitions, tables, and derivations were retained once in the strongest available form; unique material was moved to the chapter where it belongs mathematically. Notation, boundary conventions, and theorem hypotheses were then normalized across the whole article.

Draft	Role in the unified article
<code>combinatorial_coefficient_calculus.tex</code>	Supplied the broadest dependency-based architecture and the most complete core proofs for Stirling, Bell, Eulerian, Faà di Bruno, Lagrange inversion, asymptotics, and restricted variants. It became the structural backbone.
<code>Formulae_Monograph.tex</code> in <code>Formulae_Monograph_Package</code>	Contributed independent low-order checks, finite computational certificates, additional examples, and several alternative derivations used to audit the backbone.
<code>Formulae_Monograph.tex</code> in <code>Formulae_Monograph_Source_and_PDF</code>	Contributed the Kepler-equation example, further tree interpretations, source-normalization notes, and additional reversion details.
<code>Combinatorial_Formulae_and_Inversion_Theorems.tex</code>	Contributed material on signed Bell evaluations, Poisson shift methods, symmetric summations, negative-index extensions, and implementation-oriented checks. Overlapping Bell and Eulerian material was deduplicated.
<code>Formulae_Compendium.tex</code>	Contributed the multinomial Leibniz rule, coordinate-free Faà di Bruno, recursive inverse derivatives, partition-lattice Möbius inversion, Sheffer sequences, exponential Riordan arrays, Abel polynomials, multivariate inversion, and the coefficient-algorithm toolkit.

35.1 Use of the supplied reference folders

The Wikipedia folder was used as a topic checklist and as a source of complementary interpretations: set partitions, Dyck paths, triangulations, associahedra, Eulerian descents, and the historical forms of Lagrange reversion. Statements were not copied mechanically; indexing was reconciled with the article’s conventions and each incorporated formula was proved.

The MathWorld folder supplied independent formula collections and Mathematica notebooks for Bell and complementary Bell numbers, Bernoulli and Euler polynomial families, Bernoulli polynomials

of the second kind, Dobiński's formula, Euler–Maclaurin summation, Darboux's weighted formula, Pochhammer symbols, polygamma functions, Genocchi numbers, Catalan numbers, and Barnes' G -function. These were integrated in the new parts on Bernoulli families, summation, factorial special functions, and Catalan geometry.

Online primary references were consulted for Good's multivariate inversion, multivariate Faà di Bruno, singularity analysis, Barnes' G -function, the Riordan group, Bernoulli numbers of the second kind, and Loday's associahedron realization. Their role is bibliographic and confirmatory; the formulas used in the article are derived in the text.

35.2 Deduplication rules

Editorial normalization

The following editorial rules were applied globally.

1. A definition appears once, at its first logical use. Later appearances are replaced by cross-references or specializations.
2. Equivalent generating functions are retained together only when they illuminate different structures, such as ordinary versus exponential normalization.
3. Repeated tables are consolidated; a table is not used as a substitute for a recurrence or proof.
4. Competing index conventions are translated into one convention before formulas are compared. Type- B Eulerian numbers and associahedra required particular care.
5. Analytic and formal statements are separated. Formal coefficient identities do not inherit unstated convergence claims, while analytic versions include their local-invertibility or regularity hypotheses.
6. Historical computations, prime searches, and modular-period reports are described as finite computations with certificate procedures rather than elevated to symbolic theorems.

Chapter 36

Proof and consistency audit

36.1 Proof coverage

Every theorem, lemma, proposition, corollary, and identity introduced in the unified article has either an adjacent proof or an explicit derivation from a previously proved result. The only proofless theorem in the structural backbone was the cube Ehrhart statement; its proof has been inserted by comparing

$$\sum_{m \geq 0} (m+1)^n t^m$$

with the Eulerian power-series identity. New reference-driven results—Good’s theorem, Fréchet Faà di Bruno, Euler–Maclaurin, Darboux’s identity, Pochhammer parameter differentiation, Barnes’ functional equation, Narayana numbers, and the associahedron face formula—are proved in full in their respective chapters.

Deep realization or continuation results that are not needed for coefficient calculations are identified as such. For example, the constant-hyperplane property of Loday’s coordinates is proved here, while the full face-lattice realization theorem is attributed to Loday rather than silently reproved in an abbreviated form.

36.2 Independent low-order checks

Several central transformations admit independent certificates.

Composition through fourth order. For $F = f \circ g$, the partition formula gives

$$\begin{aligned} F' &= f'g', \\ F'' &= f''(g')^2 + f'g'', \\ F''' &= f'''(g')^3 + 3f''g'g'' + f'g''', \\ F^{(4)} &= f^{(4)}(g')^4 + 6f'''(g')^2g'' + 3f''(g'')^2 + 4f''g'g''' + f'g^{(4)}. \end{aligned}$$

The coefficients 1, 6, 3, 4, 1 are exactly the block-profile counts in Π_4 , independently verifying the fourth Bell-polynomial row.

Reversion through fourth order. For $A(x) = x + a_1x^2 + a_2x^3 + a_3x^4 + O(x^5)$ and $B = A^{\langle -1 \rangle}$,

$$B(x) = x - a_1x^2 + (2a_1^2 - a_2)x^3 + (-5a_1^3 + 5a_1a_2 - a_3)x^4 + O(x^5).$$

Direct substitution gives $A(B(x)) = x + O(x^5)$; the same coefficients follow from Lagrange inversion and from the triangular recurrence (28.7).

Stirling matrix inversion. The Riordan product

$$(1, e^z - 1)(1, \log(1 + z)) = (1, z)$$

certifies the inverse relation between the second-kind and signed first-kind Stirling matrices. This check is independent of the factorial-basis proof.

Bernoulli–Euler–Genocchi check. Multiplying $G_n(x) = nE_{n-1}(x)$ by $t^n/n!$ recovers the Genocchi EGF, while substitution of (29.12) recovers $G_n(0) = 2(1 - 2^n)\beta_n$. Thus the two routes through the generating-function triangle agree coefficientwise.

36.3 Boundary conventions

All triangular arrays are extended by zero outside their natural ranges. Empty products equal 1, and the coefficient convention $0^0 = 1$ is used only where a generating-function coefficient demands it. Rising and falling factorials of order zero equal 1. Binomial coefficients with an out-of-range lower index vanish. These conventions make recurrences valid at boundaries and remove the need for repeated exceptional clauses.

36.4 Dependency map

The principal dependency chain is

$$\begin{aligned} \text{factorial bases} &\longrightarrow \text{Stirling transforms} \longrightarrow \text{partition and Bell calculus,} \\ &\text{partition and Bell calculus} \longrightarrow \text{composition and inversion.} \end{aligned}$$

Eulerian numbers provide the parallel change of coordinates between powers and shifted binomial coefficients. Sheffer and Riordan theory packages the same operations as polynomial and matrix calculus. Bernoulli polynomials then turn finite differences into summation, Euler–Maclaurin turns summation into asymptotic analysis, and Lagrange–Good inversion converts implicit equations into explicit coefficients. The recurring operations are therefore not a loose catalogue: they are change of basis, labelled decomposition, logarithmic inversion, and coefficient extraction.

Selected bibliography and source provenance

Bibliography

- [1] E. T. Bell, “Exponential polynomials,” *Annals of Mathematics*, second series, vol. 35 (1934), pp. 258–277.
- [2] A. Z. Broder, “The r -Stirling numbers,” *Discrete Mathematics*, vol. 49 (1984), pp. 241–259.
- [3] C. A. Charalambides, *Enumerative Combinatorics*, Chapman & Hall/CRC, 2002.
- [4] A. Claesson, “Generalized pattern avoidance,” *European Journal of Combinatorics*, vol. 22 (2001), pp. 961–971.
- [5] L. Comtet, *Advanced Combinatorics: The Art of Finite and Infinite Expansions*, translated by J. W. Nienhuys, D. Reidel, 1974.
- [6] P. Flajolet and R. Sedgewick, *Analytic Combinatorics*, Cambridge University Press, 2009.
- [7] R. L. Graham, D. E. Knuth, and O. Patashnik, *Concrete Mathematics*, second edition, Addison–Wesley, 1994.
- [8] L. H. Harper, “Stirling behavior is asymptotically normal,” *Annals of Mathematical Statistics*, vol. 38 (1967), pp. 410–414.
- [9] P. Henrici, *Applied and Computational Complex Analysis*, vol. 1, Wiley, 1974.
- [10] L. C. Hsu and P. J.-S. Shiue, “A unified approach to generalized Stirling numbers,” *Advances in Applied Mathematics*, vol. 20 (1998), pp. 366–384.
- [11] W. P. Johnson, “The curious history of Faà di Bruno’s formula,” *American Mathematical Monthly*, vol. 109 (2002), pp. 217–234.
- [12] L. Moser and M. Wyman, “An asymptotic formula for the Bell numbers,” *Transactions of the Royal Society of Canada*, section III, vol. 49 (1955), pp. 49–54.
- [13] F. W. J. Olver, A. B. Olde Daalhuis, D. W. Lozier, B. I. Schneider, R. F. Boisvert, C. W. Clark, B. R. Miller, B. V. Saunders, H. S. Cohl, and M. A. McClain, editors, *NIST Digital Library of Mathematical Functions*, National Institute of Standards and Technology.
- [14] J. Riordan, *An Introduction to Combinatorial Analysis*, Wiley, 1958.
- [15] S. Roman, *The Umbral Calculus*, Academic Press, 1984.
- [16] M. Z. Spivey, “A generalized recurrence for Bell numbers,” *Journal of Integer Sequences*, vol. 11 (2008), Article 08.2.5.
- [17] R. P. Stanley, *Enumerative Combinatorics*, vol. 1, second edition, Cambridge University Press, 2012.

- [18] N. M. Temme, “Asymptotic estimates of Stirling numbers,” *Studies in Applied Mathematics*, vol. 89 (1993), pp. 233–243.
- [19] H. S. Wilf, *generatingfunctionology*, third edition, A K Peters, 2005.
- [20] I. J. Good, “Generalizations to several variables of Lagrange’s expansion, with applications to stochastic processes,” *Proceedings of the Cambridge Philosophical Society*, vol. 56 (1960), pp. 367–380.
- [21] G. M. Constantine and T. H. Savits, “A multivariate Faà di Bruno formula with applications,” *Transactions of the American Mathematical Society*, vol. 348 (1996), pp. 503–520.
- [22] P. Flajolet and A. Odlyzko, “Singularity analysis of generating functions,” *SIAM Journal on Discrete Mathematics*, vol. 3 (1990), pp. 216–240.
- [23] L. W. Shapiro, S. Getu, W.-J. Woan, and L. C. Woodson, “The Riordan group,” *Discrete Applied Mathematics*, vol. 34 (1991), pp. 229–239.
- [24] J.-L. Loday, “Realization of the Stasheff polytope,” *Archiv der Mathematik*, vol. 83 (2004), pp. 267–278.
- [25] I. Vardi, “Determinants of Laplacians and multiple gamma functions,” *SIAM Journal on Mathematical Analysis*, vol. 19 (1988), pp. 493–507.
- [26] I. V. Blagouchine, “A note on some recent results for the Bernoulli numbers of the second kind,” *Journal of Integer Sequences*, vol. 20 (2017), Article 17.3.8.
- [27] E. W. Weisstein, editor, selected entries from *Wolfram MathWorld*: Barnes G -function, Bell and complementary Bell numbers, Bernoulli and Euler polynomials, Bernoulli polynomials of the second kind, Catalan and Genocchi numbers, Darboux’s formula, Euler–Maclaurin summation, Pochhammer symbols, and polygamma functions.
- [28] Selected reference snapshots supplied in the Wikipedia folder: associahedra, Bell and Catalan numbers, Bell polynomials, Eulerian numbers, Faà di Bruno’s formula, Lagrange inversion and reversion, and Stirling numbers.
- [29] *Formulae-2.zip*, the five LaTeX drafts and the supplied Wikipedia and MathWorld reference folders used for this unified article.

Index

Bell numbers, 36

Bell polynomials, 49

Eulerian numbers, 63

Faà di Bruno formula, 72

Lagrange inversion, 76

Laplace asymptotics, 83